The Corporation of the Town of Ajax
General Government Committee
Monday, March 9, 2026 at 1:00 PM

Closed Session to immediately follow Open Session
Hybrid Meeting - Council Chambers
Town Hall - 65 Harwood Avenue South, Ajax

This meeting occurs in person and open portions will be live streamed for viewing at www.ajax.ca/live. Electronic participation is permitted pursuant to Council's Procedure By-law and may be arranged by e-mailing clerks@ajax.ca. Alternative formats of this agenda are available on request by contacting accessibility@ajax.ca.

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1. Call to Order and Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

3. Adoption of Minutes

3.1. Regular Meeting - February 9, 2026

Regular Meeting - February 9, 2026

4. Consent Agenda

4.1. PSA-2026-02 - Business Engagement and Support Strategy Year 1 Biannual Update

Christie McLardie, Director of Public and Strategic Affairs
PSA-2026-02 - Business Engagement and Support Strategy Year 1 Biannual Update

4.2. PSA-2026-03 - 2022-2026 Strategic Plan (Action26) Update

Christie McLardie, Director of Public and Strategic Affairs
PSA 2026-03 Year 3 Strategic Plan Update
ATT-1 - 2022-2026 Strategic Plan Update

4.3. FIN-2026-03 - 2025 Statement of Remuneration and Expenses for Members of Council and Council Appointees

Julie Mepham, Acting Director of Finance/Treasurer
FIN-2026-03 2025 Statement of Remuneration and Expenses for Members of Council and Council Appointees
ATT-1 - Statement of Remuneration and Expenses

4.4. FIN-2026-02 - Tax Section Status Report

Julie Mepham, Acting Director of Finance/Treasurer
FIN-2026-02 Tax Section Status Report

4.5. PDS-2026-05 - 2025 Year End Building Permit Activity and 2026 Projection Report

Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning and Development Services
PDS-2026-05 - 2025 Year End Building Permit Activity and 2026 Projection Report

4.6. PDS-2026-06 - Update on Provincial Road Safety Initiatives Fund (RSIF)

Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning and Development Services
PDS-2026-06 - Update on Provincial Road Safety Initiatives Fund (RSIF)
ATT-1 - List of Council Approved ASE Locations

4.7. PDS-2026-07 - Church Street North Road Closure

Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning and Development Services
PDS-2026-07 - Church Street North - Road Closure Report
ATT-1 - Church St N Closure - Cross-Section
ATT- 2 - Church St N Closure - Stage 1 Traffic Management Plan
ATT- 3 - Church St N Closure - Stage 2 Traffic Management Plan

4.8. PDS-2026-08 - Contract Award - Wetland Tree Planting Projects

Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning and Development Services
PDS-2026-08 - Contract Award - Wetland Tree Planting Projects
ATT-1 CDS - Project 26003501 - Kerrison Wetland Infill Tree Planting Project
ATT-2 CDS - Project 26003601 - Audley Wetland Infill Tree Planting Project
ATT-3 CDS - Project 26003701 - Annandale Wetland Tree Planting Project

4.9. CSD-2026-10 - 2026 Municipal Elections - Joint Compliance Audit Committee Terms of Reference

Nicole Cooper, Deputy Chief Administrative Officer
CSD-2026-10 - 2026 Municipal Elections Compliance Audit Committee Terms of Reference
ATT-1 - 2026-2030 Compliance Audit Committee By-law and Terms of Reference

4.10. CSD-2026-11 - Customer Service Strategy Update

Nicole Cooper, Deputy Chief Administrative Officer
CSD-2026-11 Customer Service Strategy Update

4.11. CSD-2026-12 - Follow-up to Council Motion re Liquor Service Policies

Nicole Cooper, Deputy Chief Administrative Officer
Follow-up to Council Motion re Liquor Service Policies
ATT-1 Liquor Service Report - Survey Responses

5. Discussion

None.

6. Presentations

None.

7. Closed Session

7.1. Security Strategy Update

- To discuss the security of the property of the municipality or local board [Sec. 239(2)(a), Municipal Act, 2001, as amended]

7.2. Lease Agreement Update

- To discuss the security of the property of the municipality or local board [Sec.239(2)(a), Municipal Act, 2001, as amended]
- To discuss advice that is subject to solicitor-client privilege, including communications necessary for that purpose [Sec. 239(2)(f), Municipal Act,2001, as amended]

7.3. Ajax Plaza Update

- To discuss litigation or potential litigation, including matters before administrative tribunals, affecting the municipality or local board [Sec. 239(2)(e), Municipal Act, 2001, as amended]

8. Adjournment

DRAFT MINUTES – SUBJECT TO APPROVAL

Minutes of the General Government Committee Meeting Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall and Electronically at 1:00 p.m. on February 9, 2026

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Chair – Councillor	-	R. Tyler Morin
	Regional Councillors	-	M. Crawford
		-	S. Lee
		-	J. Dies
	Councillors	-	N. Henry
		-	L. Bower
Regrets:	Mayor	-	S. Collier

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Chair Tyler Morin called the meeting to order at 1:01 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of the Minutes

3.1. Regular Meeting

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held on January 12, 2026 be adopted.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

3.2. Closed Session

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Minutes of the closed session of the General Government Committee held on January 12, 2026 be adopted.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

4. Consent Agenda

Committee Members separated items 4.2, 4.3 and 4.4 for discussion.

4.1. AFES-2026-02: Contract Award – Car Fire Prop through Skills Development Fund

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That Council award the Contract for a Draeger System 64 Car Fire Prop, to Darch Fire Inc. under Draegar Safety Canada's Canoe Contract #011824-DRA in the estimated amount of $103,960 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That grant funding from the Skills Development Fund of $93,619.20 be allocated to Capital Project 26002101.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

4.2. PSA-2026-01: Equity, Diversity & Inclusion Framework

Committee Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. Marycarmen Lara Villanueva, Equity, Diversity & Inclusion Advisor, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: L. Bower

That Council receive this report for information.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

4.3. FIN-2026-01: Capital Project Status and Capital Account Closing Report as of December 31, 2025

Committee Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. Tim Field, Manager of Environmental Services, Kassandra Brownridge, Manager of Strategic Initiatives, and Julie Mepham, Acting Director of Finance/Treasurer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: N. Henry

1. That Council receive the attached listing of Capital Account closings as of December 31, 2025 for information.

2. That funding transfers to/from the Reserves/Reserve Funds from the December 31, 2025 Capital Account Closing, in accordance with the Financial Sustainability Plan, be approved as follows:

Reserve / Reserve Fund	Transfers to	Transfers from	Net Transfers
Capital Contingency Reserve	(111,652.39)	131,493.81	19,841.42
Building Maintenance Reserve	(395,138.88)	101,560.68	(293,578.20)
Building Approvals Reserve	-	6,682.28	6,682.28
Strategic Initiatives Reserve	(115,663.79)	-	(115,663.79)
Vehicle/Equipment Replacement Reserve	(111,139.51)	76,258.06	(34,881.45)
Stormwater Maintenance Reserve	(238,579.14)	10,497.42	(228,081.72)
Development Reserve	(46,303.78)	12,812.62	(33,491.16)
Development Charges 2018	-	11,098.17	11,098.17
Roads Maintenance Reserve	-	27,780.48	27,780.48
Total Transfers	(1,018,477.49)	378,183.52	(640,293.97)

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

DRAFT

Opposed: None

CARRIED

4.4. OES-2026-01: Contract Award – Supply and Delivery – Additional Mobile Stage

Committee Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. Chris Vida, Director of Recreation & Culture and T. Field, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Motion to Defer

Moved by: S. Lee

That Report OES-2026-01: Contract Award – Supply and Delivery – Additional Mobile Stage, be deferred to the Council meeting of February 17, 2026 for further discussion.

In Favour: Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Henry

CARRIED

4.5. PDS-2026-03: Town of Ajax Committee of Adjustment – 2025 Summary

Moved by: L. Bower

That the report titled, Town of Ajax Committee of Adjustment – 2025 Summary, be received for information

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

4.6. PDS-2026-04: Contract Award – RFT No. T25222 Rehabilitation & Retrofitting Stormwater Management Pond 17 and RFT No. T24008 Contract Administration & Site Inspection SWMP Rehab & Retrofit

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That Council Award the Contract for Rehabilitation & Retrofitting – Stormwater Management Pond 17 (RFT No. T25222), to Sierra Excavating Enterprises Inc. in the amount of $753,585.70 (inclusive of all taxes);

2. That Council Award the Contract for Contract Administration & Site Inspection (RFT No. T24008 Phase 2) for Stormwater Management Pond 17, to Aquafor Beech Limited in the amount of $18,193.00 (inclusive of all taxes);

3. That Council approve funding of $57,305.14 to be allocated from the Stormwater Maintenance Reserve.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

4.7. CS-2026-06: 2025 Mission: Inclusion Plan Status Update

Moved by: L. Bower

That the 2025 Mission: Inclusion Plan Status Update be received for information.

DRAFT

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

4.8. CS-2026-08: Rented Dwelling Temperature By-law Review

Moved by: L. Bower

That the proposed 2026 Rented Dwelling Temperature By-law (ATT-1) be presented to Council for approval.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

5. Discussion

None.

6. Presentations

None.

7. Authority to Hold a Closed Session and Related In-Camera Meeting

Committee Members elected not to go into Closed Session.

7.1. CS-2026-07: Nomination to Durham Active Transportation Advisory Committee Vacancy

Moved by: L. Bower

That Ajax Council nominate Tallal Tabish for appointment to the Durham Active Transportation Advisory Committee (DATC) for the remainder of the 2023-2026 term.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

8. Adjournment (1:35 p.m.)

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the February 9, 2026 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: Regional Councillor Lee

CARRIED

DRAFT

Town of Ajax Report
Open Session

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Meina Lutfi, Business Engagement Advisor, Strategic Initiatives
Report Number:	PSA-2026-02
Subject:	Business Engagement and Support Strategy Year 1 Biannual Update
Wards:	All Wards
Date of Meeting:	March 9, 2026
Reference:	Business Engagement & Support Strategy Presentation to Council / March 24, 2025

Recommendation:

That Council receive this report for information.

Background:

This report provides Council with an update on the Ajax 2025–2027 Business Engagement & Support Strategy and ensures continued alignment with the Town's strategic objectives. The Strategy outlines a three-year roadmap to strengthen business relationships, build economic capacity, and support sustainable economic growth.

Discussion:

In 2025, staff made measurable progress toward implementing the priorities outlined in the Town's Business Engagement & Support Strategy. Efforts focused on strengthening relationships with the business community, advancing sector-specific initiatives, and enhancing access to municipal resources. The following highlights summarize key achievements under Goal 1 and Goal 2, while identifying initiatives under Goal 3 that are currently underway and advancing into 2026.

Goal 1: Improving Connections

Goal 1 is centered on improving connections with Ajax's business community by enhancing communication channels, expanding direct outreach, and strengthening partnerships within the regional economic development ecosystem.

1.1 Partner with local economic development ecosystem

The Business Engagement & Support (BE&S) team strengthened intergovernmental and regional collaboration through structured participation in Durham Region's economic development network. Staff attended quarterly Durham Economic Development Partnership (DEDP) management-level meetings, in addition to one DEDP All-Hands session involving economic development representatives from across Durham Region. The team participated in four Durham Economic Task Force (DETF) meetings, including two special sessions focused specifically on tariff mitigation (March and April), five in-person Durham Economic Executive Forum (DEEF) meetings, one Durham Agricultural Advisory Committee (DAAC) meeting, and 3 Intelligent Community Consortium meetings (quarterly participation). In total, staff engaged in 18 regional economic development meetings year-to-date. This coordinated approach has strengthened alignment on tariff response planning, enhanced cross-municipal information sharing, and improved Ajax's ability to leverage regional partnerships, funding opportunities, and shared data to support local businesses.

1.2 Implement AI or other advanced technology tools to improve concierge services for new and existing businesses

In 2025, the Town advanced the development of a digital Site Selection Tool designed to enhance concierge services for both small businesses and foreign direct investment (FDI) prospects, with a targeted launch in Q1 2026. The tool will catalogue more than 50 employment and commercial sites across Ajax, including properties available for lease, for sale, under development, and proposed sites, providing a centralized, data-driven platform to support investment decision-making. In addition, staff implemented interactive GIS mapping tools across multiple public-facing platforms, including the online Business Directory and the Made in Ajax webpage. These tools enable users to filter businesses by category, visualize geographic distribution, and identify nearby amenities, improving data accessibility and navigation. Collectively, these enhancements strengthen Ajax's digital service delivery, increase visibility of local businesses, and lay the foundation for future analytics on user engagement, site demand, and investment inquiries.

1.3 Enhance public-facing communications by leveraging tools like videography, photography and TOA Talks

Enhanced visual storytelling was prioritized to strengthen the reach and impact of business-focused events, programs and initiatives. Two high-impact campaigns, Her, Your, Our Story: International Women's Day and Made in Ajax: The Official Culinary Guide, demonstrated measurable growth in digital engagement and brand visibility. The International Women's Day campaign included 15 coordinated posts featuring vendor and speaker spotlights, branded visuals and collaborator tagging to expand audience reach. Two post-event recap videos were also produced in different video formats to capture the event experience. Across platforms, the campaign generated 23,322 Instagram accounts reached, 37,427 Facebook views, 4,635 X views and 94 YouTube views, resulting in a total of 65,478 cross-platform impressions and views. The structured tagging strategy and use of high-quality imagery increased visibility beyond Town-managed channels and strengthened promotional outcomes for participating

businesses. The table below breaks down the total Instagram accounts reached as well as views on Facebook, X and YouTube.

Posts	Accounts Reached	Views			
	Instagram	Facebook	X	YouTube	YouTube Reels
Launch Post	1491	3292	287	0	0
Karma Jiu Jitsu	2019	1621	313	0	0
Genesis Jewellery Boutique	1102	1303	292	0	0
Debra Guthrie Beauty Studio	1474	1920	333	0	0
Business Panel	1434	11,597	308	0	0
Claudine	1756	1729	373	0	0
Spiro's Boutique	1251	2124	270	0	0
Hunters Spot	1212	3160	280	0	0
Health Panel	1980	820	321	0	0
J'aime Desserts	1318	1521	253	0	0
The Bees Knees Apiary	1168	1286	389	0	0
Quips & Quills Bookshop	1034	1115	203	0	0
Steph's Event Recap Video	1489	1174	460	0	37
Group Photo	1688	3824	284	0	0
IWD Sunglasses Video	1569	0	0	0	0
Daniel's Post Event Video	1337	941	269	32	25
Total	23,322	37,427	4,635	32	62

The Made in Ajax culinary campaign incorporated professional photography and trend-based video content to showcase Ajax's diverse restaurant sector. A total of 11 promotional videos and supporting posts were produced, including collaborative features with local restaurants and a tourism partnership giveaway. The campaign generated 39,698 Instagram accounts reached and 212,361 total views across platforms. The Durham Tourism giveaway collaboration alone generated 41,113 Instagram views, representing the highest-performing individual post within the campaign. These results demonstrate measurable growth in audience engagement and reinforce the value of strategic visual communications in promoting local businesses and strengthening Ajax's economic brand. The table below breaks down the total Instagram accounts reached as well as views on Facebook, X and YouTube. We will continue to work on our online engagement in 2026 with a focus on YouTube.

Videos	Accounts Reached	Views				
	Instagram	Instagram	Facebook	X	YouTube	YouTube Reels
1st teaser video	2,504	4,178	2,800	298	2,800	0
2nd teaser video	4,837	8,780	30,500	201	0	664
Launch video	7,535	14,262	15,000	193		514
Hunters Spot Collab Video	2,761	5,052	16,000	194	0	7,010
BanBan Chicken Collab Video	1,245	1,912	2,500	185	0	242
This Is Your Sign to Explore	2,264	3,169	2,300	234	0	0
Eggstatic Collab Video	3,714	5,395	0	0	0	0
Bean & Basket Collab Video	6,552	12,737	0	0	0	0
Soft Launch Event	2,984	4,306	993	395	0	218
Only Eating from Categories	3,032	4,383	1,800	199	1,800	1,1358

Durham Tourism Giveaway Collab	0	41,113	0	0	0	0
Posts	Accounts Reached	Views				
Jan 10th	0	0	2,006	188	0	0
Physical Copies	2,270	5,435	10,869	182	0	0
Total Instagram Accounts Reached	39,698					
Total Views Across Platforms	212,361					

1.4 Implement a robust business visitation and corporate calling program

A targeted business visitation and corporate outreach program was implemented in response to tariff pressures affecting the steel and aluminum sectors. Beginning in March 2025, more than 40 companies, including steel and aluminum fabricators, large-scale manufacturers and supply chain-related businesses, were either visited in person or contacted directly by phone. This proactive outreach resulted in the establishment of new senior-level contacts and improved intelligence regarding sector-specific challenges. Follow-up engagement has continued through resource sharing and direct communication to ensure sustained support as tariff-related uncertainty evolves.

In coordination with the Region of Durham, the Town also participated in multiple investment attraction meetings and site visits over the past year. Staff joined regional partners during a tour with the French Consul General and representatives from the France Canada Chamber of Commerce at SAFRAN to explore opportunities for French business investment and collaboration in Durham Region. Follow-up discussions are planned for the spring to maintain momentum and strengthen international relationships. In addition, staff coordinated and attended two foreign direct investment site visits generated through the Invest Ontario Portal and Durham Economic Development Partnership submissions. While discussions remain confidential, both visits provided opportunities to present Ajax community profiles, highlight available employment lands and strengthen direct investor engagement.

1.5 Ideate creative concepts to build on the success of the quarterly Ajax Business Network events

Four Ajax Business Network (ABN) events were delivered, with a total of 229 registered attendees. These events provided structured and consistent touchpoints with the local business community, supporting relationship-building, peer networking and direct access to municipal staff and partners.

The Small Business Financing Information Session, hosted in January in partnership with the Ajax Public Library, welcomed 50 registrants. This session responded to continued demand from local businesses for guidance on accessing capital during a period of economic uncertainty and rising operational costs. It was distinct in assembling multiple financing organizations in one forum, including the Business Advisory Centre of Durham, the Business Development Bank of Canada, Grant Thornton and Royal Bank of Canada. By presenting loans, grants and advisory services in a single setting, the event reduced barriers to information and strengthened collaboration between lenders and the Ajax business community.

The Her, Your, Our Story: International Women's Day event attracted 100 registered attendees and directly engaged 14 women-owned businesses in planning, catering and vendor participation. The event was strategically important as it intentionally aligned economic development with inclusion by centring women-led enterprises throughout its design and execution. Its fully women-led structure, combined with two discussion panels and multiple skills-based masterclasses, distinguished it from traditional networking events. The coordinated communications campaign generated 65,478 cross-platform impressions, extending the economic visibility of participating businesses beyond the in-person audience.

Lakeside Connections welcomed 65 registered attendees. The event was designed as an informal outdoor networking activation at Rotary Park, leveraging Ajax's waterfront as an economic and community asset. Its format encouraged organic interaction in a relaxed setting, differentiating it from conventional indoor networking events while reinforcing the connection between local business engagement and public space activation.

The Business Holiday Mixer, delivered in partnership with the Ajax-Pickering Board of Trade at the St. Francis Centre, welcomed 14 attendees. Although smaller in scale, the event reinforced municipal and Board of Trade collaboration and maintained year-end engagement with local professionals during a traditionally busy period.

In addition to the ABN series, three supplementary business engagement events were delivered to broaden outreach and address targeted community needs. These included a Black History Month Trivia Night delivered in collaboration with the Equity, Diversity and Inclusion team; a JamFest Information Session with Pickering Village businesses to collect operational feedback and improve event coordination; You Don't Have to Go It Alone: Tools for Solo Entrepreneurs, delivered in partnership with the Ajax Public Library and BReady to support entrepreneurs. Collectively, these initiatives expanded engagement formats and strengthened dialogue with diverse segments of the business community.

1.6 Continuous improvement of engagement tools, including the identification of business champions in different sectors and a formal business visitation program

Last year, staff significantly enhanced the Town's business engagement efforts through an expanded and structured visitation program. More than 300 in-person business visits were conducted throughout the year, including over 230 restaurant visits as part of the Ajax Culinary Guide initiative, during which every restaurant in Ajax was visited and

surveyed. In addition, approximately 30 manufacturer visits were completed, along with 38 grand opening visits, one groundbreaking and 11 business anniversary visits to celebrate local business milestones. Staff also participated in multiple facility tours, including Shandex, Safran, Triforest, and Maple Furniture. These visits supported relationship-building, issue identification and resolution, data collection, information sharing on Town programs, and enhanced communication with the local business community.

The Business Champions initiative has been identified as a priority for 2026 and will align with the Powered by Ajax campaign to further strengthen sector-based engagement and peer advocacy within the business community.

The Town also leveraged the CoStar commercial real estate data platform to support investment attraction and business retention efforts. In 2025, staff generated 50 customized commercial property reports for companies exploring relocation, expansion, or establishment opportunities within Ajax. Prospective businesses were connected with local commercial real estate brokers to support transaction facilitation. To maximize the platform's effectiveness, staff completed eight formal training sessions totaling more than 10 hours with the CoStar representative. These efforts have improved access to real-time market data, enhanced responsiveness to investor inquiries, and strengthened the Town's capacity to support commercial growth.

Goal 2: Build Potential

Goal 2 focuses on building the capacity and competitiveness of Ajax's existing business community by strengthening sector supports, enhancing tourism development, improving data collection, and creating new tools to support long-term sustainability and growth.

2.1 Reinvest film permit revenue to increase profile in film industry, driving economic growth

The Town continues to actively support film production activity in Ajax2570 by maintaining an efficient and responsive permitting process. Staff coordinate site visits, assist with logistics, and provide timely communication to production companies to ensure a positive experience for both industry partners and the surrounding community. Last year, the Town approved four film permits, generating $2,579 in non-tax revenue. These productions brought 122 crew members and 26 cast members to Ajax, contributing to local economic activity through on-site spending and related services.

A portion of the revenue collected was reinvested into industry development and promotional initiatives delivered in partnership with Durham Region Film and municipal film offices. Ajax participated in two key film-related events: Your Locations. Their Next Film and The Way Home Bus Tour. The Your Locations. Their Next Film seminar educated homeowners and businesses on how to market their properties as potential filming locations, covering topics such as location marketing, site visits and scouting, preparing for productions, film-friendly practices, and understanding production company responsibilities.

Ajax also participated in The Way Home Bus Tour, a regional initiative highlighting filming locations from the Hallmark television series The Way Home, which was filmed in Durham Region. The Town's waterfront was featured as one of the tour stops, and Ajax contributed $500 as a lunch sponsor. The event brought visitors to the community, increased awareness of Ajax as a filming destination, and supported regional collaboration among five Durham municipalities.

Additionally, the Town supported the Durham Region International Film Festival through promotional assistance, including social media and e-blast communications, further reinforcing Ajax's commitment to growing its profile within the film and television industry.

2.2 Understand and leverage potential to support not-for-profits as part of Ajax Business Community

As part of the Ajax26 Strategic Plan under *Advance Innovation and Investment (2.1 Facilitate Business Retention and Expansion)*, Council identified the need to better understand and support the Town's Not-for-Profit (NFP) sector as a component of the broader business ecosystem. In response, the BE&S team initiated a Not-for-Profit Business Support Study in 2025 to assess sector capacity, identify challenges, and explore opportunities for enhanced municipal support.

To undertake this work, the BE&S team partnered with Ontario Tech University through the CityStudio Durham program, leveraging post-secondary research capacity to conduct sector analysis. A total of 26 not-for-profit organizations were contacted and invited to participate in a survey, with 10 organizations submitting responses. The study has now been completed, and the findings have been compiled into the Not-for-Profit Sector Report for internal use.

The report confirms that Ajax's NFP sector plays a vital role in delivering essential community services, including housing, youth supports, food security, seniors' services, culture, recreation, and health programming. While respondents reported generally positive working relationships with the Town, many indicated they are operating at or near capacity due to increased demand driven by population growth.

Key challenges identified include limited public awareness of services, unstable funding, access to affordable and appropriate facilities, and shortages of staff and volunteers. The report also identifies clear opportunities for municipal action, including improved communication, enhanced promotion of NFP programs, increased access to Town facilities, and stronger coordination between organizations.

The completion of this study establishes a baseline understanding of the sector and positions the Town to determine next steps in strengthening its convening and connector role to support long-term sector sustainability and community impact.

2.3 Implement the Municipal Accommodation Tax and invest revenue, leveraging partnership with Durham Tourism

In 2025, the Town of Ajax implemented the Municipal Accommodation Tax (MAT), a local levy applied to hotels, motels, and short-term rental accommodations through providers such as Airbnb and VRBO. The purpose of the tax is to generate revenue to support local tourism initiatives. Under Ontario Regulation 435/17, Transient Accommodation Tax, 50% of MAT revenue, after administrative costs, must be directed to an Eligible Tourism Entity for destination marketing programming, with the remainder retained by the municipality to fund tourism initiatives. In Ajax, Durham Tourism will serve as the designated Eligible Tourism Entity.

Remittances began in April 2025. Prior to this date, Town staff conducted business visits to establish relationships, introduced the program, and provided guidance on incorporating the tax into daily operations. The Town collected a total of $488,650.51 in MAT revenue last year. Three hotels and two short-term rental operators are currently remitting the tax. An internal MAT policy was developed to govern administration and use of the funds.

MAT revenue in 2025 directly supported community events, including $31,545.58 for the Drone Show and $29,363.41 for the Fairgrounds Grand Opening. These investments demonstrate the tangible community benefits of the program while strengthening the Town's partnership with Durham Tourism and supporting Ajax's broader tourism development strategy.

2.4 Develop and launch a business licensing program

A Business Licensing Program was originally contemplated in the 2021–2025 Economic Development Action Plan to create a universal licensing system for all businesses operating in Ajax, with the primary objective of improving business data collection. Accurate and up-to-date business data supports a range of economic development priorities, including enhanced business intelligence, investment attraction, inclusive growth, economic impact tracking, community engagement, and informed policy and funding advocacy.

The initiative has since been reimagined as a voluntary Business Registration Program, branded as Powered by Ajax. This registration-based approach is designed to capture data from as many businesses as possible, including small and home-based businesses, while offering tangible benefits to participants. The program provides a streamlined onboarding process, direct access to Town resources and support services, and improved data collection to better understand emerging sectors and business needs. By adopting a voluntary model, the Town can strengthen engagement, offer new value and perks to businesses, and support proactive economic development planning without imposing unnecessary regulatory burdens.

The first stage of Powered by Ajax will launch in Q1 2026, focusing on targeted outreach to gather feedback and build awareness. The first major promotional event will be a networking and information mixer planned for March 2026. A one-time registration fee of $25 will be collected in accordance with the Town's User Fee By-law. This program will create opportunities for deeper relationships between the Town and the local business community, ensuring businesses are informed of programs, funding

opportunities, licensing requirements, and engagement opportunities, while enhancing the Town's capacity to support and grow the local economy.

2.5 Provide education and engagement sessions on areas of importance to local businesses, including community safety, technology, tariffs and export diversification, sustainability and partnerships

In 2025, the Town conducted targeted education and engagement outreach for local businesses on critical topics including community safety, technology adoption, tariffs and export diversification, sustainability, and strategic partnerships. Between March and May, over 40 companies, primarily steel, aluminum, and large-scale manufacturers, were engaged via email and phone to collect feedback on the impact of rising tariffs, import and export challenges, and supply chain pressures. Key insights included concerns about increasing costs of imports and exports, potential revenue losses from delayed purchase orders, hoarding of raw materials, limited availability of local or Canadian suppliers, and uncertainty regarding tariff exemptions. While two to three businesses indicated they see these challenges as opportunities, many expressed interest in diversifying trade portfolios beyond the United States and requested more information and access to resources on tariffs. Staff provided guidance and connected businesses with local supplier networks to help mitigate risks.

In addition, over 20 automotive industry companies received targeted engagement, including in-person visits and correspondence. Federal funding opportunities such as the Regional Tariff Response Initiative were shared, and letters of support were prepared to assist companies in securing funding. These efforts demonstrate the Town's commitment to proactive business support, helping local companies navigate regulatory and market challenges while fostering long-term growth and resilience in key industrial sectors.

2.6 Partner on and develop targeted communications to support local restaurants, including a Food Guide

On October 16, 2025, the Town launched Made in Ajax: The Ultimate Culinary Guide, showcasing more than 230 restaurants across the community and highlighting the flavours, stories, and people behind Ajax's vibrant culinary scene. The initiative significantly expanded the Town's engagement with the restaurant sector and provided new visibility and marketing opportunities for local businesses. Staff conducted visits to all 230 restaurants, completed 70 surveys, organized 25 photoshoots, and conducted 13 interviews, with seven featured in the culinary guide.

The Town hosted a soft launch event on October 15 at the Durham Convention Center, inviting restaurant owners who participated in surveys, photoshoots, and interviews. Pages from the guide were displayed on large easels in a gallery-style format, and a total of 70 attendees participated. The event successfully celebrated the collaborative effort involved in creating the guide and allowed restaurant owners to experience the excitement of seeing their contributions come to life.

Digital copies of the guide are available at ajax.ca/MadeInAjax, and printed copies are being sold for $5 at all Town facilities. Since last year, the guide has received 4,039

webpage views and generated $295 in printed sales. Digital engagement metrics indicate strong community interest, with the guide receiving over 45,000 views on Instagram. This initiative supports the Town's economic development priorities by promoting local business, increasing community awareness, and fostering stronger connections between the Town and the restaurant industry.

Goal 3: Facilitate Growth

Goal 3 focuses on positioning Ajax for long-term economic growth through improved data collection, tourism prioritization, corporate partnerships, and evidence-based decision-making. Several initiatives under Goal 3 are currently underway and will continue to advance into 2026.

3.3 Establish corporate priorities and focus areas for tourism (including eco-tourism, sport tourism, etc.)

In 2026, the Town will place increased emphasis on tourism development, including sport tourism, film tourism and event-based opportunities. A dedicated tourism microsite will be developed to centralize information on attractions, accommodations and experiences in Ajax. The FIFA World Cup 2026 presents a significant opportunity to attract visitors, and the Town plans to host watch parties and related activations to encourage visitors to experience Ajax.

Sport tourism will remain a priority, with several events already scheduled, including the Jim Lutton 13U House League Tournament in July. The Town is currently in discussions to potentially host the Over-60 Cricket World Cup in August, which would attract international participants and visitors if confirmed. In addition, the Town is actively preparing a bid, in collaboration with Durham municipalities, to host the 55+ Ontario Summer Games in 2029. Staff will also continue promoting Ajax's sports fields, diamonds and pitches to regional and national organizers to expand future tournament opportunities.

To maximize impact, the Town will work closely with Central Counties Tourism and Durham Tourism to promote tourism assets and strengthen regional collaboration.

3.4 Implement quantitative tracking and analysis for amenity, event and key business areas to drive future decision-making

The BE&S team will expand the Town's capacity for data-driven decision-making by implementing quantitative tracking and analysis of amenities, events, and key business sectors. Staff have connected with Central Counties Tourism to explore their existing data collection and GIS tracking software, which will inform future planning and investment priorities. This initiative will enable the Town to evaluate the performance and impact of programs, optimize resource allocation, and identify emerging opportunities for growth in both the business and tourism sectors.

Financial Implications:

NA

Communication Issues:

Biannual progress reports will continue to be presented to Council to communicate updates and achieved/completed actions.

Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

The report aligns with Action26, specifically that Town's goals related to strengthening local economic growth, enhancing community engagement and modernizing service delivery.

Conclusion:

The Town has made significant progress in 2025 towards advancing the strategic goals of enhancing business engagement, supporting sector development and improving access to municipal resources. Continued implementation of the Business Engagement & Support Strategy will further strengthen partnerships, improve service delivery and support long-term economic resilience in Ajax. In 2025 alone, staff conducted more than 300 business visits, delivered 10 engagement events, generated $488,650 in Municipal Accommodation Tax revenue, supported four film productions, and achieved over 277,000 digital impressions promoting Ajax businesses.

Attachments:

NA

Prepared by:

Meina Lutfi, Business Engagement Advisor

Submitted by:

Christie McLardie – Director of Public & Strategic Affairs

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

Town of Ajax Report
Open Session

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Christie McLardie, Director of Public and Strategic Affairs
Report Number:	PSA-2026-03
Subject:	2022-2026 Strategic Plan (Action26) Update
Wards:	All Wards
Date of Meeting:	March 9, 2026
Reference:	PSA-2025-02, PSA-2024-06, CAO-2023-05

Recommendation:

That the 2022–2026 Strategic Plan (Action26) Update be received for information.

Background:

Strategic plans play a critical role in guiding municipal decision-making and shaping annual plans and budgets. In March 2023, Ajax Council approved the Action26 Strategic Plan for the 2022-2026 term. The plan outlined 13 Council priorities and 176 supporting actions, distributed as follows:

- 44 actions in 2023
- 48 actions in 2024
- 20 actions in 2025
- 11 actions in 2026
- 53 actions marked as ongoing

As of April 2025, the Action26 plan stood at 170 actions, following adjustments made to accommodate competing projects, new priorities, available resources, and funding. At that time,

- 74 actions were marked complete
- 41 actions were initiated
- 46 actions were ongoing (a project without a completion date)
- 9 actions had not been initiated.

For additional details on the Action26 Strategic Plan, including the full list of progress reports, please visit ajax.ca/action26.

Discussion:

This update provides Council with a snapshot of the progress of the Ajax26 plan between April 2025 and March 2026 to ensure ongoing alignment with the municipality's strategic objectives.

In addition to reconfirming priorities and actions, regular strategic plan reviews allow Council and staff to contemplate new areas of focus, communicate issues and recognize significant accomplishments. This responsive and fluid approach is designed to make adjustments seamless and is critical to keep the plan current for stakeholders and the community.

A full report on the status of each action is provided in Appendix 1. Below is a summary of the noteworthy changes stemming from the review and update.

Connecting our Community (original 65 actions)

1. Increase and amplify creative and innovative opportunities (6 actions)
2. Encourage community pride (12 actions)
3. Improve well-being and quality of life (24 actions)
4. Foster a safe and welcoming community (15 actions)
5. Champion inclusion, diversity, equity and accessibility (8 actions)

Progress changes:

- Deleted 5.1.2 (Investigate new Flagpole at Town Hall Complex) as the community flagpole program is run from Pat Bayly Square.

Below is the status of Connecting our Community as of March 2026:

- The number of actions decreased from 65 to 64
- 47 actions have been completed
- 3 actions have been initiated and 14 are ongoing

Accomplishments include:

- Updated the Street Naming Bylaw and Commemorative Naming Policy
- Completed the Mayor and Council Community BBQ tour
- Hosted a 70th Anniversary Drone show at the opening of the Town's new Fairgrounds
- Developed a Community Sport Affiliation Policy
- Initiated work on a Indigenous Consultation Policy

Growing our Community (original 55 actions)

1. Embrace dynamic and sustainable growth (24 actions)
2. Advance innovation and investment (10 actions)
3. Invest in the changing recreational needs of a growing community (21 actions)

Progress changes:

- Deleted 1.1.7 (Town-Wide Parking Master Plan) as project was unfunded
- Deleted 3.1.6 (Fire Station Location Study) as project was unfunded
- Deleted 3.1.7 (Assess Opportunities to Expand Parking at Greenwood Conservation Area) as additional parking is no longer a priority post-COVID

Below is the status of Growing our Community as of March 2026:

- The number of actions decreased from 55 to 52
- 35 actions have been completed
- 4 actions have been initiated and 13 are ongoing

Accomplishments include:

- Launched new Planning Application Dashboard
- Partnered with the Region of Durham on District Energy Feasibility Study
- Completed Not-for-Profit Business Support Study
- Launched Made in Ajax: The Ultimate Culinary Guide, showcasing more than 230 restaurants in Town
- Completed the Harwood Ave Multi Use Path

Modernizing our Community (original 50 actions)

1. Lead the green transition (15 actions)
2. Rethink the way we communicate (8 actions)
3. Equip our workforce for the future (11 actions)
4. Ready our organization for the future (8 actions)
5. Demonstrate sound financial management (9 actions)

Progress changes:

- Delete 1.1.3 (Climate Response Plan / Extreme Weather Service Alert Process) as focus has been on understanding climate risks and considering flood mitigation measures

Below is the status of Modernizing our Community as of March 2026:

- The number of actions decreased from 50 to 49
- 33 actions have been completed
- 3 actions have been initiated and 13 are ongoing

Accomplishments include:

- Completed the Town’s first Corporate Net Zero Emissions Plan
- Developed an HR Strategy
- Launched Workday, the new HR Management System

- Made investments in new GIS and Cybersecurity
- Launched an integrated customer service platform
- Implemented the Administrative Monetary Penalty System program

Overall update with progress changes

- The number of actions sits at 165 (reduction from 170)
- 115 actions are complete (70% complete)
- 10 actions have been initiated
- 40 projects are ongoing

Financial Implications:

There are no financial implications related to the recommendations in this report.

Communication Issues:

A final progress report will be provided to Council at the September General Government Committee meeting. This will be the final report of the plan.

The Action26 webpage (ajax.ca/action26) will be updated to reflect the updates provided herein.

Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

2022-2026 Strategic Plan (Action26)

Conclusion:

Council and the community can be proud of the progress of Action26 since its launch in 2023. Seventy percent of the plan is complete, representing 115 of the current 165 actions, while 10 have been initiated and 40 projects are ongoing. All initiatives are “in action.”

Attachments:

ATT-1: 2022-2026 Strategic Plan Update

Prepared by:

Christie McLardie – Director of Public and Strategic Affairs

Submitted by:

Christie McLardie – Director of Public & Strategic Affairs

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

ATT-1 Update

March 2025 to March 2026

2022-2026
Strategic Plan

Action 26

presented by
Ajax Council

Town of Ajax By the Lake

ATT-1

Action Status:

Complete: Indicates that the action has been largely achieved, but may still see further developments or refinements.

Ongoing: These are actions that are still being carried out or will continue in the future. There is no specific end date**.**

Initiated: The action has begun but is still in the early stages or planning phase.

Not Initiated: These actions have not yet started.

Highlighted Content: Indicates a change reported.

1. Connecting our Community

1. Increase and amplify creative and innovative opportunities

1.1 Promote creativity, learning and growth in arts and culture

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Arts and Culture Plan	Complete	Complete	Complete
Ajax Sign at Pat Bayly Square	Complete	Complete	Complete
St. Francis Centre Promotional Campaign	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete
Local Artist Recognition (Indigenous and Youth)	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing
EngAge Arts Program for Seniors	Complete	Complete	Complete
Enhance Cultural Programming	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete

2. Encourage community pride

2.1 Acknowledge and celebrate our local history and culture

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Archives Expansion and Promotion	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete
Establish and Cultivate Cultural Group Connections	2024	Not initiated	Initiated

2.2 Recognize outstanding individuals and groups

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Street Naming By-law Update	Initiated	Initiated	Complete
Commemorative Naming of Municipal Parks and Buildings Policy Update	2025	Initiated	Complete

Library Volunteer Recognition Program	Complete	Complete	Complete

2.3 Enhance community engagement opportunities

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Mayor & Council Community BBQ	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete
Outdoor Pop-up Performances	2024	Initiated	Ongoing
Town Hall School Tours	2024	Complete	Complete
Heritage Site Tours (i.e. Doors Open Ajax & Jane's Walk)	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete
Festival and Special Events Enhancements	2025	Initiated	Ongoing
Placemaking Opportunities and Campaigns	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing
Community Gardens Education and Support (i.e. Green Living Days, SNAP, Sustainability Website)	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete

3. Improve well-being and quality of life

3.1 Support and promote active and accessible transportation

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Seniors/Youth Busing Program Report	2024	Complete	Complete
Trail and Bike Connections	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing
Sidewalk Infill Program	2024	Complete	Complete
Pedal Bike Camps Review	2025	Initiated	Complete
Transportation Demand Management Plan	Complete	Complete	Complete
Bike Repair Stations	Complete	Complete	Complete
#GetAjaxMoving Diversity Campaign	Complete	Complete	Complete
Bicycle Friendly Communities Gold Certification Feasibility Study	2025	Initiated	Complete
E-Scooters and E-Bike Pilot	Initiated	Complete	Complete
Build Relationships and Partnerships with Local Agencies (Metrolinx, Region, Durham Transit, etc.)	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete

3.2 Provide services and resources to vulnerable and underrepresented communities

Action	**Status –** June ‘24	**Status –** March ‘25	**Status** – March ‘26
Ajax Emergency Shelter (Respite Centre) Partnership	Complete	Complete	Complete
Community Centre Shower Program	Complete	Complete	Complete
Social Services Access at Libraries	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete

3.3 Reimagine spaces for social and healthy interactions

Action	**Status –** June ‘24	**Status –** March ‘25	**Status** – March ‘26
Barrett Centre Urban Farm Partnership	Complete	Complete	Complete
Farmers Market Feasibility Study	Complete	Complete	Complete
Leash Free Parks (Design Specifications Review)	Ongoing	Complete	Complete
Outdoor Skating Options Report	2024	Initiated	Initiated
Youth and Family Activities	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete

3.4 Implement positive mental and physical health initiatives

Action	**Status –** June ‘24	**Status –** March ‘25	**Status** – March ‘26
Support Community-Based Mental Health Initiatives	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete
Expansion of Group Fitness Class Programs	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete
Addition of Girls Only Programming (specifically in sport)	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete

3.5 Invest in partnerships to advance strategic priorities

Action	**Status –** June ‘24	**Status –** March ‘25	**Status** – March ‘26
Community Sport Affiliation Policy	Initiated	Initiated	Complete
Ajax Partnership Fund Implementation and Reporting	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing
In-kind Facility and Amenity Rental Policy	Complete	Complete	Complete

4. Foster a safe and welcoming community

4.1 Increase a sense of safety and security for the community

Action	**Status –** June ‘24	**Status –** March ‘25	**Status** – March ‘26
Local Community Safety Action Plan	2024	Not initiated	Initiated

Corporate Security Assessment Implementation (Security Patrol Review, Sharps Management, CCTV Cameras, Park & Walkway Lighting Review)	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing
Encampment Safety and Clearing Protocols Policy	Initiated	Complete	Complete
Neighbourhood Programs	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing
Support Agencies, Community Groups, Service Providers, etc	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing
Crime Reporting Education	Initiated	Complete	Complete
Community Safety Staff Resource	Complete	Complete	Complete
Ajax Fire & Emergency Services Emergency Response Review & By-law Update	Initiated	Initiated	Complete
Ajax Fire & Emergency Services Apparatus	2025	Initiated	Complete

4.2 Continue to implement traffic calming initiatives

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Automated Speed Enforcement Progress Report	Complete	Complete	Complete
Community Safety Zones Review and Implementation	Complete	Complete	Complete
Traffic and Intersection Data Collection	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing
School Signage Review and Pilot	Complete	Complete	Complete

4.3 Increase beautification efforts throughout the Town

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Park Waste Collection Review	2025	Initiated	Ongoing
Waste Awareness Campaign	Initiated	Complete	Complete

5. Champion inclusion, diversity, equity and accessibility (IDEA)

5.1 Continuously improve our IDEA programs

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Anti-Racism Task Force Implementation	Complete	Complete	Complete
Investigate new Flagpole at Town Hall Complex	2024	Initiated	Proposed for Deletion

Signature Diversity XChange Campaign	Complete	Complete	Complete
Indigenous Consultation Policy	Initiated	Initiated	Ongoing
Abilities Centre's LEAD (Leading Equitable and Accessible Delivery) Program	Complete	Complete	Complete
Emergency Preparedness Program for Seniors and People with Disabilities	Complete	Complete	Complete
Age-Friendly/Accessibility Resources for Businesses	2025	Initiated	Ongoing
General Awareness of Emergency Preparedness	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing

2. Growing our Community

1. Embrace dynamic and sustainable growth

1.1 Advance our vision for community growth

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Community Benefits Charge Strategy	Complete	Complete	Complete
Comprehensive Zoning By-law Review	Initiated	Initiated	Ongoing
Community Improvement Plans (Downtown and PV)	Complete	Complete	Complete
Official Plan Review & Ajax Plaza Redevelopment Masterplan	Initiated (HAF)	Initiated (HAF)	Initiated (HAF)
Ajax GO Station Area Specific Study	Initiated (HAF)	Initiated (HAF)	Ongoing (HAF)
Residential Parking Permit Feasibility Study	Complete	Complete	Complete
Town-Wide Parking Master Plan	2026	Not initiated	Unfunded

1.2 Streamline processes and approvals for development

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Explore Online Services (i.e. Mapping Tool & Planning Portal)	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete
Site Plan Review - Technical Guidelines	Initiated	Complete	Complete
Prioritization of Planning Applications within Strategic Areas	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing

Development Review Teams Pilot Program Update	Initiated	Complete	Complete

1.3 Continue the revitalization of Downtown Ajax

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Hunt Street / Dowty Road Servicing Interim Project	Initiated	Initiated	Complete
Hunt Street Environmental Assessment Addendum	Complete	Complete	Complete
District Energy Feasibility Study	2026	Initiated	Complete

1.4 Engage the community on intensification projects

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Intensification Education Series	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete
Communications Strategy for Planning Projects	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing

1.5 Improve road transportation network

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Road Rationalization	Complete	Complete	Complete
Harwood Avenue North Environmental Assessment, Design & Construction	Initiated	Initiated	Ongoing
Rossland Road East Design	Initiated	Initiated	Ongoing
Integrated Transportation Master Plan Update	2025	Not initiated	Initiated

1.6 Continue to monitor and respond to legislative changes

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Provincial Legislation (Bill 23 and Bill 109)	Ongoing	Complete	Complete

1.7 Encourage mixed use development with a focus on affordable, attainable and purpose-built housing

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Explore Opportunities with Developers, Not-for-Profits and Other Stakeholders	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing
Ajax Housing Strategy and Action Plan	Complete	Complete	Complete
Municipal Housing Pledge	Complete	Complete	Complete

2. Advance innovation and investment

2.1 Facilitate business retention and expansion

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Business Retention & Expansion Program Initiation	Complete	Complete	Complete
Business Engagement Strategy	Complete	Complete	Complete
Business Mentor Roster Recruitment	Ongoing	Complete	Complete
Ajax Business Profile Video Series	Ongoing	Complete	Complete
Not-For-Profit Business Support Study	2025	Not initiated	Complete

2.2 Support adaptation to a changing economy

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Post Secondary Student Business Program	Initiated	Complete	Complete
Advocate for Smart Cities Initiatives & AI Initiatives	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing

2.3 Promote Ajax as a tourism destination

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Tourism Webpage Update	2024	Complete	Complete
Tourism Revenue Opportunities Report	Initiated	Complete	Complete
Highlight Diversity in Tourism	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete

3. Invest in the changing recreational needs of a growing community

3.1 Initiate designs to modernize and redevelop facilities

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Fairgrounds Feasibility and Design Study	Complete	Complete	Complete
Rotary Park Pavilion Feasibility Study & Improvements	Initiated	Initiated	Ongoing
Library Master Plan (2023-2028)	Complete	Complete	Complete
Ajax Community Centre Renovation Design, Ajax Wall of Fame Concept, & Facility Accessibility Standards Update	2024 (HAF)	Initiated	Initiated
Library Makerspace	Complete	Complete	Complete
Fire Station Location Study & Existing Fire Facilities Review	2026	Not initiated	Unfunded

Assess Opportunities to Expand Parking at Greenwood Conservation Area	Initiated	Initiated	Proposed for Deletion

3.2 Enhance facilities and programming for seniors

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
St. Andrew's Community Centre Feasibility Study & Facility Accessibility Standards Update	Initiated	Initiated	Complete
Snow Clearing Assistance Program Review and Report	Complete	Complete	Complete
Review of Operating Model for Seniors	Initiated	Complete	Complete
Pickering Village Municipal Complex Master Plan	Initiated (HAF)	Initiated (HAF)	Ongoing (HAF)

3.3 Expand amenities and programs for diverse communities

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Ajax CC Cricket Club House & Field of Play	Initiated	Complete	Complete
New North Cricket Wicket at St. Patrick Park	Complete	Complete	Complete
Library Satellite at Grandview Headquarters	2025	Complete	Complete

3.4 Construct new parks and public spaces

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Ajax CC Park Redevelopment (Basketball Courts and Skateboard Park)	Initiated	Initiated	Ongoing
Annandale Park and Trail Design	Initiated	Initiated	Ongoing
Cedar Park Batting Cage	Complete	Complete	Complete
Park Retrofits (St. Catherine of Siena Park, Lord Elgin Park, Exeter Park, etc.)	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing
Durham Meadoway Consultation	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete
Castlefields Park & Splashpad	2026	Not initiated	Initiated
Harwood Avenue Multi Use Path (MUP)	2024	Initiated	Complete

3. Modernizing our Community

1. Lead the green transition

1.1 Take meaningful climate action

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Green Advocacy	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing
Green Fleet Strategy (including EV Charging Stations)	Initiated	Complete	Complete
Climate Response Plan / Extreme Weather Service Alert Process	2024	Not initiated	Proposed for Deletion
Flood Mitigation Measures	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing
Ajax Climate Risk and Resiliency Plan (5-year Update)	Initiated	Complete	Complete
Energy Conservation and Demand Management Plan (5-year Update)	Initiated	Complete	Complete

1.2 Raise awareness of environmentally friendly practices and programs

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Single-Use Plastics Education	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete
Pet Waste Diversion in Parks Feasibility Report	Complete	Complete	Complete

1.3 Preserve and enhance green spaces and water quality

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Urban Forest Strategy	Complete	Complete	Complete
Ajax Waterfront Erosion Mitigation Project	Initiated	Complete	Complete
Duffin Creek Water Pollution Control Plant Expansion Advocacy	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing
Greenwood Conservation Area Toronto Region Conservation Authority Management Agreement	Initiated	Initiated	Ongoing
Naturalization and Restoration Plan	Initiated	Complete	Complete
Corporate Net Zero Emissions Plan	2024	Initiated	Complete

2. Rethink the way we communicate

2.1 Implement innovative communication technologies and tools

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26

Review of Traditional Communications Tools	Initiated	Complete	Complete
Digital Recreation Guide	2024	Initiated	Initiated
TOA Talks Podcast	Complete	Complete	Complete
Social Media Policy Update	Complete	Complete	Complete
Electronic Signs Report	Complete	Complete	Complete
Online Facility & Outdoor Spaces Booking and Tour	Complete	Complete	Complete
GPS Fleet Dashcam Project (relaunch of Track My Plow App)	Complete	Complete	Complete
Ajax Website Redesign	2025	Initiated	Initiated

3. Equip our workforce for the future

3.1 Prioritize proactive recruitment

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Staff Investment	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete
Investigate Apprentice and Intern Programs	Initiated	Complete	Complete
Recruitment Campaigns and Pilots	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing

3.2 Continue to be an employer of choice

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
HR Strategy & Corporate Succession Strategy	2025	Initiated	Complete
Non Union Compensation Review Implementation	Complete	Complete	Complete
DEI Supports and Workforce Census Implementation	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing
Human Resource Management System	2025	Initiated	Complete
Hybrid Workplace Policy	Complete	Complete	Complete
Talent Management Initiative	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing
Exempt Working Conditions Review	2025	Initiated	Initiated

4. Ready our organization for the future

4.1 Plan for and define critical corporate processes

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26

Records and Information Strategy and Information Security/Privacy Program	Initiated	Complete	Complete
GIS Strategy Implementation/Advancements in Data Governance and Use	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete
Invest in Cybersecurity	Ongoing	Complete	Complete

4.2 Ensure an efficient and effective service delivery

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Accommodation Modifications	Initiated	Initiated	Ongoing
Explore Council Chambers Retrofit Feasibility	2025	Initiated	Complete
Customer Service Strategy	Complete	Complete	Complete
Customer Relationship Management Software	2026	Initiated	Complete
Continuous Improvement Initiatives	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing

5. Demonstrate sound financial management

5.1 Manage financial resources and assets to address growing needs

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Development Charge By-law Program	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing
Infrastructure Management (Stormwater Management Fee, Infrastructure Levy, Asset Management Plan, etc.)	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete
Procurement Updates (Supplier Outreach Program & Purchasing By-law Update)	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete
Financial Systems and Processes Review	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing
Financial Sustainability Plan Update	2026	Initiated	Ongoing
Online Property Tax Portal	Initiated	Initiated	Complete

5.2 Anticipate and respond to risks and opportunities

Action	**Status –** June '24	**Status –** March '25	**Status** – March '26
Bill 23 Financial Impact Review	Ongoing	Ongoing	Complete
Annual Internal Audit Program	Complete	Complete	Complete

Non-tax Revenue Opportunities (i.e. Naming Rights)	Ongoing	Ongoing	Ongoing
AMPS (Administrative Monetary Penalty System) Program	2024	Initiated	Complete

Town of Ajax Report
Open Session

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Sarah Webster, Financial Analyst
Report Number:	FIN-2026-03
Subject:	2025 Statement of Remuneration and Expenses for Members of Council and Council Appointees
Wards:	All Wards
Date of Meeting:	March 9, 2026
Reference:	Section 284 (1) of the Municipal Act, 2001, S.O. 2001

Recommendation:

That the 2025 Statement of Remuneration and Expenses for Members of Council and Council Appointees be received for information.

Background:

Section 284(1) of the *Municipal Act, 2001* states that:

"The treasurer of a municipality shall in each year on or before March 31 provide to the council of the municipality an itemized statement of remuneration and expenses paid in the previous year to:

a) Each member of council in respect of his or her services as a member of the council or any other body, including a local board, to which the member has been appointed by or on which the member holds office by virtue of being a member of council;

b) Each member of council in respect of his or her services as an officer or employee of the municipality or other body described in clause (a); and

c) Each person, other than a member of council, appointed by the municipality to serve as a member of any body, including a local board, in respect of his or her services as a member of the body."

Discussion:

Information concerning the Ajax Council appointees was obtained directly from Elexicon and the Ajax Public Library Board. For the Town's Committees, the information was available from the Finance Department's records.

The 2025 statement of remuneration and expenses is presented in Attachment #1.

Financial Implications:

None

Communication Issues:

None

Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

N/A

Conclusion:

In accordance with the requirements of the Municipal Act, 2001, the attached statement has been prepared and submitted to Council by the March 31, 2026 deadline.

Attachment(s):

ATT-1: Statement of Remuneration & Expenses

Prepared by:

Sarah Webster, Financial Analyst

Submitted by:

Julie Mepham – Acting Director of Finance

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

Council Remuneration Report

Authorized under By-law 97-2025 and Policy 030 Elected Officials Compensation and Expenses

Table A - Members of Council

Member's Name	Remuneration/ Benefits	Travel Allowance	Communication/ Meeting Expenses	Education / Training	Hannover Messe Tradeshow	HMS Ajax & River Plate Veterans Association	AMO Board Appointment
S. Collier	$171,693.27	$15,954.86	$1,517.09	$0.00	$1,262.81 (net of $6,000 grant)	$7,325.57	$0.00
M. Crawford	71,701.64	10,013.23	3,397.04	-	-	-	3,961.22
S. Lee	81,988.37	10,013.12	3,659.34	75.51	-	-	-
J. Dies	66,059.28	10,013.12	3,205.82	112.56	-	-	-
R. Morin	74,881.61	10,013.12	666.11	2,435.62	-	4,061.49	-
N. Henry	73,685.48	10,013.12	3,674.01	1,819.77	-	-	-
L. Bower	69,100.69	10,013.12	3,453.36	2,248.34	-	-	-
Total	**$609,110.34**	**$76,033.69**	**$19,572.77**	**$6,691.80**	**$1,262.81**	**$11,387.06**	**$3,961.22**

Table B - Ajax Council Appointees - Ajax Library Board

Ajax Library Board	
Member's Name	**Training / Meetings**
Sepelene Deonarine	$417.22
Voytek Bialkowski	-
Piyali Correya	417.22
Douglas Miller	-
Mallik Fernando	375.89
Deborah McDougall	86.50
Sterling Lee	-
Rebecca Hayes	-
Pia Kaukoranta	-
Total	**$1,296.83**

Table C - Ajax Council Appointees - Committee of Adjustment

Committee of Adjustment	
Member's Name	**Honorariums**
Wasif Ahmed	$825.00
Tomas Baca	825.00
Amanda Zara Dunn	900.00
Ken Elliott	825.00
Bernadette Santiago	600.00
Total	**$3,975.00**

Table D - Ajax Council Appointees - Animal Services/Property Standards Committee

Animal Services / Property Standards Committee	
Member's Name	**Honorariums**
Jessica Black	$150.00
Lyndsey Foster	-
Michelle Kinsella	150.00
Anderson Mendonca	75.00
Paul Went	150.00
Total	**$525.00**

Table E - Ajax Council Appointees - Advisory Committee

Heritage Advisory Committee	
Member's Name	**Honorariums**
Bruce Balsdon	$520.00
Helene Bellerose	130.00
Neil Burnett	520.00
Mitchell Daniels	585.00
Barbara Gilbert	195.00
Paul Hebert	260.00
Kristina Kessler	585.00
Patricia Matthews	2,537.47
Lisa Patel	260.00
Pam Pryjma	455.00
Stephen White	520.00
Jeff Wood	1,668.37
Rob Tyler-Morin	0.00
Total	**$8,235.84**

Table F - Ajax Council Appointees - Acessibility Advisory Committee

Accessibility Advisory Committee	
Member's Name	**Honorariums**
Heather Azzarello	$455.00
Kailey Danks	490.00
Sepelene Deonarine	390.00
Nancy Henry	-
Kenneth Kwong	390.00
Manas Khanna	360.00
Adrian Lambert	390.00
Jim Lawrence	390.00
Rosanne Purnwasie	195.00
Ray Smith	425.00
Kathreen Smith	390.00
Total	**$3,875.00**

Table G - Ajax Council Appointees - Compliance (Elections) Audit Committee

Compliance (Elections) Audit Committee	
Member's Name	**Honorariums**
Kalli Chapman	-
Kelly Gravelle	-
Paul Jones	-
Total	**-**

Table H - Anti-Racism Taskforce

Anti-Racism Taskforce	
Member's Name	**Honorariums**
Malcolm Barrington	$915.00
Alexia Brewing	790.00
Rabia Bhatia	790.00
Adrienne Glasgow	725.00
Naseer Khalid	790.00
Sabah Rahmath	790.00
Chantelle Vernon	850.00
Total	**$5,650.00**

Table I - Ajax Council Appointees - Elexicon Corporation

Elexicon Corporation			
Member's Name	**Remuneration**	**Training / Meetings**	**Total**
Shaun Collier	19,665.40	6,325.00	25,990.40
Total	**$19,665.40**	**$6,325.00**	**$25,990.40**

Town of Ajax Report
Open Session

Report To: General Government Committee

Prepared By: Susan Hewlett, Manager of Taxation

Report Number: FIN-2026-02

Subject: Tax Section Status Report

Wards: All Wards

Date of Meeting: March 9, 2026

Reference: N/A

Recommendation:

That the Tax Section Status Report be received for information.

Background:

To keep Council informed about matters affecting the Tax Section, including tax collection issues, statistics and delegated authority reporting, the Tax Section Status report is presented to the General Government Committee annually.

Discussion:

In 2025, Tax staff generated and mailed over 76,800 tax bills. This is a combination of interim, final and supplementary bills which generate the required revenue to support the annual operating budget. This translated into more than 245,000 payments being processed and balanced by Tax staff through in-person visits, electronic downloads, and pre-authorized payment files.

2025 Annual Taxes

2025 Annual Taxes - Collection Statistics – as of December 31, 2025

Total Taxes Billed for 2025	$329,797,761.42
Adjustments / Write-offs for 2025	$172,412.55
Amount Collected	$310,096,786.59
% Collected	93.98%
% Uncollected	6.02%

The % Collection is slightly lower than in 2024, which was 95.01%. The Town continues to meet all Regional and Education remittance timelines, with tax arrears being monitored and managed prudently within existing working capital.

Tax Arrears – Collection Statistics

As of December 31, 2025, approximately 97.5% of the annual 2024 taxes billed had been paid. This remains in line with previous reports.

While the total number of accounts in arrears did not decrease, there was an improvement in the reduction of “early Covid arrears (2020-2022)” accounts. Collection tools in 2025 continue to effectively lower properties with multi-year arrears. The following table illustrates the reduction in the number of properties whose arrears extended beyond one year prior to 2025.

Year End Comparison of Tax Accounts in Arrears

Year	# of Accounts Dec. 31, 2025	# of Accounts Dec. 31, 2024	Year-Over-Year Change
2016	1	2	-1
2017	6	6	0
2018	0	0	0
2019	0	1	-1
2020	2	8	-6
2021	9	55	-46
2022	101	343	-242
2023	502	1,020	-518
2024	1,039	7,210	-6,171
2025	7,510	n/a	n/a
Total	9,170	8,645	

Formal collection processes continue with hundreds of arrears accounts being reviewed, and formal collection letters issued for accounts with 2 years of arrears or more.

The Town generates penalty revenue from property tax arrears at a rate of 1.25% per month or 15% annually. For 2025, the budgeted amount for penalties and interest was $3,200,000; however, actual collections totaled $4,878,183. This increase is primarily attributable to the prevailing economic conditions contributing to a higher cost of living among property owners, including high mortgage rates and elevated costs for groceries.

Properties Registered for Land Tax Sale

Staff are committed to collaborating with taxpayers to establish payment arrangements that satisfy both parties and resolve outstanding arrears efficiently. If a property remains delinquent for three years and all collection efforts have been exhausted, it will be registered for Land Tax Sale (LTS). The LTS procedure is conducted through several

stages and, in accordance with the Municipal Act, typically requiring just over one year to finalize.

A total of 47 properties were in various stages of the tax sale process during 2025. As of December 31, 2025, 19 properties remained; 28 had been paid and the tax sale cancelled.

Pre-Authorized Payment Plans

The Town offers a range of pre-authorized payment (PAP) plans, which remain a popular option among taxpayers. Staff consistently encourage property owners, both via telephone and in person, to enroll in these programs. Additionally, the Ownership Change – Tax Information letter sent to new property owners includes a link to the PAP form. As larger mortgage companies increasingly discontinue the collection of property taxes, the Town has experienced a corresponding rise in PAP applications. Currently, over 11,750 properties are enrolled in the Town's pre-authorized plans, accounting for approximately 31% of all Ajax properties.

Online Property Tax Portal, Phone & Email Statistics

In May 2025, the Online Property Tax Portal was launched. This allows property owners to view their tax account information online, including current balance, upcoming due dates and payment history. As of December 31, 2025, there were 3,035 registered users. Staff continue to encourage owners to create an account, and there has been a steady increase in registrations since late-2025.

Enquiries to the Tax department remain steady. In 2025, staff received over 13,000 phone calls through the phone queue system and responded to more than 11,400 emails. Despite this volume, an 'Average Speed of Answer' for phone calls of 19 seconds, and a 'Service Level' of 90.4% for all calls received is maintained. With the launch of the online portal, a slight decrease in calls is being observed as owners now have 24/7 access to their accounts.

Assisting property owners with their taxes, particularly overdue taxes, can often be a sensitive subject for property owners. Staff effectively manage these conversations with empathy and professionalism, delivering a high standard of customer service while adhering to corporate standards.

Tax Certificates Online (TCOL)

Launched back in October 2022, TCOL allows legal professionals, mortgage companies, and other relevant parties to request tax certificates via a secure online portal. All requests are processed electronically, with certificates delivered to clients by email within minutes. Each certificate ordered electronically saves staff approximately 10 minutes of manual entry and approval time, equating to significant time savings.

Manual certificates are still issued to those lawyers who prefer, but portal usage continues to increase.

Comparison of Manual and Electronic Tax Certificate Requests

Year	Manual Requests	TCOL Requests	% of Total Requests that are TCOL
2023	136	611	82%
2024	114	775	87%
2025	75	871	92%

Delegated Authority and Tax Adjustment Reporting

By-law 75-2017 authorizes the Treasurer or Designate to process tax adjustments pursuant to the Municipal Act, 2001, as amended. The By-law further stipulates that all such adjustments must be reported to Council via the Tax Status Report.

The Municipal Property Assessment Corporation (MPAC) provides assessment adjustments to the Tax Section throughout the year. These can be a result of:

- Minutes of Settlement (MOS) / Assessment Review Board (ARB) decisions from owner appeals
- Post Roll Amended Notices (PRANS) from changes to a property after roll return (ex: updated square footage or change in legal description or use)
- Tax Incentive applications for properties that were approved for the Farm classification
- Responses to S.357 applications for properties which experienced fire, demolition or a class change

In addition, tax adjustments are also processed for charity and heritage rebate programs.

For 2025, Tax staff processed 146 account adjustments based on revised MPAC assessments; these are apportioned back to the Region and school boards as detailed below:

2025 Summary of Tax Adjustments

Reason for Adjustment	Town	Region	School Boards	Total
S.357's	$61,249.59	$103,903.96	$11,688.02	$176,841.57
PRANS	($306,594.58)	($521,623.60)	($72,778.65)	($900,996.83)
ARB / MOS	$173,151.22	$292,051.43	$153,346.25	$618,548.90
Tax Incentives	$0	$0	$0	$0
Charity Rebates	$31,141.14	$52,286.49	$45,663.01	$129,090.64
Heritage Rebates	$592.69	$0	$219.10	$811.79
Other	$0	$0	$0	$0
Total	**($40,459.94)**	**($73,381.72)**	**$138,137.73**	**$24,296.07**

Although this is not usually the case, the Town's overall tax adjustments led to more taxes being billed than removed. While the Town includes $425,000 in its budget to mitigate impacts of tax changes, net positive adjustments negated the requirement to use this provision in 2025.

Update on Property Assessment Values

MPAC typically sends Property Assessment Notices to all Ontario property owners every four years; however, reassessments are currently paused as the provincial government evaluates MPAC's processes. As a result, most properties will continue to use their 2016 Current Value Assessment (CVA) throughout 2026. Assessment changes will only happen if there is a "change event" like fire, addition, renovation, or new construction. The province has not indicated when reassessment will resume.

Financial Implications:

N/A

Communication Issues:

N/A

Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

N/A

Conclusion:

Tax Section staff continue to work collaboratively with Town residents to ensure positive collection results, in addition to actively working to protect our assessment base to mitigate tax adjustments.

Attachments:

N/A

Prepared by:

Susan Hewlett – Manager of Taxation

Submitted by:

Julie Mepham – Acting Director of Finance/Treasurer

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

Town of Ajax Report
Open Session

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Steven McReelis, Manager, Building Approvals & Chief Building Official
Report #:	PDS-2026-05
Subject:	**2025 Year End Building Permit Activity and 2026 Projection Report**
Ward(s):	All
Date of Meeting:	March 9, 2026
Reference:	N/A

Recommendation:

That the report entitled "2025 Year End Building Permit Activity and 2026 Projection Report", be received for information.

Background:

Annually, Planning and Development Services prepare a report summarizing building permit activity. This report highlights activity occurring between January 1st through December 31st, 2025, and provides an outlook on activity anticipated in 2026.

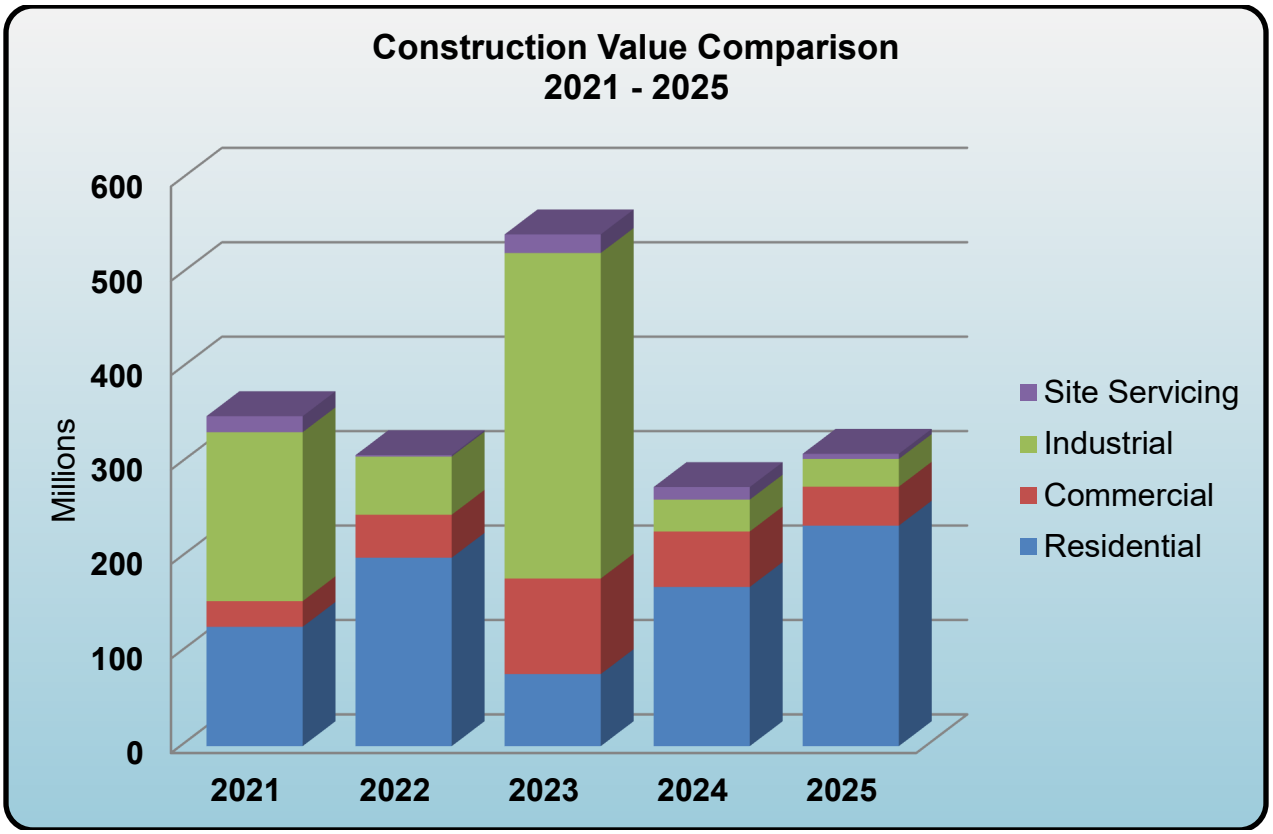
Discussion:

The following is a summary of the 2025 Year End Building Permit Activity:

- A total of 786 building permit applications were received in 2025, 0.25% (2) fewer than the 788 applications received in 2024.
- The total estimated construction value for issued building permits in 2025 reached $309.6 million, representing a 12.8% increase ($35.2 million) from the 2024 figure of $274.4 million. It is important to note that construction values are exclusively for permits that have been issued, and do not include permit applications still in circulation.
- The total estimated value of construction for residential building permits rose by 38.5% ($64.9 million), increasing from $168.6 million in 2024 to $233.5 million in 2025.

- The forecast for new residential housing units in 2025—including detached, semi-detached, townhouses, and apartments—was 1,391. However, permits were issued for only 557 units, which amounts to 40% of the projected total.
- Building permits issued for additional dwelling units (basement apartments, garden suites) decreased by 3.2% (6), from 188 permits (189 units) in 2024 to 182 permits (186 units) in 2025.
- The total estimated construction value for non-residential permits in 2025 was $76.0 million, reflecting a decline of 28.2% ($29.9 million) compared to the 2024 figure of $105.9 million. In 2025, 178 non-residential permits were issued, down from 214 permits in 2024.
- The 2025 forecast for new non-residential floor area was 77,293 m^2 (831,975 ft^2), the actual amount of new floor area for which permits were issued was 6,388 m^2 (68,760 ft^2). At the close of 2025 there was approximately 6,931 m^2 (74,605 ft^2) of new non-residential floor area in active circulation undergoing review or awaiting final approval.
- There were 215 building permit applications in circulation at the conclusion of 2025.

The graph below presents a comparative analysis of construction values over the past five years. It is important to note that commercial building permits encompass a wide variety of uses, including office spaces, restaurants, places of worship, and public facilities. The industrial category comprises structures related to assembly, fabrication, manufacturing, processing, as well as the repair or storage of goods and materials.



2026 Development Projections

Residential development is anticipated to rebound from the decline in permit volumes seen in recent years. Early budget projections estimate that construction will commence on 2,549 new residential units— including detached, semi-detached, townhouses, and apartments— in 2026.

The following are notable residential development projects anticipated to be approved for construction in 2026 (***** denotes projects where applications have been received):

- Garden Series on Monarch – Building A, Two 33-Storey Towers, 962 Apartment Units – 212 Bayly Street West*****
- Pat Bayly Square (Phase 3) – Buildings E & F, Two 25-Storey Towers, 632 Apartment Units – 1 River Plate Street & 35 Kitney Road
- Sherwood Gardens Ajax – 25-Storey Tower, 335 Apartment Units – 285 Harwood Avenue South (145, 147 & 149 Kings Crescent)
- Lake Pointe at Discovery Bay (Phase 1) – 8-Storey, 163 Apartment Units – 255 Lake Driveway
- Northgate Trails by Lakeview Homes – 215 Single Detached and Townhouse Units – 1641 Church Street North
- Time by Marshall Homes – 82 Townhome Units – Rossland Road West at Harkins Drive
- Chieftan Development Corporation – 60 Townhome Units – Bayly Street East at Shoalpoint Road
- Upperpark at Duffins Village by Coughlan Homes – 43 Single Detached and Townhouse Units – 1192 & 1260 Church Street North
- Firmland (Cedar) Inc. – 20 Townhome Units – Cedar Street at Knapton Avenue

Non-residential development activity in 2026 is expected to remain concentrated within the industrial sector; however, additional projects are scheduled for construction. Below is a list of significant non-residential development projects anticipated to receive approval for construction in 2026 (* denotes projects where applications have been received):

- Picov Industrial – 26,872 m^2, Industrial Building – 560 Kingston Road East*
- Legacy HMD Inc. – 24,870 m^2, Two Industrial Buildings – 549 Salem Road North & 170 Kerrison Drive East*
- Triovest Inc. – 8,358 m^2 Industrial Building – 2 Keensford Court
- Bayly Clayton Inc. – 7,882 m^2, Two Industrial Buildings – 479 Bayly Street East
- UltraStor – 4,884 m^2, One 4-Storey & Three 1-Storey Self-Service Storage Buildings – 365 Bayly Street West*
- Conseil Scolaire Viamonde – 3,543 m^2 2-Storey French Elementary School – 28 Turnerbury Avenue*

- Firearms Outlet Canada – 2,471 m^2 2-Storey Addition – 725 Westney Road South*
- Sun City Business Park – 2,272 m^2 Buildings E & F – 1140 & 1150 Salem Road North
- Star Night Import & Export – 2,122 m^2, Industrial Building – 45 Blowers Crescent*
- Canaweld Inc. – 2056 m^2 Industrial Building – 415 Westney Road South (North of Shaw Court)
- Minhas Self-Storage – 1,222 m^2, Three Self-Service Storage Buildings – 701 Finley Avenue

2025 Housing Pledge Target

In 2025, the Town achieved 30.4% of the assigned Housing Pledge target with 517 new dwelling units, including accessory dwelling units. This follows the Provincial methodology which includes 331 units reported by CMHC, and 186 accessory dwelling units reported by the Town's Building Section.

There are several reasons for the Town only achieving 30.4% of the assigned target; these include:

- High-interest rates and macroeconomic uncertainty have had a severe impact on the housing market, making it more difficult for people to qualify for a mortgage and/or choose to enter the housing market. This has had a negative impact on the new housing construction market with many builders waiting for the market to rebound before releasing new inventory. Some reports indicate that 2025 saw the lowest number of new unit sales in almost 45 years.
- The Town's target increased from 1,417 units in 2024 to 1,700 units in 2025, and is planned to remain at that level until 2031. In 2023, Planning staff acknowledged that the 1,700-unit target is aspirational and will continue to be challenging to meet; as the Town has averaged only approximately 710 units per year over the last 10 years.
- Provincial and CMHC methodology count finished foundations as a housing 'start'. For large apartment buildings with underground parking, there can be a significant lag between the issuance of a building permit and the year in which a unit is counted towards the target. The Town's progress towards the housing target often differs significantly from building permit data as a result of this lag. For example, in 2024 the Town issued a building permit for a 380-unit apartment building, and at the end of 2025, the Town issued another building permit for a 209-unit apartment building. Depending on the timing of completion of the foundations, the units are likely to be counted towards the Town's 2026 Housing Pledge Target. If these units were included and/or finished in 2025, the Town would have achieved approximately 65% of its target.

While the projections discussed earlier in the report identify the potential for 2,549 units in 2026, this will largely depend on improved market conditions. The 2025 Housing Market Outlook Report prepared by CMHC also identifies that housing starts are expected to slow from 2025 to 2027 mainly due to fewer condominium apartments

being built. While the Town continues to promote and create a favourable planning framework for new dwelling unit construction, a slowdown in condominium apartment units will severely impede the Town's ability to meet the housing target in upcoming years. Especially as much of the Town's projected growth is expected through intensification, largely driven by apartments. Staff will continue to monitor housing starts and progress towards the housing pledge target.

Financial Implications:

There are no financial implications as a result of this report.

Communication Issues:

None

Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

N/A

Conclusion:

Overall, although the number of permit applications in 2025 remained similar to that in 2024, the Town experienced an overall decrease in permits issued during this period. Notably, there was a reduction in residential permits issued; however, residential construction value increased significantly for the second consecutive year. In contrast, non-residential building activity saw declines in both permits issued and construction value across the commercial and industrial sectors.

The development outlook for 2026 anticipates a substantial rise in the approval of new residential units, alongside projected recovery in non-residential building activity, predominantly within the industrial sector. As with previous years, the level of development in 2026 will be largely influenced by favorable market conditions and ongoing economic stabilization.

Attachment(s):

ATT-1: Town of Ajax Building Report – Year-To-Date – December 2025

Prepared by:

Steven McReelis – Manager, Building Approvals & Chief Building Official

Submitted by:

Geoff Romanowski – Director of Planning & Development Services

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

ATT-1

TOWN OF AJAX BUILDING REPORT - YEAR-TO-DATE - DECEMBER 2025

TYPE OF PERMIT	Residential Units Created (YTD)	DECEMBER 2025 (YTD) Applications Rec'd (#)	Applications Change	Applications in Circulation (#)	Permits Issued (#)	Permits Change	Construction Value ($)	DECEMBER 2024 (YTD) Applications Received (#)	Permits Issued (#)	Construction Value ($)
RESIDENTIAL										
New Residential House (e.g. detached, townhouse)	Detached: 8 / Semi-Det: 0 / Row/TH: 21	11	-67%	12	10	-60%	17,255,194	33	25	20,084,964
Residential Multi-Unit (e.g. apartments, four-plex, hotels)	528	5	-69%	10	4	-50%	194,515,336	16	8	122,404,761
Additional Dwelling Units (e.g. bsmt. apt., garden suite)	Accessory: 186 / Detached: 0	240	27%	72	182	-3%	12,331,756	189	188	12,901,127
Residential House Additions, Alterations & Demolitions (e.g. sunroom, BGE, finished bsmt.)		233	-6%	60	176	-23%	7,805,227	249	228	10,560,571
Minor Residential (e.g. decks, sheds, detached garages)		114	31%	24	92	-19%	1,634,522	87	114	2,619,545
Sub-Total		**603**	**5%**	**178**	**464**	**-18%**	**233,542,035**	**574**	**563**	**168,570,968**
COMMERICAL										
Assembly Permit (e.g. community facilities, large restaurants)		18	-10%	8	13	-46%	5,568,058	20	24	31,487,470
Business & Personal Service (e.g. offices, hair styling salon)		19	-37%	5	22	-27%	14,989,243	30	30	7,720,639
Detention, Care & Treatment (e.g. hospitals, nursing homes)		3	200%	3	1	0%	550,000	1	0	0
Mercantile (e.g. retail store)		17	-35%	1	20	-29%	15,818,535	26	28	11,719,890
Minor Non-Residential (e.g. temporary tents, portable classrooms)		50	19%	4	49	11%	3,584,779	42	44	7,025,650
Change of Use (e.g. office to private school)		0	0%	0	0	0%	0	0	0	0
Sign Permit		40	-31%	4	40	-27%	718,761	58	55	802,450
Sub-Total		**147**	**-17%**	**25**	**145**	**-20%**	**41,229,376**	**177**	**181**	**58,756,099**
INDUSTRIAL										
Industrial Permit (e.g. manufacturing building, parking garage etc.)		**27**	**4%**	**10**	**20**	**-13%**	**29,394,796**	**26**	**23**	**33,761,857**
SERVICING										
Site Servicing (e.g. underground water and sanitary & storm sewers)		**9**	**-18%**	**2**	**13**	**18%**	**5,435,334**	**11**	**11**	**13,287,490**
TOTAL		**786**	**0%**	**215**	**642**	**-17%**	**309,601,541**	**788**	**778**	**274,376,414**

Town of Ajax Report
Open Session

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Dhaval Pandya, Manager of Transportation Planning Shubham Bohra, Transportation Project Engineer
Report Number:	PDS-2026-06
Subject:	Update on Provincial Road Safety Initiatives Fund (RSIF)
Wards:	All Wards
Date of Meeting:	March 9, 2026
Reference:	N/A

Recommendation:

1. **That Council authorize staff to create a new capital project called "Traffic Calming Measures - ASE Replacement", to install traffic calming measures at previously designated Automated Speed Enforcement (ASE) camera sites, be created.**

2. **That the funding provided to the Town of Ajax through the Provincial Road Safety Initiative Fund (RSIF) in the amount of $369,261 be allocated to the new capital project.**

3. **That Council authorize staff to adjust the number of traffic calming locations as necessary to ensure that project costs remain within the Town's RSIF funding allocation.**

4. **That Report PDS-2026-06 be forwarded to Durham Region Police Service, Durham District School Board, Durham Catholic District School Board, Durham Region Paramedic Services, Durham Region Transit, and Durham Student Transportation Service.**

Background:

Between 2020 and 2024, Council provided direction that established and progressively expanded the Town's Automated Speed Enforcement (ASE) program. Following initial Council endorsement in 2020 and completion of required agreements in late 2021, ASE deployment began in early 2022. As part of ongoing road-safety enhancements, Council expanded Community Safety Zones (CSZs) in April 2023 to include all school zones and

subsequently approved, on January 29, 2024, an increase in ASE camera locations from 15 to 28. These additional locations were incorporated into the third deployment cycle, which operated from July 2024 until the provincial termination of ASE programs in November 2025.

On November 14, 2025, the Province formally prohibited all municipal ASE programs with the enactment of Bill 56 – ***Building a More Competitive Economy Act, 2025***, which amended the Highway Traffic Act to revoke municipal authority to use automated speed enforcement. Municipal programs were required to deactivate cameras immediately. Offences issued prior to the repeal remain valid and continue to be processed under the Provincial Offences Act.

In parallel with the ASE ban, the Province introduced the Road Safety Initiatives Fund (RSIF) - a one-time $210 million provincial investment intended to assist municipalities in transitioning to permanent, engineering-based speed-management measures within School Zones and CSZs, previously served by ASE cameras. The Province has provided an immediate interim funding of $42 million to affected municipalities of which the Town received an interim RSIF allocation of $369,261. Provincial guidance specifies that RSIF funding may only be used for safety improvements at locations where municipal ASE enforcement had previously been deployed, with eligible treatments including physical traffic-calming measures, high-visibility signage, pedestrian safety enhancements, and other engineering-based measures.

Out of 28 RSIF-eligible corridors, the Town has selected 12 top-priority sites for immediate traffic calming projects using the interim RSIF funds. The application window for the next round of RSIF funding opened on February 19, 2026, following an announcement from the Province on February 13, 2026. More information will be shared with Council once staff have had the opportunity to review eligibility and outline a plan for the next round of funding.

Discussion:

Automated Speed Enforcement Program

The third deployment cycle of the Town's Automated Speed Enforcement (ASE) program commenced in July 2024 and continued until its mandated shutdown on November 14, 2025. Over the course of this cycle, ASE cameras recorded a total of 27,968 speeding charges, reflecting a sustained pattern of non-compliance on several key road segments.

Table 1 presents the combined results from calendar years 2024 and 2025 (January to November), summarizing both:

- the number of speeding instances captured by ASE cameras, and
- the number of charges laid for speeding infractions.

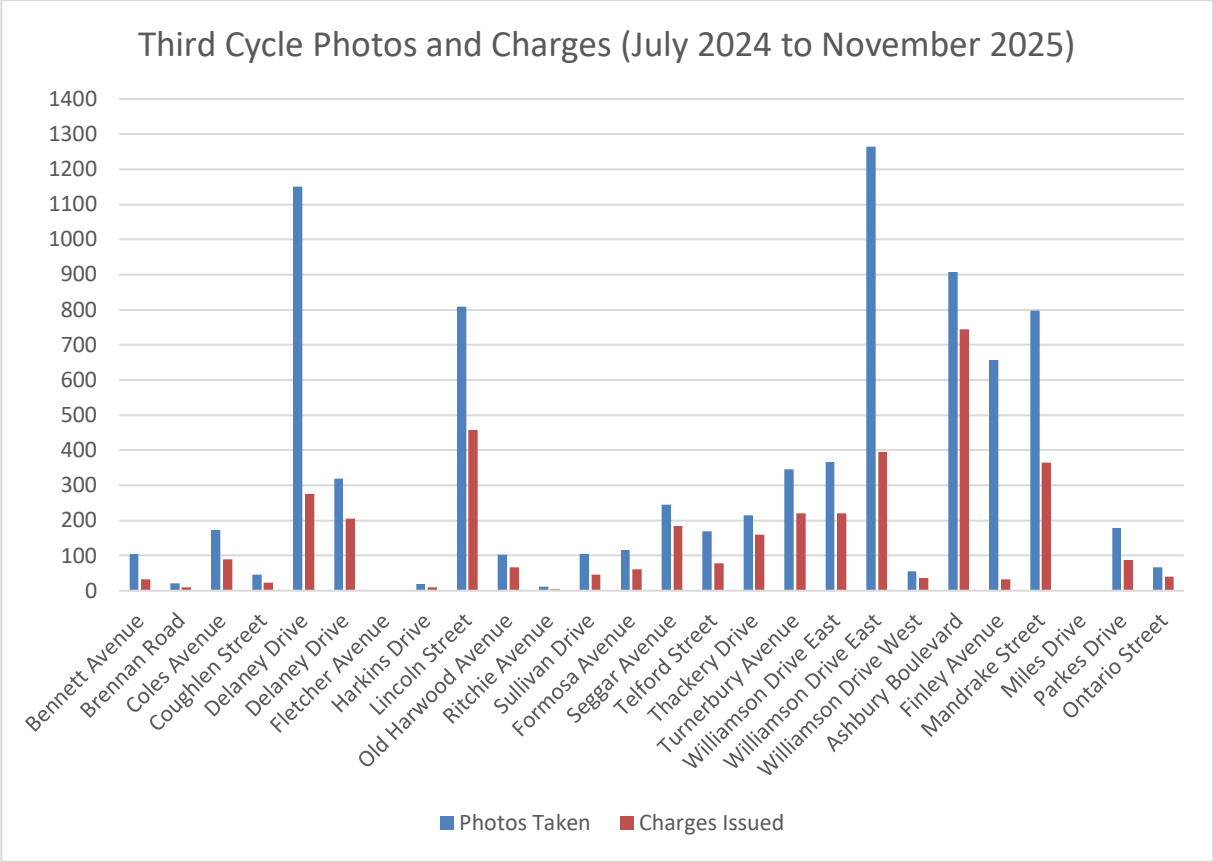
In addition to the tabulated results, **Figure 1** provides graphical illustrations of the number of photos captured and charges issued at each ASE location for the third cycle.

Across all sites included in the third ASE cycle, a total of 51,185 images were captured, and 27,968 charges were issued, resulting in a total fine amount of approximately $3.6 million. The total fine amount has been reported by the Toronto Joint Processing Centre (JPC); however, the amount actually collected by the Durham Provincial Offences Act (POA) Court may vary from this figure. This data provides a clear indication of persistent speeding behavior within designated School Zones and Community Safety Zones and highlights the ongoing need for engineered traffic-calming interventions following the provincial transition away from ASE.

Table 1 - Photos and Charges Laid in Cycle 3 - July 2024 to November 2025

Ward	Street Name	Between	Photos Taken	Charges Issued
1	Bennett Avenue	Rossland Road West and Sullivan Drive	104	32
1	Brennan Road	Ravenscroft Road and Delaney Drive	21	10
1	Church Street North	Delaney Drive and Kingston Road West	15,063	6,146
1	Church Street South	Kingston Road West and Mill Street	2,456	1,706
1	Coles Avenue	Magill Drive and Chapman Drive	173	89
1	Coughlen Street	Pearce Drive and Westney Road North	46	23
1	Delaney Drive	Elizabeth Street and Ravenscroft Road	1,470	481
1	Fletcher Avenue	Hibbert Drive and Kerrison Drive West	1	0
1	Harkins Drive	Rossland Road West and Delaney Drive	19	9
1	Lincoln Street	Church Street South and Mill Street	808	458
1	Old Harwood Avenue	Parkins Drive and Twigg Drive/Fletcher Avenue	102	66
1	Ritchie Avenue	Kingston Road West and Rossland Road South	12	3
1	Sullivan Drive	Bennett Avenue and Noake Crescent/Locker Drive	105	46
2	Formosa Avenue	Lloydminster Avenue and Audley Road North	116	60
2	Harwood Avenue North	Woodcock Avenue and Rossland Road	25,422	16,275
2	Seggar Avenue	Williamson Drive West and Rossland Road West	245	184
2	Telford Street	Stevensgate Drive and Westney Road North	169	78
2	Thackery Drive	Salem Road and Williamson Drive East	214	160

Ward	Street Name	Between	Photos Taken	Charges Issued
2	Turnerbury Avenue	Formosa Avenue and Ainley Road North	345	220
2	Williamson Drive East	Salem Road and Thackery Drive	367	221
2	Williamson Drive East	Salem Road and Audley Road North	1,264	395
2	Williamson Drive West	Ravenscroft Road and Hazeldine Drive/Tozer Crescent	56	36
3	Ashbury Boulevard	Shoal Point Road and Audley Road South	907	745
3	Finley Avenue	Banner Crescent and Burden Crescent	657	33
3	Mandrake Street	Heron Street/Gillmore Drive and Angus Drive (East leg)	798	365
3	Miles Drive	Wicks Drive and Chambers Drive	0	0
3	Parkes Drive	Milner Crescent and Finley Avenue	179	87
3	Ontario Street/ Windsor Avenue	Brock Street and Harwood Avenue South	66	40
		Total	51,185	27,968



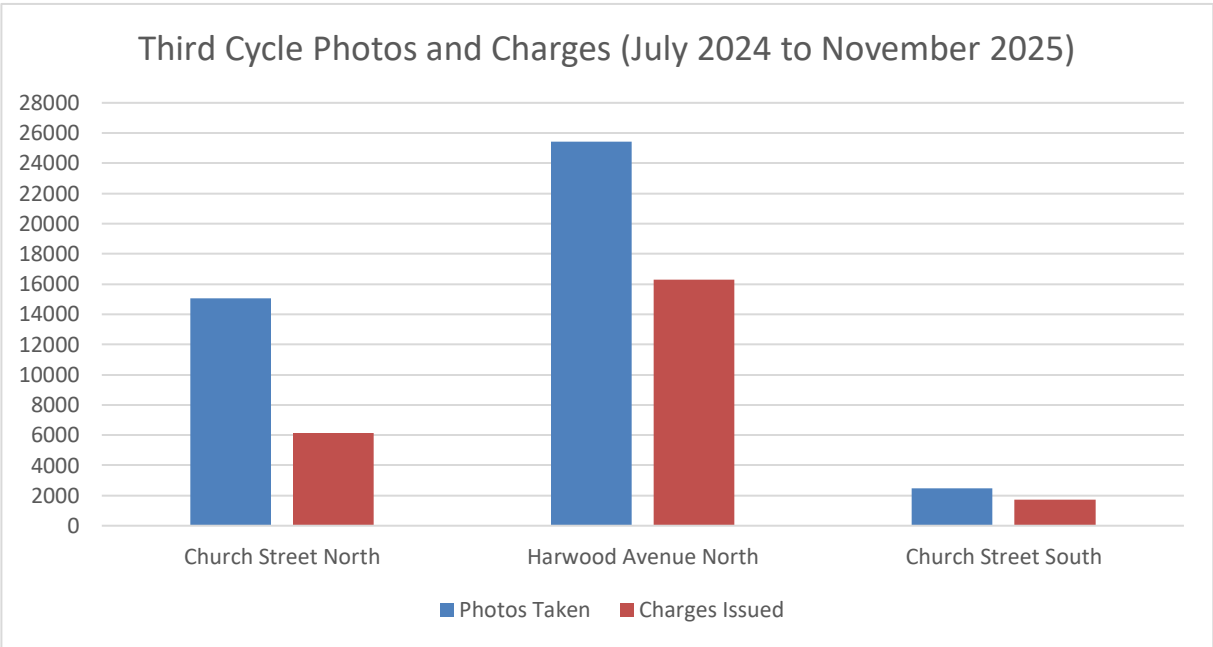


Figure 1: **Photos Taken and Charges Issued in Cycle 3 – July 2024 to November 2025**	**Town of Ajax Planning & Development Services**	Town of Ajax By the Lake

RSIF – Traffic Calming Site Selection

As noted above, the Town of Ajax has received an interim RSIF allocation in the amount of $369,261. Under provincial rules, these funds can only be used at former ASE deployment sites; RSIF funding cannot be applied to road segments that did not previously host a municipal ASE camera.

Accordingly, the Town's eligible locations are those listed within the council approved ASE locations inventory (refer to **ATT-1**), which contains all corridors where ASE cameras were historically deployed under the Town's ASE program.

Within this provincially defined boundary, staff assessed where RSIF investment would provide the strongest safety benefit. The assessment considered:

- Observed speed conditions - identified through ASE speed data, including 85th percentile (i.e. operating) speeds and the number of ASE charges issued.
- Roadway characteristics - making sure that traffic calming treatments suit the functional classification of the roads, align with current geometry and lane configurations, and also support emergency response, transit operations, and winter maintenance needs.
- Vulnerable road-user exposure - particularly where school frontages, parks, community institutions, or dense residential frontage increase the consequences of speeding.
- Strict RSIF eligibility - confirming that any recommended location falls within the Province's required category of former ASE sites and available funding.

RSIF funds may be applied to physical traffic calming measures and safety enhancements such as raised crosswalks, speed humps or cushions, curb extensions, high-visibility School Zone/CSZ signage, and other engineering measures identified by the Province as eligible investments.

The result is a focused set of eligible corridors where the Town may apply its RSIF allocation to deliver durable, engineering-based safety improvements consistent with the province's intent. **Table 2** below provides the list of priority locations based on currently available RSIF funding.

Table 2 - List of selected locations

#	Street	Ward	Between
1	Lincoln Street	1	Church Street South and Mill Street
2	Coles Avenue	1	Magill Drive and Chapman Drive
3	Old Harwood Avenue/Fishlock St	1	Parkins Drive and Twigg Drive/Fletcher Avenue
4	Delaney Drive	1	Elizabeth Street and Ravenscroft Road

#	Street	Ward	Between
5	Williamson Drive East	2	Salem Road North and Audley Road North
6	Williamson Drive East	2	Salem Road North and Thackery Drive
7	Telford Street	2	Stevensgate Drive and Westney Road North
8	Seggar Avenue	2	Williamson Drive West and Rossland Road West
9	Ashbury Boulevard	3	Shoal Point Road and Audley Road South
10	Mandrake Street	3	Heron Street/Gillmore Drive and Angus Drive (East leg)
11	Finley Avenue	3	Banner Crescent and Burden Crescent
12	Parkes Drive	3	Finley Avenue and Milner Crescent

Church Street North, Church Street South, and Harwood Avenue North have been identified as locations with higher ASE ticket volumes and have previously hosted ASE camera installations. Nevertheless, these corridors were not considered for physical traffic-calming measures in this assessment due to their roadway classifications and functional roles. Church Street (North and South) is designated as an Arterial Type B roadway, which precludes the implementation of physical traffic-calming measures because of its essential mobility function and operational requirements. Although Harwood Avenue North holds an Arterial Type C classification, its current traffic volume and 4-lane cross-section result in its operation as a Type B arterial road; as such, it also does not meet the established criteria for traffic-calming interventions. Despite the aforementioned considerations, these locations will be considered for the potential installation of radar message boards.

Proposed Traffic Calming Measures

As required under the Province's RSIF framework, all investments must consist of physical, engineering-based safety improvements in School Zones and Community Safety Zones where ASE cameras were previously deployed. The Province has identified measures such as speed humps, raised crossings, horizontal deflection, high visibility signage, and related traffic calming devices as eligible RSIF expenditures. based safety improvements in School Zones and Community Safety Zones where ASE cameras were previously deployed.

In applying this guidance, the Town will implement a suite of context sensitive engineering treatments tailored to the function of each corridor, expected travel speeds, adjacent land use, emergency access requirements, and pedestrian activity levels. These measures are selected for their proven ability to reduce vehicle operating speeds, enhance driver awareness, and support improved safety outcomes, particularly for children and vulnerable road users.

Traffic calming measures work best when applied in combination rather than as standalone treatments. Individual devices tend to influence driver's behavior only at a single point, whereas a coordinated set of measures provides consistent cues that encourage drivers to maintain lower speeds throughout the entire corridor. This approach leads to more predictable driver behavior, reduced speed variability, and stronger, longer-lasting safety outcomes. It also allows the Town to balance safety improvements with operational needs such as transit, goods movement, and emergency response.

1. Speed Humps - Speed humps are a well-established vertical-deflection measure used across Canadian municipalities to purposely reduce midblock operating speeds. When properly spaced and designed to standards, they produce consistent, predictable speed reduction without impeding emergency vehicles when used in moderation. On local and selected collector streets fronting schools and parks, humps are an effective tool for lowering approach speeds and improving stopping distance in pedestrian-dense environments.

2. Flexible Bollards - Flexible Bollards provide horizontal narrowing, creating a visual and physical cue that prompts drivers to reduce speed and maintain lane discipline. They are particularly useful where road widths are excessive or where temporary, removable devices are preferred for winter maintenance. In School Zones and CSZs, bollards can reinforce gateway treatments, discourage mid-block passing, and narrow perceived lanes without altering drainage or geometry.

3. Radar Message Boards - Radar message boards offer immediate, real-time feedback to approaching drivers, reinforcing compliance without generating enforcement penalties. They are particularly effective during transition periods when new traffic-calming features are introduced. Boards can also provide short-duration speed data logging to assist with post-installation monitoring and verify the long-term effectiveness of the installed measures.

It should be noted that certain corridors are already equipped with traffic calming measures, including speed humps or cushions, flexible bollards, and flexible signage as part of the 2022 Traffic Calming Program. In these instances, staff will assess the current traffic calming infrastructure on the identified streets and evaluate whether enhancements are necessary.

Design and Delivery Process

All RSIF-funded traffic calming projects will follow the Town's standard engineering and engagement process, including:

- Conceptual Design - Identification of treatment selection and preliminary placement.
- Detailed Design - Refinement of location and geometry, signage and pavement marking plans, and coordination with Roads Operations, transit, emergency services, and school partners, as necessary.
- Public Consultation - Notification to affected residents, schools, and stakeholders with opportunities for input.

- Monitoring and Evaluation - Post-construction speed studies and observational review to confirm performance and ensure alignment with RSIF reporting expectations.

This structured approach ensures consistent, transparent implementation while maintaining compatibility with transit, winter operations, and emergency response considerations, and demonstrates the Town's commitment to active public engagement throughout the process.

Impact on and Input from Other Departments

After consultation with the Town's Fire Services Departments, they outlined that:

- Traffic calming measures could negatively affect emergency and non-emergency response times.
- Delayed response times may increase fire development, impacting the health and safety of firefighters and residents.
- Traffic calming features may lead to higher maintenance and repair costs for Fire's fleet vehicles, particularly affecting brakes, steering, and suspension.

Operations and Environmental Services staff have no concerns about the proposed traffic calming measures on selected streets; however, further discussions are required.

Financial Implications:

Capital Cost

The Traffic Calming Measures - ASE Replacement project is a grant funded project in the amount of $369,261. The funds must be utilized by the end of March 2028.

The Town will use its interim RSIF allocation to support design development and construction at the 12 priority locations. This funding enables the Town to put in place permanent, engineering-based traffic-calming measures that meet provincial RSIF standards. **Table 3** below shows the estimated costs for each priority location.

Table 3 - Cost Estimate of Selected Locations

#	Street	Ward	Between	Estimated Cost ($)
1	Lincoln Street	1	Church Street South and Mill Street	$ 32,936.00
2	Coles Avenue	1	Magill Drive and Chapman Drive	$ 32,936.00
3	Old Harwood Avenue/Fishlock Street	1	Parkins Drive and Twigg Drive/Fletcher Avenue	$ 8,312.00
4	Delaney Drive	1	Elizabeth Street and Ravenscroft Road	$ 50,272.00
5	Williamson Drive East	2	Salem Road and Audley Road North	$ 42,860.00

#	Street	Ward	Between	Estimated Cost ($)
6	Williamson Drive East	2	Salem Road and Thackery Drive	$ 20,624.00
7	Telford Street	2	Stevensgate Drive and Westney Road North	$ 25,524.00
8	Seggar Avenue	2	Williamson Drive West and Rossland Road West	$ 35,448.00
9	Ashbury Boulevard	3	Shoal Point Road and Audley Road South	$ 28,036.00
10	Mandrake Street	3	Heron Street/Gillmore Drive and Angus Drive (East leg)	$ 32,936.00
11	Finley Avenue	3	Banner Crescent and Burden Crescent	$ 28,036.00
12	Parkes Drive	3	Finley Avenue and Milner Crescent	$ 28,036.00
			Total	**$ 365,956.00**

While the Town will strive to utilize all available funding, any minor project overages will be funded by the Capital Contingency Reserve upon closing of the capital project.

Operating Costs

Annual operating expenses are estimated at approximately $30,000 for the removal and reinstallation of flexible bollards during winter, as well as the upkeep of radar message boards. Regular maintenance costs for signs, posts, and pavement markings are projected to range from $5,000 to $10,000. These amounts will be included in future budget requests.

In addition, a five-year radar message board replacement cycle will continue to be budgeted through the asset management planning process.

Communication Issues:

Effective communication will be essential to ensure residents, road users, and community partners are well-informed throughout the delivery of RSIF-funded safety improvements. Virtual and/or in-person public consultation sessions will be held following the substantial completion of detailed design and before the procurement process to solicit input from the community. These sessions will provide comprehensive information regarding proposed traffic calming measures for each street, including their exact locations, projected construction timelines, and expected duration. Transportation staff will collaborate with the Town's Communications section to prepare and circulate public notices well ahead of the scheduled consultation sessions.

Staff will use a combination of project notices, website updates, on-site signage, and direct outreach, as required, to adjacent property owners and school administrators (where applicable) to maintain transparency and manage expectations. Communications will emphasize the safety objectives of the improvements and outline what residents can expect before, during, and after installation.

A dedicated point of contact will be identified for public inquiries, and feedback received through the consultation and construction stages will be monitored to support timely responses and minimize disruptions.

Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

This report aligns with the following section of the 2022-2026 Strategic Plan – Action26:

Pillar: Connecting our Community
Priority: 4. Foster a safe and welcoming Community
4.2 Continue to implement traffic calming initiatives

Conclusion:

This report outlines the Town's use of the Provincial Road Safety Initiatives Fund (RSIF) and identifies the 12 locations recommended for implementation of traffic calming measures based on the available RSIF allocation. It presents the associated cost estimates, describes the engineering measures to be advanced, and confirms the steps required to deliver these improvements within the provincial timelines. The information provided is intended to support Council's understanding of the funding requirements, project scope, and next steps necessary to move the program forward.

Attachments:

ATT-1: List of Council Approved ASE Locations

Prepared by:

Dhaval Pandya – Manager of Transportation Planning
Shubham Bohra – Transportation Project Engineer

Submitted by:

Geoff Romanowski – Director of Planning & Development Services

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

Attachment 1 - List of Council Approved ASE Locations

#	Street	Between
1	Ashbury Boulevard	Shoal Point Road and Audley Road South
2	Bennett Avenue	Rossland Road West and Sullivan Drive
3	Brennan Road	Ravenscroft Road and Delaney Drive
4	Church Street North	Delaney Drive and Kingston Road West
5	Church Street South	Kingston Road West and Mill Street
6	Coles Avenue	Magill Drive and Chapman Drive
7	Coughlen Street	Pearce Drive and Westney Road North
8	Delaney Drive	Elizabeth Street and Ravenscroft Road
9	Finley Avenue	Banner Crescent and Burden Crescent
10	Fletcher Avenue	Hibbard Drive and Kerrison Drive West
11	Formosa Avenue	Lloydminster Avenue and Audley Road North
12	Harkins Drive	Rossland Road West and Delaney Drive
13	Harwood Avenue North	Woodcock Avenue and Rossland Road
14	Lincoln Street	Church Street South and Mill Street
15	Mandrake Street	Heron Street/Gillmore Drive and Angus Drive (East leg)
16	Miles Drive	Wicks Drive and Chambers Drive
17	Old Harwood Avenue/Fishlock Street	Parkins Drive and Twigg Drive/Fletcher Avenue
18	Parkes Drive	Milner Crescent and Finley Avenue
19	Ritchie Avenue	Kingston Road West and Westney Road South
20	Seggar Avenue	Williamson Drive West and Rossland Road West
21	Sullivan Drive	Bennett Avenue and Noake Crescent/Locker Drive
22	Telford Street	Stevensgate Drive and Westney Road North
23	Thackery Drive	Salem Road and Williamson Drive East
24	Turnerbury Avenue	Formosa Avenue and Ainley Road
25	Williamson Drive East	Salem Road and Thackery Drive
26	Williamson Drive East	Salem Road and Audley Road North
27	Williamson Drive West	Ravenscroft Road and Hazeldine Drive/Tozer Crescent
28	Windsor Avenue / Ontario Street	Brock Street and Harwood Avenue South

Town of Ajax Report
Open Session

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Arun Thirupathisivam, Development Engineering Coordinator
Report Number:	PDS-2026-07
Subject:	Church Street North Road Closure
Wards:	Ward 2
Date of Meeting:	March 9, 2026
Reference:	2025 Road Occupancy/Road Closure By-law #48-2025

Recommendation:

1. **That Council approve the temporary two-stage road closure of Church Street North between Taunton Road West and Rossland Road West from June 1, 2026 to September 15, 2026, arranged through the Road Occupancy and Road Closure By-law #48-2025, to allow construction for the extension of the sanitary sewer and watermain in support of the proposed subdivision (S-A-2021-01) at 1641 Church Street North.**

Background:

The proposed subdivision (S-A-2021-01) at 1641 Church Street North is advancing towards the commencement of site servicing works. As part of these works, new watermain and sanitary sewers are required to be installed within Church Street to connect the development to the municipal infrastructure.

Church Street North currently has existing municipal watermain and sanitary sewers extending only to the southern limit of the Hydro Corridor. There are no water or sanitary services available north of this point to support the proposed development and servicing needs. To facilitate the extension of municipal watermain and sanitary sewer infrastructure from the limits of the Hydro Corridor to the proposed development, construction activities are required within the Church Street right-of-way. The proposed works include the installation of new watermain and sanitary sewer connections and associated roadworks.

Due to the location, depth, and sequencing of the proposed underground works, a temporary road closure of Church Street is required to ensure public safety, accommodate construction staging, and allow the work to be completed in a safe and efficient manner.

Prior to the commencement of any construction activities or road closure, the developer will be entering into an external servicing agreement with Durham Region. Through this agreement, the Region will collect securities for construction and restoration to ensure that the services and the road are constructed to Town and Region Standards.

Discussion:

The proposed watermain and sanitary sewer extension on Church Street North will require a localized road closure to accommodate excavation and equipment staging across the full width of the roadway. Alternative construction methods, including lane restrictions, were reviewed. However, due to the depth of the sanitary sewer installation and the required trench width, this option was determined to be impractical due to safety concerns, constructability limitations, and the potential for extended construction duration under partial lane closures. Therefore, a temporary localized closure will be necessary to ensure the safety of the public and construction personnel. ATT-1 illustrates the challenging depth of construction in relation to the lanes of travel within the right-of-way.

To minimize impacts and maintain access to adjacent landowners, the temporary road closure on Church Street will be implemented in two stages. During both stages, unrestricted access to Arbor Memorial Inc. at 1757 Church Street North will be available. Details of the two-stage road closure are outlined below.

Stage 1:

This stage will involve the construction of the sanitary sewer and watermain on Church Street from Hurst Drive/Caton Lane to a point south of the existing driveway at 1620 Church Street North. Church Street will remain closed between Taunton Road and Rossland Road and accessible to local traffic to allow continued access to nearby residents, emergency vehicles and deliveries. Please see ATT-2 for Stage 1 road closure details.

Stage 2:

This stage will involve the construction of the sanitary sewer and watermain on Church Street from a point north of the existing driveway at 1620 Church Street North to the northern limit of the proposed subdivision at 1641 Church Street North. Church Street will remain closed between Taunton Road and Rossland Road and accessible to local traffic to allow continued access to nearby residents, emergency vehicles and deliveries. Please see ATT-3 for Stage 2 road closure details.

Traffic Management Plan

A traffic management plan will be implemented during both stages of the closure, including clearly signed detour routes along Church Street, Taunton Road, Ravenscroft Road and Rossland Road. Advance warning signs will also be installed along the eastbound and westbound approaches of Taunton Road and Rossland Road to provide clear guidance for motorists. Advance notification signs will be installed 15 days prior to the closure to ensure drivers are aware of the exact dates and duration of the work. For overnight closures, all barricades and signages will be fitted with retroreflective materials and equipped with warning lights in accordance with the Ontario Traffic

Manual (OTM). The traffic management plans for both stages of closure have been attached with this report.

Financial Implications:

N/A

Communication Issues:

Communication efforts will be carried out prior to and throughout construction and will include direct notification to the adjacent landowners. The Durham District School Board (DDSB), the Durham Catholic District School Board (DCDSB), and emergency services will be notified of the road closure prior to construction. The developer will be advised to ensure unobstructed access for fire department vehicles is maintained at all times during construction. Clear detour routes will be enforced as part of the traffic management plan to safely redirect motorists via Ravenscroft Road. Advance signage will be installed 15 days prior to the closure and be arranged through the Road Occupancy and Road Closure By-law #48-2025.

Construction activities may result in short-term dust and noise impacts to nearby residents and motorists. Appropriate measures will be in place to minimize these impacts for the duration of the work.

Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

N/A

Conclusion:

It is the recommendation of staff that Council approve the necessary road closure to facilitate the extension of municipal watermain and sanitary sewer infrastructure on Church Street North.

Attachments:

ATT-1: Church Street North Cross-Section - Sanitary and Watermain Construction
ATT-2: Church Street North – Stage 1 Traffic Management Plan
ATT-3: Church Street North – Stage 2 Traffic Management Plan

Prepared by:

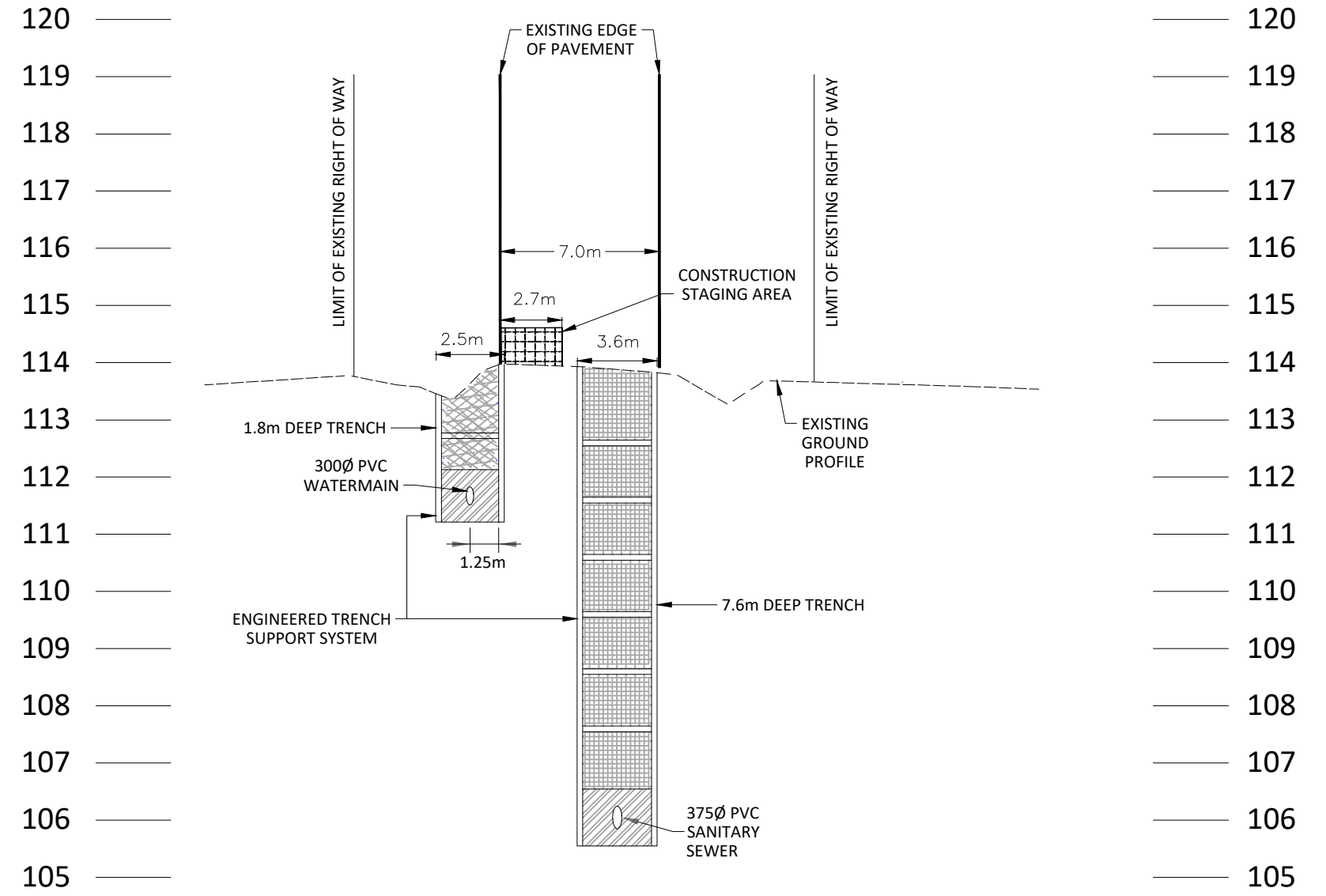
Arun Thirupathisivam – Development Engineering Coordinator

Submitted by:

Geoff Romanowski – Director of Planning & Development Services

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer



CHURCH STREET - CROSS-SECTION A-A
(WATERMAIN AND SANITARY CONSTRUCTION)

SCALE: H=1:250 V=1:100

TOWN OF AJAX
Planning and Development Services

Date:	06/02/2026
Contract:	N/A
Created By:	BM
Checked By:	N/A
	FIGURE 1

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Taunton Road W
Church Street N
North extent of Stage 1 closure to terminate south of existing west-side driveway to allow landowner access
Subject Lands
Affected property with active occupation
Proposed Stage 1 Church Street Road Closure
Ravenscroft Road
Westney Road N
Rossland Road W
CHURCH ST. CLOSED AT HURST DR. / CATON LN
FOLLOW
DETOUR
ROAD CLOSED
N
Church St N
Traffic Management Plan
Stage 1 Closure
Per OTM Book 7 - TS-21 & TS-22
(N.T.S.)



Church St N
Traffic Management Plan
Stage 2 Closure
Per OTM Book 7 - TS-21 & TS-22
(N.T.S.)

Town of Ajax Report
Open Session

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Cameron Richardson, Supervisor of Environmental Sustainability & Climate Change
Report Number:	PDS-2026-08
Subject:	Contract Award - Wetland Tree Planting Projects
Wards:	All Wards
Date of Meeting:	March 9, 2026
Reference:	2026 Capital Budget No. 26003501 2026 Capital Budget No. 26003601 2026 Capital Budget No. 26003701

Recommendation:

1. That Council award the contract for the Kerrison Wetland Infill Tree Planting Project, Audley Wetland Infill Tree Planting Project, and Annandale Wetland Tree Planting Project to the Toronto and Region Conservation Authority (TRCA) in the amount of $878,283.58 (inclusive of all taxes).

Background:

Wetland restoration and associated native tree and shrub planting has been identified as a priority in the *Ajax Climate Risk & Resiliency Plan*, *Carruthers Creek Watershed Plan,* and *Urban Forest Technical Study*. The importance of wetlands and their flood mitigation potential have also been identified in *Action26 – Ajax Council's 2022-2026 Strategic Plan.*

Both the Kerrison and Audley Wetland Restoration Projects, and associated tree and shrub planting, were identified as a restoration priority in the *Carruthers Creek Watershed Plan (2020),* of which the Town was a significant contributing partner, and are located within the Carruthers Creek floodplain at Kingston Rd. E. and Audley Rd. The Kerrison Wetland Infill Tree Planting Project will plant approximately 500 native trees and 2,000 native shrubs across 0.5 hectare (1.2 acres) of restored habitat. The Audley Wetland Infill Tree Planting Project will plant approximately 1140 native trees and 4,560 native shrubs across 3.4 hectares (8.4 acres) of restored habitat.

The Annandale Wetland Restoration Project, and associated tree and shrub planting, was identified as a restoration priority in the *Ajax Climate Risk & Resiliency Plan* and is located within the Duffins Creek floodplain at Bayly St. W. and Church St. S. The Annandale Wetland Tree Planting Project will plant approximately 4,000 native trees and 16,000 native shrubs across 4.5 hectares (11.1 acres) of restored habitat.

The three projects will collectively plant 28,200 native trees and shrubs across 8.5 hectares (20.8 acres) in Ajax.

Discussion:

Purchases of Goods/Services that are exempt from the Town's Procurement By-Law (pursuant to Section 9.7 of the By-Law) may be procured without a competitive procurement process. The By-Law indicates the TRCA as a vendor that is exempted from the competitive process as they have specialized knowledge and experience related to long-term restoration projects located within their Regulated Areas and floodplains.

Contract commencement is March 16, 2026, and completion of all three projects is expected by December 31, 2027.

Financial Implications:

Approved Capital Budgets - fully funded by Tree Compensation Funds

26003501	Kerrison Wetland Infill Tree Planting Project	$100,000.00	
26003601	Audley Wetland Infill Tree Planting Project	$250,000.00	
26003701	Annandale Wetland Tree Planting Project	$520,000.00	$870,000.00
Contract (net of HST rebate)		$790,921.57	
Contingency 10%		$79,078.43	$870,000.00
Available Budget			$0.00

A contingency amount of approximately 10% has been identified to account for unexpected costs that may occur during the project, which could include site preparation, additional tree protection methods, or inclement weather delays.

These three projects were approved by Ajax Council in the Town of Ajax's 2026 Capital Budget and will be entirely funded through the Town's Tree Compensation Funds. Town staff will continue to identify and apply to applicable external grant opportunities to help fund tree planting projects.

Communication Issues:

These projects are expected to garner significant positive feedback from the community based on the implementation of priority climate resilience and biodiversity projects. Town staff will ensure that the Town and TRCA are profiled prominently and positively given their direct involvement, financial commitments, and existing collaborative relationship.

Additionally, these projects will continue to provide opportunities to host community events, including tree planting, to educate the public about the projects and increase their involvement in, and awareness of, the Town's sustainability initiatives.

Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

This report aligns with the following sections of the 2022-2026 Strategic Plan – Action26:

Pillar: Modernizing our Community
Priority: Lead the green transition
Action: Flood Mitigation Measures

Conclusion:

The three planting projects implement key strategic priorities and actions identified within the *Ajax Climate Risk & Resiliency Plan (2025)*, *Carruthers Creek Watershed Plan (2021)*, *Urban Forest Strategy (2023),* and the *2022-2026 Strategic Plan – Action26*. The Town of Ajax will continue to exemplify strong leadership and advocacy to fulfill our vision of becoming a sustainable community. Cross-collaboration between all departments, other municipalities, and government partners will be required to ensure that the Town of Ajax proactively mitigates and adapts to the expected impacts of climate change.

Attachments:

ATT-1: CDS – Project 26003501 – Kerrison Wetland Infill Tree Planting Project
ATT-2: CDS – Project 26003601 – Audley Wetland Infill Tree Planting Project
ATT-3: CDS – Project 26003701 – Annandale Wetland Tree Planting Project

Prepared by:

Cameron Richardson – Supervisor of Environmental Sustainability & Climate Change – ext. 3229

Submitted by:

Geoff Romanowski – Director of Planning & Development Services

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

TOWN OF AJAX

2026 CAPITAL BUDGET / 2027-2035 LONG RANGE CAPITAL FORECAST

DETAIL SHEET

Project Name	**Kerrison Wetland Infill Tree Planting Project**		
Project	26003501	**Initially budgeted in**	2026
Submitted By	Stev Andis, Manager of Planning	**Department**	Planning & Development Services
Start Year	2026	**Section**	Planning

PROJECT DESCRIPTION / JUSTIFICATION

Scope: The Kerrison Wetland Tree Planting Project consists of new and infill native tree and shrub plantings within the newly restored Kerrison Wetland to create and enhance riparian and forest habitat within the Carruthers Creek floodplain between Kerrison Road and Kingston Road East. Riparian margins are strips of land along the edges of natural watercourses including streams, lakes and wetlands. Riparian plantings are grasses, shrubs, trees or other vegetation planted along the edges of such watercourses.

Rationale: This project is identified as a restoration priority in the Carruthers Creek Watershed Plan. This project would improve water quality, increase wildlife habitat, flood mitigation, improve regional and local Natural Heritage System connectivity and reduction of urban heat island effect. Wetlands and adjacent habitats are "carbon sinks" and one of the most cost-efficient ways to sequester carbon. This project also presents the opportunity to involve Ajax residents in tree/shrub plantings. This project is funded by tree compensation collected by the Town.

Reference : *Ajax Climate Risk and Resiliency Plan, Carruthers Creek Watershed Plan, Urban Forest Technical Study*

Schedule: 2026

Funding: This initiative will be supported through contributions received as part of tree compensation, designated for the planting and replanting of trees.

EXPENDITURES / FUNDING

	Previously Approved	2026	2027	2028	2029-2035	Total
Total Expenditures	**-**	**100,000**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**100,000**
Recoveries - External	-	100,000	-	-	-	100,000
Total Funding	**-**	**100,000**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**100,000**

TOWN OF AJAX

2026 CAPITAL BUDGET / 2027-2035 LONG RANGE CAPITAL FORECAST

DETAIL SHEET

Project Name	**Audley Wetland Infill Tree Planting Project**		
Project	26003601	**Initially budgeted in**	2026
Submitted By	Stev Andis, Manager of Planning	**Department**	Planning & Development Services
Start Year	2026	**Section**	Planning

PROJECT DESCRIPTION / JUSTIFICATION

Scope: The Audley Wetland Tree Planting Project consists of new and infill native tree and shrub plantings within the newly restored Audley Wetland to create and enhance riparian and forest habitat within the Carruthers Creek floodplain between Kingston Road East and Highway 401. Riparian margins are strips of land along the edges of natural watercourses including streams, lakes and wetlands. Riparian plantings are grasses, shrubs, trees or other vegetation planted along the edges of such watercourses.

Rationale: This project is identified as a restoration priority in the Carruthers Creek Watershed Plan. This project would improve water quality, increase wildlife habitat, flood mitigation, improve regional and local Natural Heritage System connectivity and reduction of urban heat island effect. Wetlands and adjacent habitats are "carbon sinks" and one of the most cost-efficient ways to sequester carbon. This project also presents the opportunity to involve Ajax residents in tree/shrub plantings. This project is funded by tree compensation collected by the Town.

Reference: *Ajax Climate Risk and Resiliency Plan, Carruthers Creek Watershed Plan, Urban Forest Technical Study*

Schedule: 2026

Funding: This initiative will be supported through contributions received as part of tree compensation, designated for the planting and replanting of trees.

EXPENDITURES / FUNDING

	Previously Approved	2026	2027	2028	2029-2035	Total
Total Expenditures	**-**	**250,000**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**250,000**
Recoveries - External	-	250,000	-	-	-	250,000
Total Funding	**-**	**250,000**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**250,000**

TOWN OF AJAX

2026 CAPITAL BUDGET / 2027-2035 LONG RANGE CAPITAL FORECAST

DETAIL SHEET

Project Name	**Annandale Wetland Tree Planting Project**		
Project	26003701	**Initially budgeted in**	2026
Submitted By	Stev Andis, Manager of Planning	**Department**	Planning & Development Services
Start Year	2026	**Section**	Planning

PROJECT DESCRIPTION / JUSTIFICATION

Scope: The Annandale Wetland Tree Planting Project consists of new native tree and shrub plantings within the floodplain of Duffins Creek that were removed for an intensive, manicured, recreational use located at the northeast corner of Church St S and Bayly St. The project will include significant native plantings at the project location within newly created wetland habitat.

Rationale: This project is identified as a restoration priority in the Carruthers Creek Watershed Plan. This project would improve water quality, increase wildlife habitat, flood mitigation, improve regional and local Natural Heritage System connectivity and reduction of urban heat island effect. Wetlands and adjacent habitats are "carbon sinks" and one of the most cost-efficient ways to sequester carbon. This project also complements planned wetland and trail work within the project area. This project is funded by tree compensation collected by the Town.

Reference: *Ajax Climate Risk and Resiliency Plan, Carruthers Creek Watershed Plan, Urban Forest Technical Study*

Schedule: Project initiation in 2026, completion in 2027.

Funding: This initiative will be supported through contributions received as part of tree compensation, designated for the planting and replanting of trees.

EXPENDITURES / FUNDING

	Previously Approved	2026	2027	2028	2029-2035	Total
Total Expenditures	**-**	**520,000**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**520,000**
Recoveries - External	-	520,000	-	-	-	520,000
Total Funding	**-**	**520,000**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**520,000**

Town of Ajax Report
Open Session

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Emma Humphries, Policy & Research Analyst
Report Number:	CS-2026-10
Subject:	2026 Municipal Elections - Joint Compliance Audit Committee Terms of Reference
Wards:	All Wards
Date of Meeting:	March 9, 2026
Reference:	N/A

Recommendation:

1. That the by-law to establish a Joint Compliance Audit Committee for the 2026-2030 Council term (ATT-1) be presented to Council for approval on March 23, 2026; and,

2. That the Municipal Clerk be directed to participate in the recruitment of Compliance Audit Committee members through the Joint Compliance Audit Committee with the Regional Municipality of Durham, City of Oshawa, City of Pickering, the Town of Whitby, and the Durham District School Board.

Background:

Pursuant to the requirements under section 88.37 of the *Municipal Elections Act,1996* ("the Act"), all Ontario municipalities must establish a Compliance Audit Committee ("the Committee") prior to a regularly scheduled municipal election. The Committee is mandated to receive applications from electors requesting a compliance audit of a candidate's or third party advertiser's campaign finances, and to consider whether to order an audit. Should the Committee choose to order an audit and the auditor finds that a candidate or third party advertiser has contravened the financial compliance provisions of the Act, the Committee may then decide whether to commence legal proceedings against the candidate or third party advertiser. The Committee also reviews reports from the Clerk regarding any contributors who appear to have exceeded the contribution limits specified in the Act. The Committee then determines whether to commence legal proceedings against the contributors.

The Committee begins accepting applications for compliance audits and Clerk reports after the deadline to file election financial statements has passed (Friday March 27, 2027). Applications must be submitted within 90 days of the relevant deadline for filing the financial statements.

Council's responsibility under the Act is to establish the Committee and appoint its members. The Municipal Clerk is responsible for establishing procedures to be followed by the Committee during a meeting, examining contributions to identify any apparent exceedances of limits, and processing applications for compliance audits.The purpose of this report is to receive Council's approval to establish the Compliance Audit Committee for the 2026-2030 term of office, approve the Committee's Terms of Reference, and provide direction to the Clerk to begin the recruitment process.

Discussion:

The 2022 Municipal Election year was the first year the Town of Ajax ("the Town") participated in the Joint Compliance Audit Committee process with other Durham lakeshore municipalities. Previously, the Town operated its own independent Compliance Audit Committee comprised of three members and one alternate to fill absences. In comparison, the Committee encompassing multiple lower-tier municipalities, school boards and the Region of Durham typically recruits 10-15 members with varying specializations/expertise, who serve as a 'pool' the participating municipalities can draw from, to form a smaller committee when audit applications are received. Participating in a larger Joint Committee allows for more diverse perspectives and expertise to aid in the assessment of potential financial contraventions under the Act. It also allows for a collaborative approach to developing acceptable meeting procedures for the Committee, and having the benefit of learning from the experiences of other Durham municipalities who have processed compliance audit applications of their own.

In the 2022 municipal election, the Town of Ajax received a request from a member of the public for an audit of two candidates. The Committee proved to highly qualified and competent in performing its deliberative and decision-making duties. Informed by this experience following the 2022 municipal election, staff are recommending that the Town once again participate in this Joint Committee process again.

2026 Terms of Reference
The following changes were made for the 2026 Terms of Reference to improve clarity and consistency:

- The addition of the following definitions to increase clarity and comprehension while reviewing the document:
    - **Act** means the Municipal Elections Act, 1996, S.O. 1996, c. 32, as amended from time to time.
    - **Applicant** means the individual who submitted the Application requesting a Compliance Audit.
    - **Application** means an Application accepted by the Clerk under sections 88.33(2) and 88.35(2) of the Act.

  - **Candidate** means the Candidate whose election campaign finances are the subject of an Application for a Compliance Audit.
  - **Registered Third Party** means an individual resident in Ontario, a corporation carrying on business in Ontario or trade union who has filed with the clerk of the municipality responsible for conducting an election, a notice of registration to be a Registered Third Party for the election pursuant to Section 88.6 of the Act, and whose election campaign finances are the subject of an Application for a Compliance Audit.

- An increase in remuneration from $350 to $400 per meeting, with an additional $100 for each application considered per meeting prior to the first meeting. This decision to increase in remuneration was based on feedback from previous committee members and benchmarking of municipal comparators.

- Clarity on the Clerk's role in retaining legal counsel for the Committee when deemed appropriate.

Pending Council approval, Corporate Services will work with other participating municipalities to engage in the recruitment and selection process and bring forward the complete roster of members for Council's approval by way of appointing by-law.

Financial Implications:

Committee Members are provided a small retainer fee to cover attendance at the mandatory training and any conversations that occur outside of a formal meeting of the Committee (i.e., virtual meetings with the Clerk). The costs of the retainer fee will be equally shared by the participating municipalities.

Additionally, members receive a per meeting honorarium and mileage for any meetings of the Committee called to address matters related to the 2026 election in Ajax. The per meeting fee covers the review of background or agenda materials as required for meeting preparation. Costs for operating the Compliance Audit Committee are paid from the Town's Election Reserve.

Communication Issues:

In order for the compliance audit process to be effective, Committee members must recognize the significance of the Committee's role and be committed to supporting a free and fair democratic municipal election. To foster this, Joint Committee participating municipalities will undertake a comprehensive recruitment advertising campaign aimed at attracting highly qualified and impartial volunteers. Town staff will ensure that the opportunity is widely promoted to eligible Ajax residents, including those who have served in this capacity in previous terms of Council.

Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

Establishment of the Compliance Audit Committee is a statutory requirement and does not arise from the Town's Strategic Plan.

Conclusion:

The compliance audit process is a crucial accountability process for municipal elections in Ontario. The Town's participation in the 2022 Joint Committee process provided staff with valuable experience to learn from and access to a highly qualified and skilled roster of members of the Committee. The recommendations in this report, including participation in the Joint Compliance Audit Committee recruitment with our peers across Durham Region, ensure that the Town continues to uphold the integrity of elections and remain prepared to address any potential financial contraventions throughout the 2026-2030 term of Council.

Attachments:

ATT-1: 2026-2030 Compliance Audit Committee By-law and Terms of Reference

Prepared by:

Emma Humphries – Policy & Research Analyst

Submitted by:

Nicole Cooper – Deputy Chief Administrative Officer

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

The Corporation of The Town of Ajax
By-Law XX-2026-Law

Being a By-law to establish a 2026-2030 Election Compliance Audit Committee.

Whereas, Section 88.37(1) of the Municipal Elections Act, 1996, as amended, mandates that a council or local board shall establish a compliance audit committee to address applications requesting a review of a candidate's campaign finances;

Therefore, it is enacted as a By-law of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax as follows:

1. That a 2026-2030 Election Compliance Audit Committee be established under the provisions of the Municipal Elections Act, 1996, as amended;

2. That the attached Terms of Reference shall guide the structure and responsibilities of the 2026-2030 Election Compliance Audit Committee; and

3. That, pursuant to the Municipal Elections Act, 1996, as amended, the 2026-2030 Election Compliance Audit Committee shall serve a term that is concurrent with the term of office of the Council elected in 2026, and shall therefore serve in the instance of any by-election that may take place during that time.

4. That By-law 70-2021 hereby be repealed.

By-law passed this March 23, 2026

_____
Mayor and CEO

_____
Clerk

2026 Municipal & School Board Election
Joint Compliance Audit Committee
Terms of Reference

Name:

The name of the Committee is the "2026 Municipal Election Joint Compliance Audit Committee" ("the Committee").

Definitions:

Act means the Municipal Elections Act, 1996, S.O. 1996, c. 32, as amended from time to time.

Applicant means the individual who submitted the Application requesting a Compliance Audit.

Application means an Application accepted by the Clerk under sections 88.33(2) and 88.35(2) of the Act.

Candidate means the Candidate whose election campaign finances are the subject of an Application for a Compliance Audit.

Clerk means the Clerk or secretary of the Participating Body, or their designate.

Participating Bodies means the Town of Ajax, Regional Municipality of Durham, City of Oshawa, City of Pickering, the Town of Whitby and the Durham District School Board.

Registered Third Party means an individual resident in Ontario, a corporation carrying on business in Ontario or trade union who has filed with the clerk of the municipality responsible for conducting an election, a notice of registration to be a Registered Third Party for the election pursuant to Section 88.6 of the Act, and whose election campaign finances are the subject of an Application for a Compliance Audit.

Mandate:

The Committee is established pursuant to the requirements of section 88.37 of the Act for the Participating Bodies.

The powers and functions of the Committee are set out in section 88.33 to 88.37 of the Act.

Term of Committee:

The term of appointment for the Committee shall be concurrent with the term of office of the council or local board elected in 2026 and shall therefore serve for four (4) years commencing on November 15, 2026 and concluding on November 14, 2030 or until such time the applicable Committee has disposed of any remaining matters in accordance with the Act, whichever is later.

Composition:

When a compliance audit Application from an elector or a report from the Clerk indicating a Candidate or Registered Third Party has contravened any of the contribution limits under section 88.9 of the Act is received, the Committee comprised of three (3) members shall meet and consider the Application and/or report in accordance with the Act.

Members forming the Committee shall be selected by the Clerk from a roster of qualified individuals, who have been jointly recruited and appointed by the Participating Bodies.

The following persons are ineligible for appointment:

- Employees or officers of any of the Participating Bodies,

- A member of council or of a local board of any of the Participating Bodies,

- Any persons who are candidates in an election of any of the Participating Bodies for which the Committee is established; or

- Any persons who are Registered Third Parties in an election of any of the Participating Bodies for which the Committee is established.

Should an appointed Committee Member accept employment or become an officer with any of the Participating Bodies, become a member of council or of a local board of any of the Participating Bodies, or register as a Candidate or a Third Party with any of the Participating Bodies, they will have been deemed to have resigned.

All Committee Members shall agree in writing that they will not work or volunteer for, or contribute to, any Candidate or Registered Third Party in any capacity in an election of any of the Participating Bodies.

If a person on the roster to serve on the Committee is identified as having participated or contributed to a Candidate's campaign or Registered Third Party, that person shall not be eligible to be selected as a Member with respect to an Application within the applicable Participating Body where the participation or contribution to a Candidate’s campaign or Registered Third Party occurred.

Conduct of Members:

Members of the Committee shall comply and conduct themselves in accordance with the Joint Compliance Audit Committee Administrative Practices and Procedures for the Participating Bodies.

Members shall not use their position on the Committee for any personal or political gain.

Remuneration:

Remuneration for Committee Members will be as follows:

- $400.00 retainer fee (costs will be shared equally by the Participating Bodies) for those individuals on the roster. The retainer fee shall cover attendance at a mandatory training session and review of periodic updates or information supplied by the Clerk of any of the Participating Bodies. The retainer fee will also cover any conversations which occur outside of a formal meeting of the Committee, for example virtual meetings with the Clerk. Payment of the retainer fee does not denote membership on a committee and covers the four (4) year term; and

- $400.00 per meeting attended, plus an additional $100.00 for any additional Application and report being considered after the first one, during the same meeting; plus mileage in accordance with the rate normally paid to employees of the applicable Participating Body. The per meeting rate shall cover review of background or agenda materials as required in preparation for a meeting.

Membership Selection:

At a minimum, the recruitment of persons to be included on the roster of individuals shall be advertised on the websites of the Participating Bodies.
Other targeted recruitment measures may be initiated by the Clerks of the Participating Bodies.

All applicants will be required to complete an application and may be subject to further screening and an interview. The selection process will be determined by the Clerks of the Participating Bodies.

Applicants must have the ability to understand and apply the election campaign finance

provisions of the Act and must remain impartial in order to fulfill their responsibilities.

Preference will be given to candidates that have experience related to compliance audit activities or investigative or adjudicative processes.

The following criteria will be considered when considering members:

- Demonstrated knowledge and understanding of municipal election campaign finance rules,
- Proven analytical and decision-making skills,
- Experience working on committees, boards, adjudicative bodies, task forces or similar settings,
- Experience in accounting and audit, law, law enforcement, academics, or municipal administration from related fields,
- Demonstrated knowledge of quasi-judicial proceedings,
- Availability and willingness to attend meetings; and,
- Excellent oral and written communication skills.

Meetings:

Meetings will occur as needed and shall be conducted in accordance with the Joint Compliance Audit Committee Administrative Practices and Procedures for the Participating Bodies.

Chair:

At the first meeting of a Committee on a particular report or Application, the members shall appoint one member to act as Chair for the duration of the Committee's deliberations.

Role of Clerk:

The Clerk will act as the main contact between the Committee, compliance audit Applicant, Candidate and Registered Third Party. In accordance with section 88.37(6) of the Act, the Clerk shall carry out any duties required under the Act to implement the Committee's decisions.

Where the Clerk or Committee determines that the Committee requires legal assistance in respect of a specific report or Application, or for other matters such as the Committee's role, interpretation of legislation, procedure, or other matters of a general nature pertinent to the Committee's business, the Clerk, in consultation with the Participating Body's solicitor, shall retain legal counsel to provide advice that may be subject to solicitor client privilege to the Committee.

Administrative Practices and Procedures:

The Clerk(s) of the Participating Bodies shall establish administrative practices and procedures for the Committee in accordance with s. 88.37(6) of the Act and shall carry out any other duties under the Act to implement the Committee's decisions.

The Clerk(s) of the Participating Bodies may be required to make administrative changes to these Terms of Reference or the administrative practices and procedures from time to time due to legislative changes, or if, in the opinion of the Clerk(s), the amendments do not change the intent of the Terms of Reference or the administrative practices and procedures.

Town of Ajax Report
Open Session

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Jaclyn Grossi, Municipal Clerk
Report Number:	CSD-2026-11
Subject:	Customer Service Strategy Update
Wards:	All Wards
Date of Meeting:	March 9, 2026
Reference:	LIS-2023-18 Customer Service Strategy

Recommendation:

That the Customer Service Strategy Update be received for information.

Background:

In December 2023, Council endorsed the Town of Ajax Customer Service Strategy. The strategy established a long-term vision to deliver a consistently positive customer experience across all service channels and identified key focus areas related to service standards, technology enablement, staff capacity, and data driven decision-making. term vision to deliver a consistently positive customer experience across all service channels and identified key focus areas related to service standards, technology enablement, staff capacity, and data driven decision-making.

Since endorsement, staff have been advancing the strategy through a phased and coordinated implementation approach, with an emphasis on defining a consistent customer experience, deploying modern service delivery tools, and supporting staff to deliver service excellence. While important foundational work has been completed, customer service and customer experience are ongoing and evolving areas of focus. The initiatives outlined in this report represent highlights of the early achievements to date toward a long-term vision that will continue to require sustained attention, refinement, and investment over time. -term vision that will continue to require sustained attention, refinement, and investment over time.

Discussion:

A number of initiatives have been launched across the Town to begin defining consistent service expectations, introducing valuable tools, and supporting staff in delivering customer focused service. At the same time, staff recognize that customer service and customer experience are never static and will continue to evolve as

community needs, service channels, and expectations change. At the same time, staff recognize that customer service and customer experience are never static and will continue to evolve as community needs, service channels, and expectations change.

The Customer Service Strategy is grounded in five guiding principles that continue to inform implementation activities:

- Consistent customer experience
- Customer choice in how services are accessed
- Easy to navigate services
- Staff equipped with the tools and knowledge to succeed
- Use of data to improve customer service

To operationalize these principles, the strategy is delivered through three strategic pillars: Define the Experience, Deploy the Tools, and Elevate the Delivery.

Define the Experience

Work undertaken to date has focused on beginning to establish a shared understanding of what customers can expect when interacting with the Town of Ajax. Initial steps included the formation of a corporate Customer Experience Team with representation from across departments to support coordination, shared learning, and alignment. Regular meetings have helped initiate corporate conversations around customer experience, with the understanding that ongoing collaboration will be required as services and expectations continue to evolve. The variety of perspectives that each department brings to the Team is critical to developing policies that reflect the entire corporation.

Corporate Customer Service Standards and Accessible Customer Service Standards have been developed and introduced across customer-facing channels. These standards provide a foundation for consistency while allowing flexibility to respond to service-specific needs. Continued reinforcement, refinement, and integration into daily operations will remain necessary.

Customer service behaviours were formalized into a clear service promise that will be launched as part of the Town's annual staff Customer Service Appreciation Week event in October 2026. This promise is intended to guide staff interactions and decision-making and is being embedded gradually through training, communication, and day-to-day practice.

Training delivered to date has focused on reintroducing service standards and expectations to all staff to ensure that everyone continues to provide services to our customers in alignment with the Council approved standards. Ongoing training and reinforcement will remain essential to sustaining and strengthening the customer experience over time.

Performance measurement has also begun to evolve, with the introduction of automated customer feedback surveys, refreshed in-person feedback opportunities, and the establishment of key indicators that will allow staff to make data-informed decisions on future customer experience policies. These metrics are intended to encourage learning and improvement rather than represent a final or complete measurement framework.

Deploy the Tools

The Town has begun deploying modern tools to support more consistent service delivery, recognizing that technology is an enabler rather than a solution on its own.

Dynamics 365 was selected and implemented as the Town's corporate Customer Relationship Management (CRM) platform, providing a centralized approach to service request intake, tracking, and reporting. The launch of the HeyJAX public portal platform, including 49 service request types, a knowledge base, and a feedback loop, represents an important step toward improved and centralized customer interactions. Future phases will likely include additional integrations of major, mature, compatible systems and applications that allow for seamless case management throughout Town offered services, and expansion of the service request types.

Several system integrations and self-service options have been introduced or enhanced, including online applications, planning dashboards, a business directory, and marriage licence modernization portal. Staff workplans and IT project forecasting prioritize additional digital and self-service options for customers and access to our existing services.

Analytics and reporting capabilities have also been introduced through dashboards and reporting tools. These capabilities are intended to support informed decision-making and continuous improvement and will continue to mature over time. Additionally, expanded reporting and quality control measures such as call recording for spot checks and continuous improvements are being explored in future phases.

Elevate the Delivery

Initial efforts to elevate service delivery have focused on understanding existing processes, onboarding departments, and beginning to use data and feedback to inform change. Staff are reviewing current process and applications to ensure that we are offering the best services to our customers, such as conducting utilization review of Language Line to optimize its value to customers and staff and ensure trusted language supports.

Process mapping activities were completed for service requests included in the CRM to better understand current workflows and identify opportunities for improvement and process optimization. These exercises highlighted both efficiencies and complexities across service areas, reinforcing the need for ongoing collaboration and innovation.

Departments have received training related to new tools and self-service options, and early efforts have been made to improve inquiry management, website content, and knowledge resources. These initiatives represent steps toward a more coordinated and customer focused service delivery model. Early efforts have been made to improve inquiry management, website content, and knowledge resources. These initiatives represent steps toward a more coordinated and customer focused service delivery model.

Feedback intake is being centralized and reporting practices established; however, staff recognize that performance measurement and service improvement will continue to evolve as data quality, tools, and processes mature.

Financial Implications:

There are no financial implications associated with the Customer Service Strategy Update. Any future initiatives arising from the strategy will continue to be considered through the Town's annual budget and approval processes.

Communication Issues:

Progress on the Customer Service Strategy has been communicated internally through training, staff engagement, and corporate updates. External communication continues through digital platforms, service portals, and customer feedback mechanisms.

Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

The completion of the Customer Service Strategy fulfilled a strategic priority of Council in 2024. As staff continue to make progress on the deliverables, we continue to support the priority of readying our organization for the future and ensuring efficient and effective service delivery.

Conclusion:

Staff have undertaken a wide range of initiatives to begin implementing the Customer Service Strategy. These efforts have established important foundations, including clearer service expectations, initial technology enablement, and improved access to customer feedback. At the same time, staff recognize that customer service and customer experience are never fully complete. They are continuous, evolving areas of focus that must adapt to changing community needs, service demands, and expectations. As such, customer service and customer experience will remain top of mind for staff, with continued emphasis on learning, refinement, and collaboration across the Town.

Attachments:

ATT-1: N/A

Prepared by:

Jaclyn Grossi, Municipal Clerk

Submitted by:

Nicole Cooper – Deputy Chief Administrative Officer

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

Town of Ajax Report
Open Session

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Nicole Cooper, Deputy CAO
Report Number:	CSD-2026-12
Subject:	Follow-up to Council Motion re Liquor Service Policies
Wards:	All Wards
Date of Meeting:	March 9, 2026
Reference:	RC-2025-04: Rotary Park Pavilion Concession – Liquor License Pilot

Recommendation:

1. That staff be authorized to proceed with an Expression of Interest process to explore potential alcohol sales pilot projects for the 2026 summer season at Paradise Park and the Audley Sportsplex Pinwheel; and,
2. That staff be authorized to take the necessary actions to implement such pilot projects pending receipt of suitable proposals.

Background:

In June 2025, staff brought a report to Council which contemplated the introduction of liquor sales from the Rotary Park Pavilion. In response to that report, Council passed the following resolution:

> *That RC-2025-04: Rotary Park Pavilion Concession – Liquor License Pilot be referred to staff to report back with details regarding expansion of the program at additional locations and/or Town events, by the February 2026 General Government Committee (GGC) Meeting, including a draft liquor sales license pilot policy.*

An internal staff committee was formed to scope the project and examine various matters related to liquor policies across Town. A public survey was also conducted to gauge community sentiments around liquor permissions within the Town of Ajax. The Committee considered the following aspects of liquor service:

1. Public sentiment and municipal/provincial trends around alcohol service;

2. The Town's Municipal Alcohol Policy (primarily governs Special Occasion Permit [SOP] events)
   - This includes Municipally Significant Event designations and new legislative changes regarding "bring your own"
3. Facilities with perpetual Liquor Licenses
4. Potential for seasonal liquor service in Town outdoor amenities (e.g. seasonal beer garden)
5. Review of municipal permissions for "bring your own" liquor in designated parks (e.g. Toronto and Ottawa)

Discussion:

The Town's review of liquor-related policies and practices was informed, in large part, by the results of an IMO survey conducted over two weeks in January 2026. In addition, staff considered broader provincial trends related to alcohol policy and applied this perspective when evaluating various aspects of liquor service within Ajax. Accordingly, this report begins by outlining the survey findings and relevant provincial policy, as they formed a foundational component of staff's overall review.

Provincial and Municipal Trends

Over the past decade, and particularly since 2023–2024, Ontario has clearly signaled a policy shift toward a more open and flexible alcohol marketplace, emphasizing consumer choice, convenience, and alignment with other provinces. The provincial government has undertaken what it describes as the largest expansion of alcohol retail access since the end of prohibition. Through a phased rollout completed in 2024, the Province enabled beer, wine, cider, and ready to drink beverages to be sold not only in licensed grocery stores but also in convenience and big box stores across Ontario, dramatically increasing the number of points of sale and normalizing alcohol as part of everyday retail environments. This direction has been framed by the Province as "modernization" and a deliberate effort to treat consumers "like adults," while supporting local producers and hospitality businesses. Further evidence of this shift includes the Province's recent regulatory changes replacing traditional "tailgate" rules with a broader "bring-your-own" (BYOB) event framework, allowing attendees at designated community, cultural, and sporting events to bring and consume their own alcohol, subject to municipal designation and oversight.

At the municipal level, large cities such as Toronto and Ottawa have moved to permit personal alcohol consumption in select public parks through pilot programs and permanent by-law amendments, demonstrating a growing acceptance of controlled alcohol use in public spaces when supported by clear rules, designated areas, and enforcement safeguards. Taken together, these actions demonstrate a clear trend toward relaxing traditional controls and encouraging municipalities to adapt their local policies to reflect a more flexible, contemporary approach to alcohol regulation consistent with provincial intent.

For municipalities, this provincial shift matters because local liquor related policies operate within — and should arguably align with — a more permissive and normalized provincial framework. As rules governing where and how alcohol may be sold and consumed evolve in Ontario, municipalities are on the front line of implementation

through aspects like patio permissions, event approvals, regulatory by-laws, and enforcement practices. Policies that remain overly restrictive or misaligned with provincial intent risk creating unnecessary barriers for local businesses, generating confusion for residents, and placing municipalities out of step with evolving provincial standards and norms. By modernizing local liquor related policies, municipalities can ensure regulatory coherence, support consistent enforcement, and respond to changing community expectations while continuing to meet their responsibilities for health, safety, and good governance.

Importantly, increased flexibility in liquor related policies does not equate to reduced oversight or diminished public safety. Provincial reforms have been accompanied by a continued emphasis on responsible service, clear licensing requirements, and enforcement through the Alcohol and Gaming Commission of Ontario (AGCO), with municipalities retaining tools to manage impacts through regulatory by-laws or other means. Many Ontario municipalities have demonstrated that modernized alcohol policies — including expanded patios, diverse retail formats, and flexible event permissions — can coexist with strong risk management, education, and compliance measures. A balanced approach allows municipalities to mitigate potential harms while avoiding unnecessarily prohibitive rules that can stifle activity and innovation. In this context, policy flexibility is best understood not as deregulation, but as a shift toward proportionate, evidence-based controls that reflect current provincial direction and community norms.

From an economic development standpoint, adopting more flexible liquor policies supports local restaurants, breweries, wineries, and event organizers by enhancing competitiveness and contributing to the vibrancy of community spaces. By aligning municipal policies with this direction, there is increased potential to attract investment, foster tourism, and strengthen the local economy.

Municipalities across Ontario are leveraging these new provincial policies to stimulate tourism and economic activity in their communities through a variety of approaches. Examples include the introduction of licensed “pedal pubs” on quadricycles in Toronto, Ottawa and Niagara regions; and extending patio permissions into laneways and along commercial streets to drive visitation and visitor spending in commercial areas, like Dundas Place in London or as part of the Love Kingston Marketplace in downtown Kingston.

The broadened permissions for alcohol sales and consumption during special events also now permit “street festivals”, which permit patrons to move freely with alcoholic beverages, creating a more relaxed, "street-festival" atmosphere that increases visitor engagement and encourages spending at nearby local businesses or vendors.

Public Sentiment and Local Survey Results

An IMO survey was conducted in January 2026. Based on the results, there is a clear indication that respondents favour a more flexible approach to municipal alcohol policies. A total of 406 participants completed the survey, the majority of whom (approximately 85%) identified as Ajax residents, providing strong local relevance to the findings. Support for expanded and adaptable alcohol service options was high: over

80% of respondents supported expanding the list of Town locations eligible for temporary SOPs, such as additional indoor pavilions. Similarly, nearly 70% felt the Town should take a “more flexible or more commonplace” approach to allowing temporary, event-specific outdoor liquor service, compared to smaller proportions favouring the status quo or a more restrictive approach. This preference for flexibility was further reinforced by strong support (approximately 77%) for establishing perpetual liquor licences at additional locations, including seasonal patios or beer gardens. Overall, the survey demonstrates a community leaning toward modernized, flexible alcohol-related policies that enable a broader range of events and locations, while only a relatively small minority expressed opposition or significant reservations.

Based on a review of the open-ended survey responses, several clear and recurring themes emerge that both reinforce and contextualize the quantitative results. Many respondents expressed strong support for greater flexibility in municipal alcohol policies, frequently citing opportunities to enhance community vibrancy, attract visitors, support local businesses (particularly breweries and event vendors), and generate additional municipal revenue. The waterfront was repeatedly identified as a key opportunity, with numerous respondents pointing to Whitby as a successful and close by comparator, and describing patios, beer gardens, festivals, and licensed events as desirable amenities that would encourage people to gather and spend time in Ajax. A common sentiment among supporters was that adults should be treated as responsible individuals, with alcohol viewed as a normal part of social and cultural life when managed through permits, trained servers, and appropriate controls.

At the same time, a substantial subset of responses raised consistent cautions that help frame how flexibility could be implemented responsibly. These concerns focused on public safety, particularly impaired driving, proximity to playgrounds and family-oriented spaces, underage access, noise, litter, and the need for adequate enforcement and staffing. Many respondents who were not opposed in principle emphasized that any expansion should be limited to specific locations or events, include clear boundaries, require Smart Serve–trained staff, and preserve alcohol-free spaces for families and those who prefer them. Overall, the open responses suggest broad conditional support for a more flexible and modernized approach to alcohol policies, provided that expansion is carefully designed, well-regulated, and sensitive to location, safety, and community character considerations.

Municipal Alcohol Policy (MAP)

The Town has a Municipal Alcohol Policy, the vast majority of which covers rules for ‘Special Occasion Permit’ events. An AGCO Special Occasion Permit (SOP) in Ontario is a permit issued by the AGCO that allows individuals or organizations to sell and/or serve alcohol at a specific event, location, and time that would not otherwise be licensed. It is commonly used for weddings, community festivals, fundraisers, small parties and other one-time or short-term events. Municipal Alcohol Policies generally reflect the AGCO’s requirements and sometimes impose additional regulatory requirements. MAPs generally cover the following:

- Roles and responsibilities – outlining the expectations of permit holders, event organizers, municipal staff, volunteers, and third-party operators to ensure alcohol is served responsibly and in compliance with AGCO requirements.
- Event and site requirements – including approved locations, requirements for outdoor SOPs, capacity limits, hours of alcohol service, signage requirements, etc.
- Risk management and public safety measures – such as requirements for trained servers (e.g., Smart Serve), security staffing, intoxication prevention, incident reporting, etc.
- Application, approval, and enforcement processes – describing municipal review timelines, required documentation, insurance and indemnification, and consequences for non-compliance or violations.

Staff undertook a comprehensive review of the Town's existing MAP. Much of its content replicates AGCO requirements, however several areas were identified for potential change and/or improvement, namely:

- The document will be re-formatted to focus attention on true "policy" matters, whereas more specific regulatory and risk management requirements for permit-holders will be detailed in an Appendix to the policy;
- Staff propose to add flexibility to the list of indoor locations where SOPs are permitted. Specifically, it is proposed that several Town pavilions be added to the list of allowable locations (which currently includes areas within the 3 Community Centres, Town Hall, the St. Francis Centre, and Quaker Meeting House). In addition, it will be proposed that the Senior Management Team have the ability to define the list of allowable locations rather than having the list firmly prescribed by Council policy; this change would reflect a common approach in other municipalities.
- Risk Management review – further analysis is required to ensure the optimal utilization of 'levers' to manage risks (e.g. insurance, deposits, event supervision); currently, the Town provides a level of supervision and rule prescription to SOP events, even small ones, that appears to be in excess of what is found in other municipalities. An updated MAP will seek to maintain appropriate risk mitigation while making the application process for SOP events less cumbersome for permit holders, and where risk measures are more tailored to the risk profile of a given event;
- Municipally Significant Events (MSE):
    - The Town's current MAP references, at a high level, the process for obtaining a MSE designation. A MSE designation is required to obtain a Public SOP in Ontario when a public event, not hosted by a registered charity or non-profit, intends to sell or serve alcohol;
    - A MSE in Ontario is a public event officially designated by a local municipality in order to obtain an SOP, that benefits the community by promoting social, cultural, or economic development, or has historical/cultural importance, requiring municipal council approval (or delegated authority) for the designation. These events are typically open to the public, have set times, and aim to build community awareness or support local charities, with the final approval resting with the AGCO after municipal endorsement. This presents an opportunity for the municipality

to impose appropriate conditions and control (i.e. insurance, traffic controls, noise mitigation, public health and safety safeguards, etc.)
    - In 2012, Council delegated authority to the Clerk & Manager of Bylaw Services to approve MSE designations; however, given the current structure in Ajax, the Public and Strategic Affairs department may now be the more appropriate decision-maker. Further, the process is very informal compared to other municipalities, at present; there is no well-defined application or review process. These matters will be addressed in an updated MAP.
- 2026 “Bring Your Own” Legislative Changes:
    - Effective January 1, 2026, the definition of a "tailgate event" has been expanded to include cultural and community events. Previously, these permits were strictly limited to outdoor events held in connection with professional, semi-professional, or post-secondary sporting events.
    - As of April 30, 2026, the terminology "tailgate" will be replaced with "bring-your-own" throughout the provincial regulations.
    - To host a "bring-your-own" event for community or cultural purposes, applicants must now obtain a MSE designation from the relevant municipality before applying to the AGCO. These permits remain the only type of SOP that legally allows attendees to bring and consume their own alcohol within a permitted area.
    - Staff will be updating the MAP to reflect these legislative changes, and incorporate “bring-your-own” events into the MSE application and approval process.

Staff are currently in the process of finalizing an updated MAP which will be presented to Council for consideration prior to summer recess.

Facilities with Perpetual Liquor Licenses

At present, the Town only operates one facility that maintains a perpetual liquor license, being the St. Francis Centre. In addition, the Town has leased several of its owned properties at various points in time, where the lessee has obtained a form of liquor license as a private operator (e.g. Riverside Golf Course, Mill St. Fire Hall).

At present, staff are not proposing to obtain new perpetual liquor licenses for any of its owned and operated facilities. For facilities leased to a private operator, such as those referenced above, there is no need to develop over-arching ‘policy’ to address their service of alcohol, as every scenario is unique. License-holders are heavily regulated by the AGCO, and any additional terms and conditions important to the Town could be addressed within the terms of the lease, based on the unique circumstances of that property.

Proposed Pilot Projects for 2026 Summer Season

The June 2025 staff report “Rotary Park Pavilion Concession – Liquor License Pilot” was presented because the current concession operator at the Rotary Park Pavilion had requested permission to sell alcohol. While alcohol sales from the Rotary Concession may be possible and desirable in the future, this facility presents a more complex case.

Rotary Park is a shared facility where a portion offers a privately-operated concession, but other portions are heavily relied upon for town-run camps and private event rentals. It has not yet been fully contemplated how existing Town uses and regular alcohol service might co-exist within the facility. Further, the Rotary Park Pavilion Feasibility Study is currently underway and set to be completed in 2026. This will inform the overall vision for the Rotary Park area and facility use, and it is advisable to complete this process before moving forward with significant use changes or new offerings at this location. Staff are instead proposing pilots at two other Town locations, which are detailed below; should these proceed, they will provide useful learnings for the potential introduction of alcohol sales at Rotary Pavilion in future years.

In the Fall of 2025, staff received two unsolicited proposals from two Durham-based small businesses, interested in operating a seasonal beer-garden with food service along the Ajax waterfront for the 2026 summer season. While both proponents were flexible in terms of location, the greatest interest appeared to be for Paradise Park, with some interest in the Love Crescent Parking lot area and to a lesser degree, the Carruthers Marsh and Rotary Park Pavilions. Internal staff discussions led to the conclusion that Paradise Park offered the most desirable location for a pilot project for a variety of reasons, mainly the presence of washrooms, parking availability, considerable distance from residential properties, and the general desirability of the space. Portions of Paradise Park are owned by TRCA and operated by Town under a Management Agreement, which requires the Town to obtain TRCA permission for leases. On a concept basis, TRCA has indicated an openness to such a proposal pending Council support and refinement of further details.

Staff examined the existing Whitby waterfront beer garden in order to understand how such a model might operate within Ajax. In the case of Whitby, the Town leases outdoor space at the Port of Whitby to a private operator, who operates the beer garden and an accompanying food service, operated independently and with little to no involvement from the Town. It operates generally through May to October with hours between 11:00 a.m. and 9:00 p.m. The lease provides that the use is restricted to food and beverage operations and related activities, and requires the tenant to obtain and maintain an AGCO liquor sales license. The tenant is responsible for all taxes, power, waste, staffing, site cleanliness, inventory control and security, and meeting public health requirements. Generally, it is a short-term, highly controlled municipal lease where the financial and operational risk sits almost entirely with the tenant, and with strong municipal protection around liquor licensing, insurance, reputation, and termination flexibility. The lease appears designed to support a pilot-style pop-up rather than a permanent or long-term tenancy, and could serve as a useful model for the Ajax waterfront. Bylaw Enforcement in Whitby has confirmed that while the beer garden adds parking pressures in the area, it has not generated any notable public nuisance issues, (waste, noise, etc.).

Staff have also identified the Audley Sportsplex Pinwheel as a desirable location for an alcohol service pilot. Currently, there is no concession operator for this location. The Pinwheel would, in concept, operate differently from the proposed Paradise Park option; in the case of Audley, the Town would seek an operator who would have exclusive use of the Pinwheel. However, unlike a potential Paradise Park beer garden, it would not

necessarily operate during fixed, regular, hours, but rather during events such as large baseball tournaments or other sporting events.

Given the receipt of more than 1 proposal for a 2026 pilot, it is proposed that staff undertake a formal Expression of Interest process to intake proposals for the above described pilots (Paradise Park & Audley Sportsplex Pinwheel). Rather than being too prescriptive with design and operating elements, the Town would prefer a more open-ended process that invites the creativity of local businesses. Staff would review and score the proposals against established criteria and determine how to move forward in time for the 2026 season.

Potential Future Pilot: "Bring-Your-Own" Alcohol in Designated Parks

As part of its broader review, staff also considered the potential for a future pilot project that would permit personal consumption of alcohol in select, designated outdoor park spaces. Several large Canadian municipalities, including the Cities of Ottawa and Toronto, have implemented such pilots and permanent programs with generally positive outcomes, supported by clear boundaries, defined locations, signage, and public education. These initiatives have demonstrated that, when thoughtfully designed, allowing personal alcohol consumption in limited park settings can coexist with public safety, family use, and respectful shared enjoyment of public space.

While this model is considered promising and aligned with evolving provincial and municipal trends, staff are not recommending its implementation at this time. Given the Town's current focus on gradually introducing flexibility through more structured and controlled pilot initiatives, it is proposed that consideration of a "bring-your-own" park pilot be deferred to a future term of Council. This phased approach would allow the Town to build experience, assess public response to initial pilot projects, and ensure that any future expansion of alcohol permissions is well understood, broadly supported, and introduced in a manner that aligns with community expectations.

Financial Implications:

There are no financial implications arising from the recommendations contained herein.

However, certain initiatives proposed within this report would have the potential to generate new revenue for the Town. The expansion of allowable SOP locations has the potential to generate modest additional revenue, and a potential beer garden pilot project at Paradise Park, and service at the ARC Pinwheel could also generate license revenue for the Town. The particulars would be determined as part of lease/license agreement negotiations.

Communication Issues:

Should Council endorse the recommended approach, staff will develop an appropriate communications plan to ensure transparency and clarity with residents, stakeholders, and potential proponents. This will include clearly communicating the intent, scope, and limitations of any proposed pilot projects, and that any pilots will be subject to necessary

regulatory and operational controls. Communication efforts will focus on managing expectations, outlining how public safety and community impacts will be addressed, and providing opportunities for feedback as pilots are implemented and evaluated.

Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

The proposals contained herein support various Strategic Plan initiatives related to supports for business, a thriving local economy, and safe and vibrant community spaces.

Conclusion:

The review undertaken in response to Council's direction confirms that liquor related policies in Ajax are operating within an evolving provincial and municipal context. Provincial reforms, comparator practices, and local survey results indicate growing acceptance of more flexible approaches to alcohol service, provided that appropriate safeguards remain in place to support public safety and regulatory compliance. Community feedback demonstrates strong support for expanding and modernizing the Town's approach to liquor service, particularly through controlled, location specific, and event-based permissions. At the same time, residents emphasized the importance of thoughtful implementation, including clear boundaries, enforcement, and the preservation of alcohol-free spaces.

In response, staff are recommending a balanced and incremental approach. Updates to the Municipal Alcohol Policy will modernize and streamline the Town's framework while aligning with recent legislative changes. The proposed Expression of Interest process will allow the Town to explore limited pilot projects at select locations in a structured manner that manages risk and protects municipal interests. Together, these actions position the Town to respond to evolving expectations while gaining practical experience before considering broader policy changes.

Attachments:

ATT-1: IMO Survey Results

Prepared by:

Nicole Cooper – Deputy Chief Administrative Officer

Submitted by:

Nicole Cooper – Deputy Chief Administrative Officer

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

Project Report

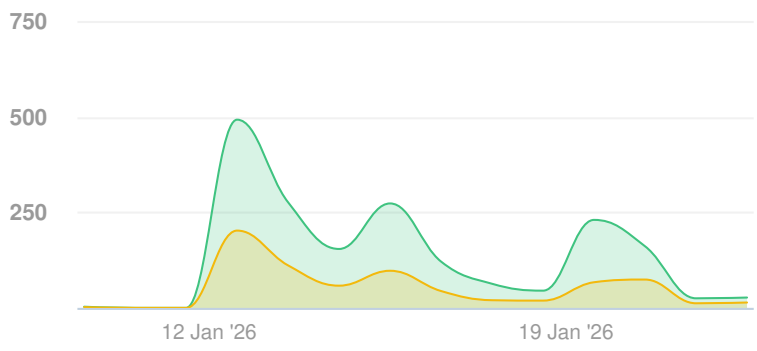
08 January 2019 - 22 January 2026

In My Opinion

Municipal Alcohol Policy

GRANICUS

Visitors Summary



Pageviews Visitors

Highlights

TOTAL VISITS
797

MAX VISITORS PER DAY
202

NEW REGISTRATIONS
0

ENGAGED VISITORS
403

INFORMED VISITORS
513

AWARE VISITORS
682

Aware Participants	682
Aware Actions Performed	Participants
Visited a Project or Tool Page	682

Informed Participants	513
Informed Actions Performed	Participants
Viewed a video	0
Viewed a photo	0
Downloaded a document	0
Visited the Key Dates page	7
Visited an FAQ list Page	0
Visited Instagram Page	0
Visited Multiple Project Pages	104
Contributed to a tool (engaged)	403

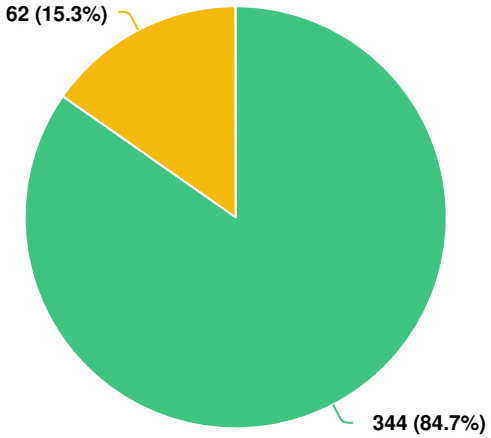
Engaged Participants	403		
Engaged Actions Performed	Registered	Unverified	Anonymous
Contributed on Forums	0	0	0
Participated in Surveys	1	0	402
Contributed to Newsfeeds	0	0	0
Participated in Quick Polls	0	0	0
Posted on Guestbooks	0	0	0
Contributed to Stories	0	0	0
Asked Questions	0	0	0
Placed Pins on Places	0	0	0
Contributed to Ideas	0	0	0

ENGAGEMENT TOOL: SURVEY TOOL

Municipal Alcohol Policy Survey

Visitors 519	Contributors 403	CONTRIBUTIONS 406

Are you an Ajax resident?



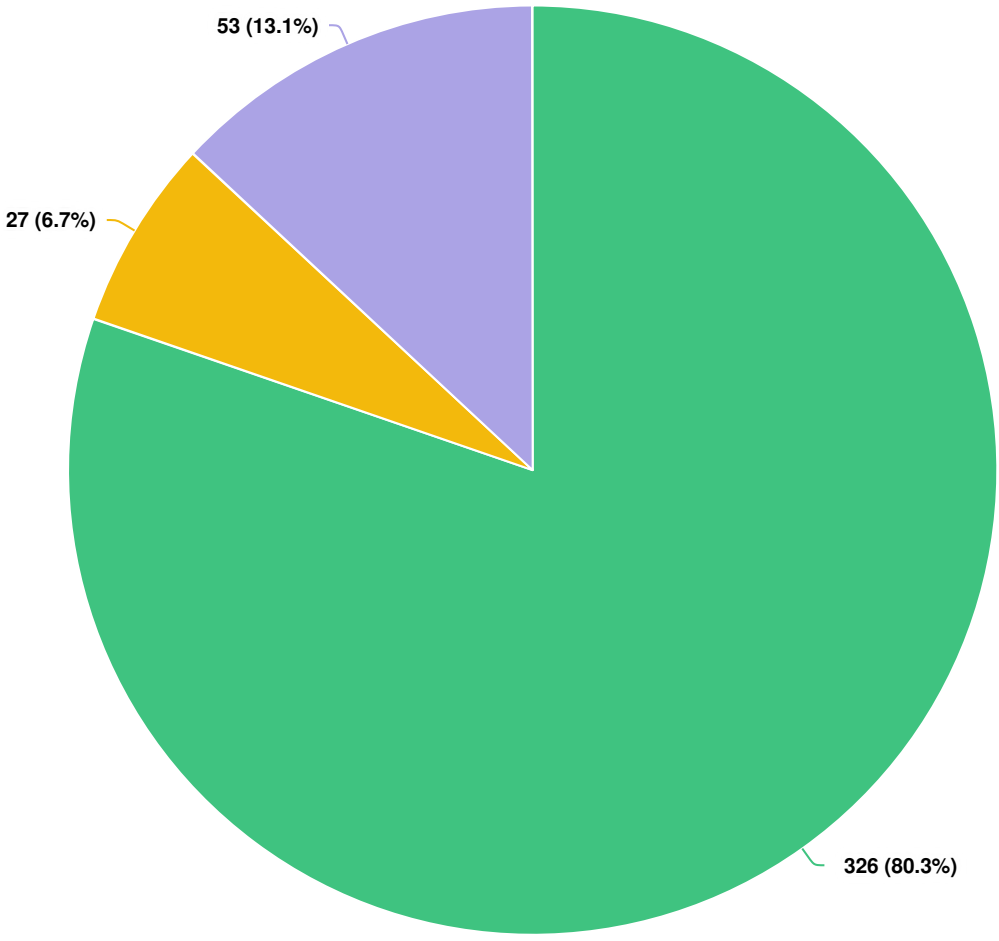
Question options

Yes No

Mandatory Question (406 response(s))

Question type: Radio Button Question

Would you support expanding the above list to permit temporary liquor service (SOPs) at additional Town locations (i.e. some or all of its indoor pavilions)?



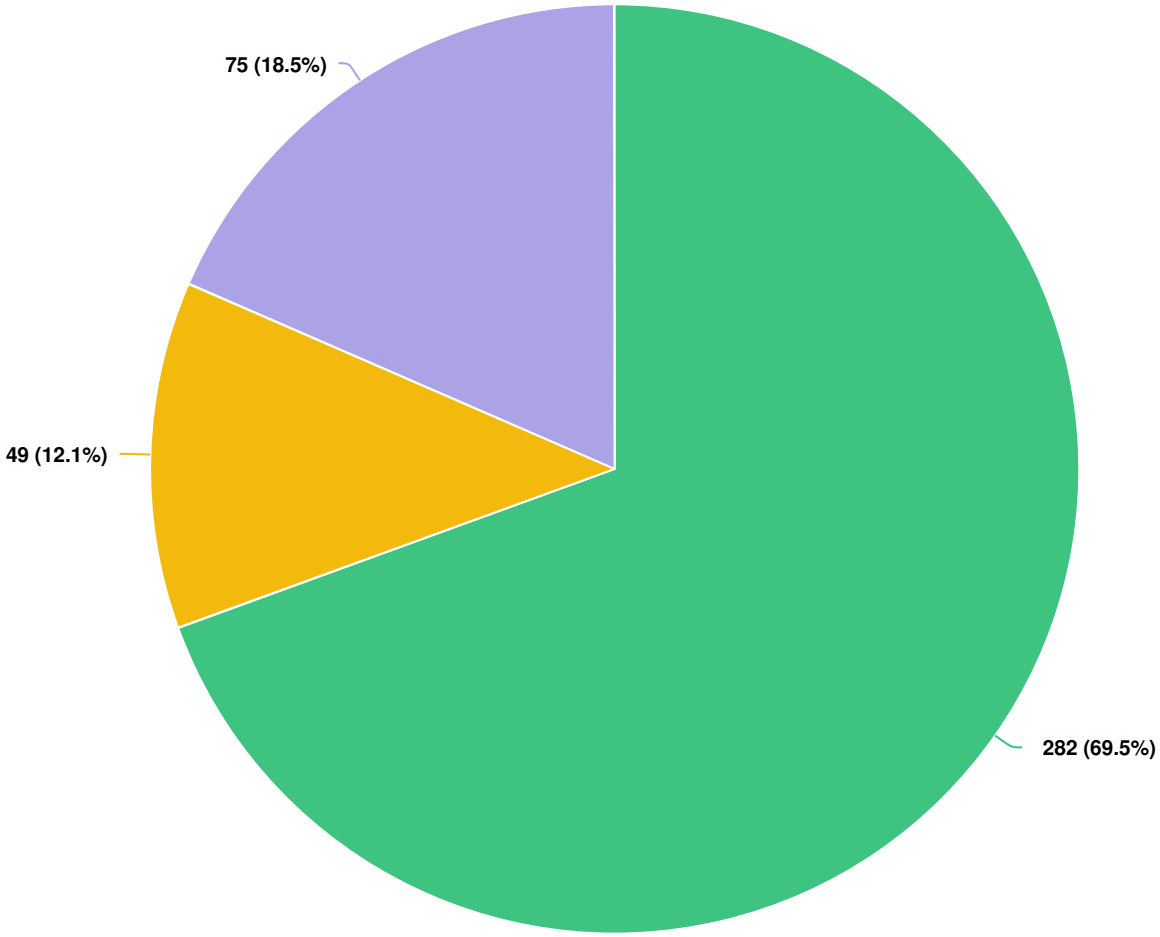
Question options

Support | Not sure/some reservations | Do not support

Mandatory Question (406 response(s))

Question type: Radio Button Question

Generally, what approach do you think the Town should take when it comes to allowing temporary event-specific outdoor liquor service?



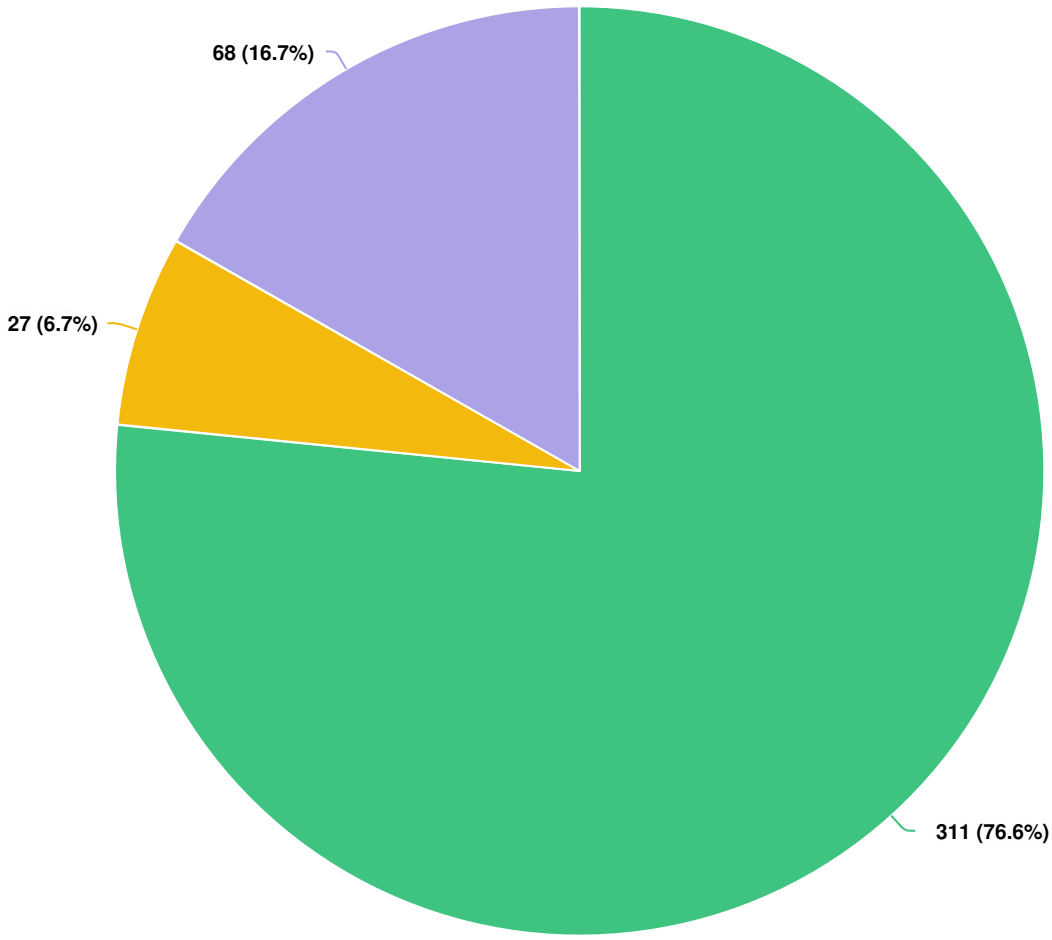
Question options

- More flexible/more commonplace
- Status quo
- More cautious/restrictive

Mandatory Question (406 response(s))

Question type: Radio Button Question

Would you support a perpetual Liquor License at additional locations, such as a seasonal outdoor patio or beer garden along the waterfront (similar to the Whitby lakefront), or seasonal sale of beer and/or alcohol from the Rotary Park Pavilion conc...



Question options

Support | Not sure/some reservations | Do not support

Mandatory Question (406 response(s))

Question type: Radio Button Question

SURVEY QUESTIONS

Q1 Please provide additional comments

Screen Name Redacted
1/12/2026 01:38 PM

To much of a risk for drunk driving.

Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 01:44 PM	Allowing for alcohol permits at more publicly funded spaces will help increase town revenue through the permitting process and by increasing the number of guests visiting from out of town.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 01:52 PM	Additional revenue through alcohol sales would be beneficial to residents.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 02:46 PM	There shoukd be more choice and potential revenue opportunities for the Town.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 03:19 PM	Concerned about Alcohol being allowed in Pavillions close to playgrounds
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 04:09 PM	Supervised and managed properly, whats the harm
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 05:51 PM	Alcohol is too prevalent in our society. It’s too accessible out of events
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 05:58 PM	All pavilions should permit alcohol service
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 06:16 PM	Would totally depend on the locations.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 06:18 PM	Would like an example of the pavilions being considered.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 06:58 PM	Rented out a place at ACC. It was so expensive to have alcohol. We needed people with credentials and bar tenders.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 06:59 PM	Drinking and driving is becoming an increasingly huge issue and opens the town up to liability
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 07:27 PM	We do not need alcohol in Public Parks where it can be abused and not controlled

Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 07:47 PM	Only if additional Town Staff can monitor
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 08:18 PM	Drinking alcohol in public places promotes drunk driving and we all know what can happen with that.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 09:27 PM	It really does depend where. The list you have is fairly extensive. Not even sure it's necessary to expand it.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 09:38 PM	Alcohol is item used as part of social celebrations and just social interactions in general. I would be fully supportive if an expansion.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 09:50 PM	I think this is a great way to support small business!
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 09:51 PM	This would be great for the community!
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 10:02 PM	Local craft breweries would be best as it supports local business
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 10:04 PM	I think this is a great idea
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 10:22 PM	It's important to be able to ensure appropriate controls so that persons below the age do not gain access. Expansion might not ensure these safeguards.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 10:53 PM	It would be nice to host more events, serving wine for guests would be bonus!
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 11:23 PM	We have moved on from the need for archaic laws and this presents an opportunity for revenue generation.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 12:13 AM	Should be applicable to all venues that require bookings.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 01:50 AM	Allow at all locations

Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 03:57 AM	There are enough ways to obtain liquor currently in Ajax & increased access = increased drinking I currently find liquor / beer containers on a weekly basis in my Ajax neighbourhood while cleaning up debris We do not need more drunk drivers making their way through Ajax
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 07:34 AM	It will increase in quarrel, conflict and thus crime
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 08:52 AM	Assuming there has not been a marked increase in complaint from other facility users
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 09:09 AM	Open the public parks for Food events, Beer Festivals, Holiday events, Lake front area, Support the local brewery's and Distillery only.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 09:58 AM	as long as everything is well monitored
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 10:04 AM	Tell me where, how long and when. No info provided to make a decision. It appears wou expect a yes.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 11:36 AM	I would be interested in knowing which specific locations are being considered. There are several Licensed establishments fit to host events, including hotels and conference Centre, and preference would be to support these businesses in Ajax. [redacted] We should be focused on promoting and utilizing existing locations.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 01:34 PM	Monitoring other locations that are not directly connected to the city administration is tricky with alcohol use
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 02:15 PM	I am not supportive of offering alcohol near public parks (where kids play)
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 03:24 PM	People likely already are smuggling in alcohol into these spaces, might as well allow the municipality to gain financially through a permit process if this is feasibly achievable.

Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 06:41 PM	Adults need to be allowed to act in mature ways without governmental groups controlling legal activities. Okay also if certain groups declare certain events alcohol free as part of their permit application.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 10:15 PM	Nothing good will come of this.
Screen Name Redacted 1/14/2026 11:34 AM	I don't live in Ajax but live in nearby Whitby and travel to Ajax all the time. It would be incredible to have a European style biergarden along the lake, would be a major economic draw!
Screen Name Redacted 1/14/2026 02:08 PM	Drinking should not be done in community environment as many families and children safety could be at risk
Screen Name Redacted 1/14/2026 02:13 PM	No. I do not support expanding the list to permit temporary liquor service (SOPs) at additional Town locations, including indoor pavilions. Expanding temporary liquor service to additional Town locations is unnecessary and would negatively impact public safety, community well-being, and the family-friendly nature of Town facilities.
Screen Name Redacted 1/14/2026 02:14 PM	I have some reservations regarding the expansion of temporary liquor service at additional Town locations. While I recognize that such services may benefit certain events, it is important that any expansion be carefully assessed to ensure public safety, proper supervision, and respect for the diverse cultural and family-oriented nature of many community spaces. Clear guidelines, trained staff, and appropriate safeguards should be in place before considering additional locations.
Screen Name Redacted 1/14/2026 03:28 PM	Provincial rules around alcohol consumption have only recently changed. It would be good to see the results of those changes on the community before expanding municipal locations.
Screen Name Redacted 1/14/2026 05:04 PM	The town should consider allowing residents to responsibly consume alcohol at public facilities such as parks when those spaces are formally booked for private events. If residents are paying to reserve shelters or benches for birthdays or other celebrations, they should be permitted to enjoy those gatherings in a reasonable and regulated manner, similar to other rented venues. This would support community use of public spaces while still maintaining order and

	accountability.
Screen Name Redacted 1/14/2026 10:22 PM	Im worried that this can be misused and could result in underage drinking and driving under the influence as well as public indecency.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 01:10 PM	Opening the option of more liquor in public parks where you have children playing, some without adult supervision is not a good idea. May also require more By Law officers to patrol the areas, more litter and chance of broken bottles, increase cost for staff to monitor this project. Increase chance of out bursts, fights etc. by law officers cannot even control “rude” cyclists on week ends never mind intoxicated ones.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 02:34 PM	There are many serious health risks to ingesting alcohol. There is no safe amount. Why would you make it more available to Ajax residents when it will cause negative health effects? It would be advisable for the TOA to work with the Durham Region Health Department for further direction. We cannot smoke/vape at these events. We should not allow alcoholic beverages either. The profits you make from selling these products will be very short lived in the bigger picture as the costs of dealing with the short/long term health effects of alcohol with be huge. Major Health Risks Cancers: Alcohol is a Group 1 carcinogen, linked to cancers of the mouth, throat, larynx, esophagus, liver, breast, and colon. Liver Disease: Heavy drinking can lead to fatty liver, alcoholic hepatitis, and cirrhosis (scarring). Heart Issues: It can cause high blood pressure, irregular heartbeats, and damage the heart muscle (cardiomyopathy). Brain & Nervous System: Alcohol can cause brain damage, memory problems (dementia), and nerve damage, affecting thinking and coordination. Pancreas: It increases the risk of pancreatitis, a painful inflammation, and can lead to diabetes. Weakened Immune System: Makes you more vulnerable to infections like pneumonia and tuberculosis. Mental & Social Impacts Mental Health: Linked to depression, anxiety, and increased risk of self-harm. Addiction: Alcohol is dependence-producing, leading to Alcohol Use Disorder (AUD). Injuries & Accidents: Impairs judgment, increasing risks of falls, violence, and fatal car crashes. Other Risks Digestive Problems: Can cause gastritis, ulcers, and malnourishment. Pregnancy: Alcohol use during pregnancy can cause Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorders (FASDs). Let’s be smart and promote the health of our residents.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 02:37 PM	More booze = more fun !!!

Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 02:49 PM	Tourists will come and leave waste outside the pavilions as they walk around. Also have concerns about the alcohol with the e scooters. Bad combination.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:06 PM	Alcohol is extremely harmful
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:07 PM	Yes, we should expand the town and build it up. Provide more opportunities for community.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:14 PM	This really is not a big deal. We have bigger problems then to worry about little things. So let the little things like where a non illegal beverage be consumed just be. Open it up and make life a little more free. We have enough laws.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:21 PM	It would give organizers more options.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:24 PM	No need to be selling or serving alcohol in a municipal building. It adds 0 gain to any activities, and is a liability.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:36 PM	Expanding the list of eligible properties would almost certainly lead to increased rental income for the town. A couple of years ago we looked at renting one of the indoor pavilions for a family event. Since an SOP was not an option we held the event in Toronto.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:43 PM	There really needs to be fully trained smart serve security when events are booked that have an SOP. This protects the community and the event holder.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:51 PM	If renting space for a party etc.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 04:05 PM	Alcohol abuse is a serious problem and allowing people to start drinking in more places in public will expose children and others to those who end up drinking too much as well as put residents on roadways, sidewalks, and parking lots at more risk for potential drunk driving. When people get together for functions, alcohol consumption increases and serious consequences to innocent people end up happening. Why would anyone consider allowing more alcohol use in public places when there is already enough places that serve it.

	Seems like just a money grab instead of considering safety.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 04:08 PM	Responsible use of alcohol should not be limited to only drinking establishments. Parks, beaches etc should be allowed if consumed responsibly
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 04:27 PM	Potential for additional revenue and employment. Availability of alcohol at additional locations could increase the use of those locations and enhance the experience of residents/visitors. Such a shift would reflect a positive shift away from the patriarchal attitude of the Town to its citizens. Adults should be treated as adults.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 04:51 PM	Leads to unacceptable, rowdy behaviour and noise in the residential areas around the pavilions and also puts residents at risk due to drunk drivers.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 04:58 PM	Consumption of alcohol may promote some things, but health and safety are not promoted. I disagree with expanding the SOPs to other locations.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 05:11 PM	My only concern would be if they were serving themselves, no one would be there to monitor the amount of drinks a person can have. Would these facilities need a a bartender that has more that has smart serve? If so, then, yes, I agree to having alcohol there.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 05:14 PM	I do think that further liquor places are not necessary.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 05:26 PM	I emphasis the word temporary- meaning an short term event - less that one day.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 05:29 PM	we are all adults, treat us as such
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 05:29 PM	As an adult each one should be responsible for the alcohol they consume
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 05:54 PM	All but town hall Town hall is a secretary that should be welcoming to all including faith based who do not drink It also should be a place

	where alcoholic addictions should not be tempered
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 06:42 PM	Providing it is for private functions not open to public
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 08:28 PM	If available at selected locations, why not expand it to others.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 09:11 PM	If persons are able to use liquor in the pavillions it may increase the use of these venues for weddings and other more formal events.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 09:50 PM	How will the additional licenses if approved be monitored to ensure that drunkenness is not an issue? Will each event need licensed bartenders and servers?
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 10:27 PM	I don’t want to offer more opportunities for people to drink and drive… let them drink at home!!!
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 11:13 PM	These locations are in parks and public outdoor spaces, where families gather. Having drinking so easily accessible where people are responsible for children in parks and playgrounds does not make sense. It sets a bad example for the children and also may lead to distraction on the part of the adults responsible for their safety and well-being.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 11:32 PM	I believe all the current locations have experienced good results so why not expand.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 11:45 PM	Consuming liquor should be for special events, not something that is made easier to do. By keeping the SOPs at the current locations, it can be ensured that there is enough staff to properly monitor. If expanding is done, then that could result in more reckless driving, noise complaints, and residents feeling less safe in the town they live in.
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 07:51 AM	There must be some oversight so that no is able to drink and drive from the event(s).
Screen Name Redacted	People who are "problem" drinkers are not deterred by laws. Most

1/16/2026 10:09 AM	people just want to have a drink and will clean up after themselves.
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 12:00 PM	People bring it anyways, missed revenue, I've rented a place and got drunk at a baby shower
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 03:32 PM	Would children be in attendance at these functions. What sort of security will be provided. Totally unacceptable when children and young adults under the drinking age.
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 03:36 PM	I support this, assuming there are appropriate guidelines and regulations.
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 05:29 PM	Let the people have a good time no need to be sticklers.
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 05:39 PM	We already have enough liquid outlets and alcohol services. We want to take our children and grandchildren to events without constant alcohol involvement .
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 06:37 PM	Alcohol does not need to be brought into public spaces where children and families are enjoying amenities. Alcohol should not be served in places where children and families go as people who drink there may end up drinking too much creating an inappropriate situation and making it uncomfortable for others to see this unacceptable drunk behaviour. Why not have a venue like a snack bar or coffee shop where all can enjoy the services and it does not impact the safety of patrons.
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 07:52 PM	Alcohol should be able to be served at Town locations. With appropriate controls, as always.
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 10:11 PM	It is well known that alcohol not only causes health issues but it is also highly addictive. Before making such a move, the municipality should educate people on alcohol's effects and consequences.
Screen Name Redacted 1/17/2026 01:07 PM	Beer / wine should be available to those wishing to consume alcohol. All ontario liquor laws must be enforced.
Screen Name Redacted	would like to see local breweries and distillers represented at local

1/17/2026 08:18 PM	markets and events
Screen Name Redacted 1/18/2026 11:40 PM	We need to support s.all business in every way possible!
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 09:25 AM	It would be an amazing addition to the lakefront.
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 10:03 AM	I feel that with permits and property trained servers this is a reasonable expansion
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 11:33 AM	Lift all restrictions and allow adults to be adults.
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 12:37 PM	Why are we limiting these permits today? I see No reason to have restrictions.
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 12:42 PM	I would like to see a nice restaurant on the lake withe a patio, to enjoy beautiful days in the summer over looking the water as well as more entertainment. Pickleball tennis etc.
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 04:28 PM	Actively seeking to increase alcohol consumption is not good for anybody's community. Is the thinking behind this push for more and more available alcohol to bring people together and promote social behaviour? Or is it pure profit?
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 05:42 PM	Ajax's watefront is beautiful. Would be really nice to have a drink on a patio or close to the lake. Would really help support municipal visitors and spending time outdoors by the waterfront.
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 07:44 PM	For functions, events eg weddings
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 08:38 PM	Would love to see something down at the waterfront
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 08:53 PM	I'm in favour of this.

Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 11:01 PM	Strongly support
Screen Name Redacted 1/20/2026 09:20 AM	I think there’sa real opportunity here for outdoor events at the waterfront
Screen Name Redacted 1/20/2026 06:55 PM	I believe that adults should be allowed to enjoy alcohol in a safe and responsible manner if they choose to do so. As long as attendees at events are not drinking and driving or acting irresponsibly they should be permitted to consume alcohol.
Screen Name Redacted 1/20/2026 09:58 PM	I find this move interesting after the Canadian Cancer Society, Princess Margaret, the Gov. of Can. and even Lakeridge Heath's peer reviewed information and campaigns on alcohol consumption's close relationship with cancer.
Screen Name Redacted 1/20/2026 10:32 PM	I support granting a liqour service at pavillons like carruther's marsh.
Screen Name Redacted 1/21/2026 10:38 AM	Provided that they follow the LLCA and AGCO regulatory compliance

Optional question (105 response(s), 301 skipped)
Question type: Essay Question

Q2 Please provide additional comments

Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 01:44 PM	If enjoyed responsibly, allowing alcohol consumption at these events can be very safe and improve general enjoyment of our public spaces. In City of Toronto, they are piloting a program allowing alcohol in parks, and it seems to be going well. Ensuring that the town is equipped for this is the more proactive response.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 01:52 PM	It would save on policing people for having a drink in a public space.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 02:00 PM	Allow open consumption in public parks
Screen Name Redacted	Status quo seems to be working for all

1/12/2026 03:19 PM	
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 04:09 PM	Supervised and managed properly, whats the harm We are way too restrictive
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 05:51 PM	As above. There's too much normalization already. Children are watching. Not to mention people need to drive to these places.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 05:58 PM	It's 2026.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 06:18 PM	I believe the servers have to be licensed; this should remain in place.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 07:27 PM	No change needed
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 07:47 PM	Special events, markets, tournaments make sense. Beach front with designated area. Utilize fairgrounds (might need more washrooms)
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 08:26 PM	Ajax farmers market was the first time I've seen a market that had a local brewery that did not have product samples or sales.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 08:57 PM	Yes for concerts and other community events
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 09:29 PM	[redacted] should be able to order a Labatt 50 no matter where [redacted] goes in AJAX
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 09:52 PM	Whitby has done a great job with their licensing
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 10:02 PM	Beer fest!
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 10:20 PM	Parks, events
Screen Name Redacted	In addition to the safeguards, there's the added concern about noise.

1/12/2026 10:22 PM	
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 10:57 PM	I strongly don't believe alcohol should be at any outdoor events. Adults don't always make good choices. I understand having beer tents at street festivals but never outside a children playground. What about the extra garage creating with the disposal cups.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 11:23 PM	We are raising a generation of shut-ins. People don't socialize anymore. We need more events to draw people out of their homes. Plus it generates revenue.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 12:13 AM	Completely support it as long as people are being served responsibly.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 01:50 AM	Grow up. Alcohol is everywhere, license it and generate revenue.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 03:57 AM	anyone holding these should be responsible for extra policing that should be used when these licenses are active
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 08:52 AM	Cautious of lack of supervision at outdoor venues that is in place inside. Too easy to go too far with only bylaw "possibly" coming by.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 09:09 AM	Only Ajax businesses should be allowed. Surprised when outside Ajax brewery and Distillery were at Ajax events e.g., Pat Bayley Music on the square , Pickering Village events. Farmers Markets.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 09:25 AM	alcohol should be allowed to be carried walking along Kingston Rd during Jam fest, in Rotary park on July 1 and ribfest.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 09:58 AM	as long as everything is well monitored
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 10:04 AM	Too much drinking in current streets.....no one is paying attention to drinking out of residence.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 11:36 AM	Again, I would be interested in specific outdoor locations being considered. Ajax has one of the most beautiful, enjoyable and well maintained waterfronts along the Ontario shore. I would be opposed to approving the allowance of alcohol here. Any parks designed for

	families / children should be alcohol free. That said, ball parks and cricket fields (could) benefit from Alcohol vendor "tents" or booths during special game events. It makes sense that Pat Bayly Square, Golf Courses and Ajax Casino grounds all have permission for outdoor liquor sales during events. Although, the amount of discarded liquor bottles / cans etc. found in parks, apartment stairwells and parking lots is concerning and indicative of illegal outdoor consumption.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 01:34 PM	Given the after math of most events having alcohol is negative it's better to be restrictive and cautious
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 02:15 PM	Again, similar to above, I have some concerns about the issues that may emerge from expansion (public intoxication, driving, enforement, etc) Plus what will this cost the Town in terms of more enforcement What is the expected revenue benefits to be?
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 03:24 PM	People likely already are smuggling in alcohol into these spaces, might as well allow the municipality to gain financially through a permit process if this is feasibly achievable.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 06:41 PM	Not sure why this also needs to be only through permits. Ajax residents should be able to use common spaces similar to residential locations. Exception to this would be the preference of certain locations be fully banned from alcohol use (i.e. playgrounds and other children-centric town areas).
Screen Name Redacted 1/14/2026 02:04 PM	Alcohol always causes issues with rowdiness and some individuals taking advantage of being under the influence and causing abuse to other individuals. Basically all recreational facilities are family oriented and Alcohol disrupts that family time by having even one individual acting obnoxiously
Screen Name Redacted 1/14/2026 02:08 PM	focus on safety
Screen Name Redacted 1/14/2026 02:13 PM	Granting outdoor liquor permits would expose not only event attendees, but also the general public—including children, teenagers, and other vulnerable individuals—to alcohol consumption, its potential misuse, and the resulting disorder. Such exposure risks creating a lasting negative influence on younger generations. In addition, outdoor alcohol service can increase public safety concerns, including

	impaired behavior, noise disturbances, littering, vandalism, and strain on emergency and bylaw enforcement resources. It may also negatively affect nearby residents and businesses, undermine the family-friendly character of public spaces, and create long-term community and social challenges.
Screen Name Redacted 1/14/2026 02:14 PM	Maintaining the current approach allows the Town to balance community enjoyment with safety and responsibility. The existing framework permits alcohol service at appropriate events while ensuring that rules, permits, and conditions are respected. This balanced approach helps protect families, youth, and vulnerable populations while still supporting well-managed community activities.
Screen Name Redacted 1/14/2026 03:28 PM	Sporting events can already sometimes get heated. Introducing alcohol can only make things worse. Please use caution.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 02:34 PM	See above
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 02:37 PM	More booze = more fun !!!
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 02:49 PM	Because e bikes.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:07 PM	Just let people live their lives[redacted] Yes and be more flexible so that people can actually enjoy themselves in this place
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:08 PM	We’ve got to put the Puritanism in the past! Responsible consumption isn’t a problem.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:14 PM	As I said we need to be more free about the things that truly don't matter. Let's worry about crime.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:18 PM	It's 2026. Ontario is probably one of the most restrictive jurisdictions in the free world when it comes to liquor. It's about time the town, and governments, started treating its residents like adults.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:21 PM	I think the Town has been managing it effectively and this could expand its services

Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:24 PM	A non municipal event is an appropriate place to have alcohol
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:51 PM	Probably not needed unless a specific event...not just to drink at a park.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 04:05 PM	Drinking encourages inappropriate behaviour which children should not be exposed to. If someone cannot wait until they get home to drink and has to have alcohol in public places (not licensed restaurants/bars), then this is a serious issue. [redacted] we don't need more issues caused by having more access to alcohol in public spaces. More problems and violence/aggression due to alcohol consumption at games/etc will be an issue requiring more safety first the public.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 04:08 PM	The rules have evolved and drinking should reflect that. People smoke Marijuana everywhere but liquor is still so controlled
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 04:27 PM	Potential additional revenue and employment. While these should be more flexible/commonplace, the variables identified in the paragraph preceding the question (parking, washrooms, adherence to rules) should be reasonable and maintained.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 04:51 PM	These are family spaces that are negatively effected by the presence of alcohol.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 04:58 PM	I don't see a connection to why alcohol should be served at "Run Ajax" - we don't need alcohol at healthy living events, or events with our children and whole families.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 05:11 PM	My only concern would be if they were serving themselves, no one would be there to monitor the amount of drinks a person can have. Would these facilities need a a bartender that has more that has smart serve? If so, then, yes, I agree to having alcohol
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 05:14 PM	As Above,

Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 05:26 PM	I do not think alcohol is necessary at any of the events you listed.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 05:29 PM	we are all adults, treat us as such
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 05:42 PM	Treat those of legal drinking age as responsible adults and deal with those exceptions that are irresponsible as per the law ,especial drinking and driving.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 06:42 PM	No need to! General public outdoor spaces should not have alcohol served
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 08:28 PM	I think if done responsibly, outdoor events should be able sell alcohol.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 09:11 PM	It may be more difficult to control persons and their consumption and some of the park spaces are quite big. It would increase the cost for the city/town for security or municipal officers to be checking and monitoring.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 11:13 PM	Alcohol is not a requirement for any of these public events. The responsibility of the organizer is then huge - and not likely to be easy to uphold. And it also creates much more waste and litter, and behavior problems.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 11:45 PM	There is never enough licensed and trained staff at events as-is, I should know as I was a volunteer at a community event and asked to ensured alcohol didn't leave a fenced in area with zero training or licensing. If the town does proceed with being more flexible or commonplace, then they should require everyone who pours, watches, or is otherwise nearby be fully licensed and trained ahead of time (with the event being required to pay for it). I think it's also appropriate to ask if liquor is really need at an event like that. Liquor isn't needed after a 5k or marathon, what they need is water and other cool non-alcoholic liquid.
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 07:51 AM	There must be some oversight so that no is able to drink and drive from the event(s)

Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 09:02 AM	I've seen it well managed in other municipalities, worth doing on a trial basis.
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 12:00 PM	I don't like alcohol being advertised outdoors, kids see it. It's done on purpose by alcohol companies. They are slowly realizing people are drinking less.
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 03:36 PM	This might help increase attendance, with people possibly staying longer and possibly supporting more vendors.
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 05:39 PM	More alcohol isn't the best solution.
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 06:37 PM	Outdoor liquor service is not appropriate. People who are enjoying outdoor spaces in Ajax should not have to see people who drink too much and act inappropriately. Alcohol use should be in licensed restaurants and bars which people choose to go to. Families and individuals enjoying outdoor spaces have a right to not have to see people drinking and acting inappropriately in public places.
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 07:52 PM	With appropriate controls this can be acceptable.
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 10:11 PM	Same reason as before..
Screen Name Redacted 1/17/2026 08:18 PM	would like to see local breweries and distillers represented at local markets and events
Screen Name Redacted 1/18/2026 11:06 PM	Not a supporter of outdoor liquor use in public spaces.
Screen Name Redacted 1/18/2026 11:26 PM	We should use the waterfront for venues like Whitby.
Screen Name Redacted 1/18/2026 11:40 PM	We have such a beautiful location absolutely ripe to bring in tourism from both local and out of town events!
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 10:03 AM	An important consideration would be washroom facilities that are close to the venue. As long as this is maintained I think it is

	reasonable to expand offerings.
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 11:33 AM	Lift all restrictions and allow adults to be adults.
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 12:37 PM	Why would we limit the people rights to enjoy a beverage? I see no reason for such regulations prohibiting this. People can buy at any gas station and go To the park.
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 04:28 PM	I don't think alcohol should be an expectation at community events. Do we want people drinking at The Santa Claus Parade? Is the goal here to make a profit whenever community gathers? Or is the goal to increase attendance at community events by catering to individuals who only respond to an invitation when there is alcohol involved?
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 05:42 PM	Ajax's watefront is beautiful. Would be really nice to have a drink on a patio or close to the lake. Would really help support municipal visitors and spending time outdoors by the waterfront.
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 07:44 PM	Encourages community involvement
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 08:38 PM	People can smoke weed outdoors, why not a beer or two
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 08:53 PM	Providing licensing for these events will draw more people to the events.
Screen Name Redacted 1/20/2026 06:55 PM	Drinking should be permitted at the above mentioned locations and events for those that wish to consume alcohol. An added benefit to allowing this would presumably be increased revenue from those temporary permits which could be reinvestmented into the town.
Screen Name Redacted 1/20/2026 10:32 PM	Events like rib fest and music festivals
Screen Name Redacted 1/21/2026 10:38 AM	Provided that they follow the LLCA and AGCO regulatory compliance

Optional question (85 response(s), 321 skipped)

Question type: Essay Question

Q3 Please provide any additional comments:

Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 01:41 PM	Within reason - Whitby & Oshawa have clearly designated areas where alcohol is able to be consumed and where it can't go past. I think we would need additional enclosed seating areas that are specifically permitted for alcohol consumption, so it is kept separate from areas where children are playing and we do not have intoxicated patrons or alcohol negatively impacting other residents' lives.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 01:42 PM	[redacted] We don’t need more people, more intoxication and more garbage. It will frustrate residents and cost us money. Also don’t add to the waterfront! It’s precious
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 01:44 PM	This will definitely bring more people into nature and make the waterfront more enjoyable. I am a relatively young person that recently moved to Ajax with my fiance from Toronto and it would be lovely to have some small establishments to enjoy near the waterfront for our own enjoyment and to showcase our friends and family that visit from out of town. Ultimately, people need to experience nature to appreciate it and care about conserving it. If you bring people to a natural space without compromising the ecology, it will only help the town and can also act as an additional revenue source which is awesome. Thanks :)
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 02:11 PM	I'd rather it be available then people "sneak" it and then the garbage is left all around.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 02:16 PM	Similar to whitby with enclosed area.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 02:31 PM	The Ajax waterfront is not easily accessible without a vehicle, so I would not support additional liquor service as people would be driving. It’s a great family friendly space.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 02:46 PM	I think this is an absolute must to allow responsible adults to enjoy a drink and make places like the Waterfront a destination. It could allow for food trucks and other business opportunities. These are the things which make a Town a community, bringing people together.

Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 03:19 PM	Rotary Park Pavillion is too close to playgrounds & splash pad. Alcohol & children's activities should not be mixed into the same area
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 04:09 PM	Supervised and managed properly
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 04:27 PM	There is already significant amounts of garbage left by people at the waterfront. There is not much access to transit there and would therefore lead to more drinking and driving.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 05:58 PM	And Carruthers pavilion
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 06:03 PM	You guys should partner with Durham Distillery for a Whitby Pump house experience. They are awesome at those type of experiences.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 06:10 PM	I have gone to Town Brewery’s Pump House several times and enjoyed an evening of food and drink on Whitby’s waterfront.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 06:18 PM	Don't like the idea of alcohol being readily.availanle outdoors, especially the waterfront. Too much potential for children to be exposed to questionable behavior.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 06:29 PM	Great idea!! Would love to help plan a walking event with different beverage options.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 06:41 PM	I support but they must be monited and support all the rules
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 06:58 PM	Indoor fine. Outdoor not fine.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 07:27 PM	Do not need alcohol in parks
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 07:47 PM	Designated drinking spaces. Unique cuts to prevent others from bringing their own to spaces

Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 08:26 PM	As a person that lives near the lake, I think the idea of a lakefront beer garden is fantastic.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 08:45 PM	Be great for the community and Ajax
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 08:45 PM	Taxes payed, freedoms should be allowed
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 09:02 PM	Licensed spaces can be family friendly and provide unique opportunities for the town and provide an experience for everyone.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 09:27 PM	In controlled situations/events etc most people are well behaved when drinking. Changing those parameters can lead to more challenging behaviours and safety concerns. I would suggest caution.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 09:29 PM	[redacted] needs that Labatt 50! Get [redacted] a Molson Golden.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 09:52 PM	Whitby lakefront license has created a great facility - The Pumphouse
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 10:22 PM	Perpetual licensing leads to less rigorous care without safeguards. There are many who struggle with excess drinking. No need to make it more difficult to ensure they are not enabled. .
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 10:53 PM	The Whitby port is an amazing gathering spot! I head there often, would love to enjoy that in my town!
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 10:57 PM	At the rotary park, this is crazy to even think of this. The playground is directly in front of the pavilion. Why does this family park need to have alcohol available. I would never vote for this.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 11:23 PM	no brainer! Revenue generator and will draw more people to use the waterfront. Hire some bands to entertain us.
Screen Name Redacted 1/12/2026 11:38 PM	this would be great!

Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 12:13 AM	Yes, Whitby waterfront has been highly successful. We should be following suit.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 03:57 AM	see previous comments
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 08:30 AM	Reasonable and lawful consumption should be allowed in our park spaces.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 08:48 AM	the town brewery at the waterfront brings in so many people. would be a great idea
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 08:52 AM	With appropriate safe guards, yes (parking, license, known vendor etc)
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 09:09 AM	Only if Ajax Business.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 09:58 AM	as long as everything is well monitored
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 10:04 AM	Do not support as we have no control now ocer the streets
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 11:36 AM	South Ajax / Waterfront is 90% residential. Many schools, children, churches and homes. I do not support. I definitely DO NOT support any sale, seasonal or otherwise, along our waterfront. It is small in area compared to Whitby and Pickering, it is along a residential road with many houses facing the area and paying high taxes, and it would cause and increase in traffic and parking issues. Liquor licenses should be reviewed annually, applied for annually and have an increase in Fees. The number of high rises approved to be built in (south) Ajax in the next few years is going to grossly increase traffic, which is already strained (Highway 2 / Bayly / Harwood). Ajax cannot predict the impact such an enormous increase of residents will have on roads, parks, schools etc. Keep the SOP's and any other alcohol permits where most all business and existing event establishments are located. NOT IN SOUTH AJAX RESIDENTIAL or WATERFRONT
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 02:15 PM	Too close to kids at Rotary. I view this park as something that families mostly use. I think it should remin as such. I would be more

	supportive of designated water front areas where people can bring their own wine to relax.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 03:24 PM	Whitby's lakefront is a success and so this is something that should be supported in Ajax.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 05:15 PM	There is no public transit to and from the waterfront. Children, pedestrians, and cyclists are at risk if drivers are impaired
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 06:41 PM	Can the costs of temporary permits be supplied based on the current categories.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 10:15 PM	Who does this benefit. Beer around children for a beer garden at the lake. It's a recipe for the unspeakable. Don't do it.
Screen Name Redacted 1/13/2026 11:23 PM	If people can openly smoke marihuana in the park, why can;t those who choose to have a beer do so- even bring their own
Screen Name Redacted 1/14/2026 02:04 PM	Again these are places for families and alcohol will always bring behaviours that can’t be tolerated by general public.
Screen Name Redacted 1/14/2026 02:13 PM	No. I strongly oppose the introduction of perpetual liquor licences at additional public locations, including seasonal outdoor patios, beer gardens along the waterfront, or the sale of alcohol from the Rotary Park Pavilion concession. Public parks and waterfront areas are intended to remain safe, inclusive, and family-oriented spaces. Establishing permanent or seasonal alcohol service in these locations would increase public exposure to alcohol, elevate risks related to safety, disorder, and enforcement, and negatively influence children and youth. Existing licensed venues already provide adequate options for alcohol consumption, and there is no demonstrated community need or public benefit to justify expanding liquor access into shared public spaces.
Screen Name Redacted 1/14/2026 02:14 PM	nts I approach the idea of additional perpetual liquor licenses with caution. While seasonal or designated locations may enhance certain recreational experiences, it is essential to carefully consider long-term impacts on public safety, community well-being, and inclusivity. Any decision should involve strong oversight, clear boundaries, and continued availability of alcohol-free public spaces that are welcoming

	to all residents. Optional signature (if space allows): Nasir Khalid On behalf of the Kabul Cultural Council and Omid24 TV
Screen Name Redacted 1/14/2026 03:28 PM	Whitby locations are an excellent venue. There might be a nice opportunity to follow suit with the right location in Ajax.
Screen Name Redacted 1/14/2026 09:08 PM	Only if these places don't charge an arm and a leg for alcohol
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 01:10 PM	In a closed, monitored area yes. Not in the general public areas
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 02:34 PM	See above
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 02:37 PM	More booze = more fun !!!
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 02:49 PM	Absolutely not. This is supposed to be for kids and families to enjoy. Let tourists go to Whitby. People drive to get here, they don't take transit. That means they drink then drive home. Also they ride e bikes and scooters provided by the town. Terrible combination. Leave the waterfront alone!
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:03 PM	This is what we are missing!
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:06 PM	Widespread alcohol use contributes to preventable disease, mental health issues, and social instability, negatively affecting community safety and overall well-being. Alcohol use leads to serious health problems, increases the risk of accidents and violence, and creates long-term social and economic costs for families and healthcare systems.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:07 PM	If Whitby is doing it, what reason do we have not to?
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:09 PM	I would it if there were permanent concessions available at parks like Rotary park for a nice glass of wine or something on a warm sunny day.

Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:14 PM	Imagine the money from tourism and consumption. I think Ajax could really benefit from that. Plus if I go to these events with the family I might want a single beer. So much more enjoyable to be free to do that.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:18 PM	Same comments above
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:21 PM	Allow Ajax to be more welcoming like its neighbouring municipalities.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:21 PM	Locations need to be identified before I can support the idea totallyb
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:36 PM	It already happens elsewhere and civil society has not broken down. This is another opportunity to generate revenue for the town.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:51 PM	We have enough issues at the waterfront . Excess garbage, limited parking areas.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 03:57 PM	Parking is a problem along the waterfront. Other than the parking I would not have any reservations as long as security is provided
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 04:05 PM	There are enough places to buy liquor/alcohol. The goal should be to encourage people to stop drinking, not encourage them to drink more.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 04:08 PM	I love the waterfront beer garden in whitby. Adds such a wonderful summer vibe at the beautiful waterfront
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 04:26 PM	not at Rotary Park pavillion - people don't need to be drinking in the park
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 04:27 PM	Potential additional revenue and employment. An environment in which people are able to enjoy a fuller experience. This is a 'leveling up' of the legal use of marijuana in outdoor areas. Many towns and cities have removed the restrictive policies regarding responsible use of alcohol at outdoor locations without negative outcomes (see City of Toronto parks).

Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 04:51 PM	Not supportive of my tax money being used for unnecessary things like this when our community faces so many more high priority issues that require attention.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 04:58 PM	I do not support expanding the perpetual alcohol licenses to other locations. The drawbacks and risks associated with more alcohol in public spaces far outweigh the possible benefits.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 05:26 PM	Who is responsible? You have very little control over who ultimately gets the alcohol, how much they buy or where they take it. An older person could purchase alcohol for an underage person since no one monitors this like they would in a bar or restaurant or banquet facility (they would lose their license so it would be in there best interest not to let this happen.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 05:29 PM	we are all adults, treat us as such
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 08:28 PM	This is common in many European countries, and people have learned to be respectful and responsible.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 09:11 PM	Not the Rotary - its a much busier park unless you cardon a portion of park like a gazebo with some additional seatings and lightings away from the Rotary pavilion. Could do it during the summer months.
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 11:13 PM	Public spaces should not be promoting alcohol consumption. AND for many people, alcohol-free spaces are sanctuaries from most socializing establishments. Why not be promoting healthy outdoor venues?
Screen Name Redacted 1/15/2026 11:45 PM	The problem is responsibility, who personally will be responsible to ensure too much liquor isn't consumed and those who consume it safely get home (and not put anyone else in danger). Even having one drink results in a higher risk of car crashes, which we should want less of, not more. Do we want those who have had liquor around kids or a playground, which could result in a higher risk of injury?
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 07:51 AM	There must be some oversight so that no is able to drink and drive from the event(s)

Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 09:02 AM	Rotary Pavilion
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 12:00 PM	No thanks, alcohol in an outdoor space is inviting for degeneracy, again people see the brands and drinks, I don't want them advertising it where I walk with my family. Don't care if it's once in a while, other things can be improved
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 03:32 PM	Concerned that no control can be applied on who and whom is accessing these facilities. Again my concern is for those who would like to enjoy the outdoors peacefully and without fear.
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 03:36 PM	Why not, if it works.
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 04:27 PM	Responsible alcohol consumption in public areas is not a threat.
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 05:29 PM	Yes absolutely good idea
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 05:39 PM	Why would anyone want to participate in alcoholic activities at a farmers market?
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 06:37 PM	If there is a designated licensed facility that is not part of the outdoor spaces/parks/community centres like restaurants with designated trained staff that limit the amount of alcohol consumption to prevent drunk driving/inappropriate behaviour, then perhaps this could happen but I’m not sure why there is such a heavy focus on serving alcohol to residents. It is unhealthy and causes diseases which puts a strain on our already overwhelmed healthcare facilities. Why not partner with coffee franchises or open your own cafes so that everyone can enjoy them, not just those who drink alcohol. Seems like Ajax only cares about pleasing residents who drink alcohol which some people don’t for several reasons (e.g., religion).
Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 07:52 PM	Lakefront/Rotary Park is a passive quiet park area that is not conducive to restaurant/bars/etc. It would detract from the character of that area. It also would not have a good business case for doing this.

Screen Name Redacted 1/16/2026 10:11 PM	Same reason as before.
Screen Name Redacted 1/17/2026 12:38 AM	The Town can make money from sales and support local businesses by selling local products.
Screen Name Redacted 1/17/2026 08:53 AM	I live by the lake. If parking is already a concern here (and a pain for residents and our guests with permits), why would we compund the issue and add alcohol to the mix? [redacted]
Screen Name Redacted 1/17/2026 01:07 PM	Will help increase additional participation at these outings
Screen Name Redacted 1/17/2026 08:18 PM	would like to see local breweries and distillers represented at local markets and events
Screen Name Redacted 1/18/2026 11:06 PM	It's a children's play area outside predominantly. Don't support liquor consumption here. Just no.
Screen Name Redacted 1/18/2026 11:26 PM	Great idea
Screen Name Redacted 1/18/2026 11:40 PM	As above,please relax regulation on all small businesses. Increase focus on crime and vagrant populations Thank you for asking :)
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 10:03 AM	Fully agree as long as occasional inspections are done to ensure that compliance is still adhered to
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 12:37 PM	Oshawa and Whitby already do this and it provides a great environment for the town to enjoy an afternoon.
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 04:28 PM	Everybody knows that consuming alcohol is a health risk. For better health, people should not be offered alcohol more and more and more. Other people get affected when drunken public behaviour takes place. I think overall, it has a tendency to make communities less safe. Impaired driving would become more commonplace. As would public intoxication. I think some people would feel less safe taking their children to public places where potential drunken behaviour is on

	display. Some people like to drink on special occasions, but it seems like alcohol is being pushed towards daily behaviour. Who wants residents of Ajax (and guests) drinking alcohol everywhere they go? Some will argue that individuals have a choice, but look what happens when there are junk food options everywhere. [redacted] If there are more and more places where alcohol is being offered, people will just make worse and worse choices. I imagine that the people who really want more alcohol to be served everywhere will use some human rights argument or freedom of choice argument. I hope that doesn't cloud the Town's judgment to the realities of increasing public risks. I think it would ruin the waterfront that many Ajax residents love.
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 05:42 PM	Ajax's watefront is beautiful. Would be really nice to have a drink on a patio or close to the lake. Would really help support municipal visitors and spending time outdoors by the waterfront.
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 07:44 PM	Common in Europe with no problems, accepted and behaviour is observed and monitored normal as coffee.
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 08:38 PM	Ajax residents leave Ajax to go to Pickering or whitby to take advantage of their waterfront and enjoy an alcoholic beverage
Screen Name Redacted 1/19/2026 08:53 PM	Yes definitely. This will draw more people to the beautiful Lakefront!
Screen Name Redacted 1/20/2026 08:14 AM	Ride my bike in that area all the time, would be great to have an area to go sit and get a drink while by the water!
Screen Name Redacted 1/20/2026 08:17 AM	Sounds like a great idea, would love to have a place to stop by and grab a drink by the water!
Screen Name Redacted 1/20/2026 09:31 AM	Sounds like a great idea, would love to have a place to stop by and grab a drink by the water!
Screen Name Redacted 1/20/2026 06:55 PM	Adults can already drink alcohol at bars. I think being able to enjoy a beer or two at an outdoor event in the summer months would be welcome and add some enjoyment for those who drink. There will always be a need to strike a balance between unlimited freedoms and a nanny state. As long as there isn't an uptick in drunk driving incidents or public intoxication I support expanding alcohol sales

during events.

Screen Name Redacted 1/20/2026 10:32 PM	It could increase lakefront visitors if there was a nice location to sit and have a drink like in whitby
Screen Name Redacted 1/21/2026 10:38 AM	Provided that the follow the LLCA and AGCO regulatory compliance

Optional question (109 response(s), 297 skipped)
Question type: Essay Question